

ACA Marketplace Shoppers (OEP) — Deep Buyer Research

Health Insurance Ecosystem · the individual or family buying marketplace (Obamacare) coverage · Researched 2026-09-25 · refresh due 2027-03-25 · Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/aca-shoppers/research/>

104,229 documents in the shared corpus · 1,793 buyer documents in this page's voice · 518 ads to this audience of 4,366 read.

TLDR

- Who: 1,793 first-person marketplace shoppers from r/Obamacare, r/HealthInsurance and the comment threads under early-retirement, self-employed and 2026-premium videos. Employer-plan stories, agents, vendors and political comments with no personal plan detail are excluded, so the voice is thinner than the Medicare page.
- What they fear: the premium at renewal (36 documents), getting sick or hurt and not being able to pay (24), and the income math: the cliff and paying credits back at tax time (19).
- What changed: the enhanced premium tax credits expired for 2026; CMS reports 23.1M plan selections (down 4.9%) and about 1.5M improper enrollments removed. The complaint ledger is led by premiums that doubled or tripled (105 documents), the cliff and repayment (91) and deductibles too high to use the plan (15).
- What they do about it: pick a tier (109 documents name bronze, silver or gold), go to HealthCare.gov or the state exchange themselves (104), weigh COBRA or a spouse's plan (105), move to Medicaid (101), or go without (40). Only 24 name a broker or agent.
- Who sells to them: 518 active Meta ads to marketplace shoppers; '\$0 / low-cost coverage' is the leading hook.
- The read for Vince (hypothesis): ACA leads are cheap to generate, but this buyer is price-shocked, income-sensitive and wary of having a plan changed without consent. Agents will pay for consented, verified households who have seen their real price, not raw '\$0 coverage' form fills.

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Tab 1 — Fears

Marketplace buyers state numbers more than feelings; the fears here are counted only when a fear word and the subject sit in one sentence, which keeps this tab small and exact.

Theme	Documents
The premium at renewal	36
Getting sick or hurt and not being able to pay	24
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The premium at renewal · 36 documents

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnyycy/>

↳ (0): "I hope everyone making these posts are also calling their senators and representatives. They may not respond but they do track constituent issues/concerns."

↳ (0): "...and don't forget to VOTE!!!"

↳ (0): "I just wish we had at least one party running on universal healthcare to vote for."

"I had to retire due to medical issues at 55 so we had to go with Marketplace. It's been pretty good, our premiums are under \$150 per month for 2 people and our deductible for family was \$800. No HSA is allowed but we created a medical bucket in our high yield savings account and just transfer money as needed. We keep our income below \$60,000 too. I fear big changes are coming for 2026 though. Guess we will cross that bridge when it comes. God bless all!"

— YouTube · Want to Retire Early? HERE ARE 4 OPTIONS FOR HEALTH INSURANCE! · 145 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wmu0NOIjsfU&lc=Ugyd3n-O0reHcMX3grJ4AaABAg>

↳ @iHealthBrokers (3): "Yes, it is likely that we will see largely increased premiums in the upcoming year. We will release a video previewing 2026 plans soon! Thank you for your comment."

"I can't afford COBRA and I'm under court orders... I recently changed jobs. My benefits with my new employer don't kick in for 60 days. I'm under court orders (Child Support) to provide coverage or I risk paying 100% of any medical costs out of pocket. My children's other parent is not willing to work with me and has a history of taking advantage of situations that cause me financial hardship. They are already aware of the lack of coverage since recent Rx had to be paid out of pocket. Although my new position pays better than the last, COBRA coverage is \$1961.25 monthly to continue. Considering my other expenses to just survive, I can't afford an additional \$2k/mo even if it's only for two months. I have two children that are Special Needs so having a PPO plan was the choice to ensure we could see (almost) any doctor we needed. There is no option to only provide coverage for my children. I don't know what to do. I can start looking at other providers. I was told to ask for "Special Enrollment Period" plans as the coverage would only be needed for two months (until my new employer's benefits kick in). It was recommended to check healthcare.gov and affordablehealthplans.com. My concern is running into similar, unaffordable pricing. I need advice. I'm lost and feel like I'm going to face major medical bills here soon if I don't figure out a plan. I'm at work so I can't provide 100% of my attention to searching plans until later this evening. Help me, Reddit Community. You're my only hope."

— r/HealthInsurance · 42 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1w02ffv/>

↳ (0): "Your loss of insurance due to you leaving your job that included health insurance opens a special enrollment period in your state's health insurance marketplace (ACA Marketplace). The marketplace is operated either by your state or the federal government, depending on where you live. All plans available in the marketplace meet certain core standards including coverage of essential services and coverage for preexisting conditions. This last point is really important. Plans bought outside the marketplace may not include coverage for medical issues a person already has. In your children's cases, that would mean their health conditions wouldn't be covered, making the insurance less than useful. Depending on your income, you may get a subsidy for buying a plan through the Marketplace. Given today's date (August 28th) most plans may not go into effect until October 1. Costs incurred prior to the effective date won't be covered by insurance. Medicaid coverage is available in all states, depending on income and other factors. In most states, Medicaid expanded to cover a wide range of people. The Marketplace in your state will indicate if Medicaid is an option in your state. In some cases, Medicaid can be retroactive. You might also consider pursuing CHIP or Medicaid for individuals with disabilities, depending on the exact nature of your children's medical issues."

↳ (0): "Thank you. I'll look into these options."

↳ (0): "How long have you gone without health insurance? COBRA can be signed up for/used retroactively. So for 60 days from the last date of employment you have a window where you can wait to sign up if you need it, and it covers you retroactively for those 60 days. It's a rare instance where you only have to pay for it if you need to use it. For instance, if you do nothing now, and then your child has a large medical expense, you can sign up after the event of the expense, get coverage, and the event will be paid for as long as you signed up within the first 60 days."

Getting sick or hurt and not being able to pay · 24 documents

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future. 💙 "

— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q4ew3x/>

↳ (0): "Republicans could not care less if people are uninsured and it actually seems like they enjoy kicking people off insurance, hurting poor people, and punching down while they laugh. And they proclaim to be Christian. Jesus would be disgusted with them!"

↳ (0): "But you don't know what you're going to make in 2026. Estimate your income above the poverty level and get coverage."

↳ (0): "Be prepared to owe if you end up making more than you estimate. This happened to me. Not fun."

"I can't afford COBRA and I'm under court orders... I recently changed jobs. My benefits with my new employer don't kick in for 60 days. I'm under court orders (Child Support) to provide coverage or I risk paying 100% of any medical costs out of pocket. My children's other parent is not willing to work with me and has a history of taking advantage of situations that cause me financial hardship. They are already aware of the lack of coverage since recent Rx had to be paid out of pocket. Although my new position pays better than the last, COBRA coverage is \$1961.25 monthly to continue. Considering my other expenses to just survive, I can't afford an additional \$2k/mo even if it's only for two months. I have two children that are Special Needs so having a PPO plan was the choice to ensure we could see (almost) any doctor we needed. There is no option to only provide coverage for my children. I don't know what to do. I can start looking at other providers. I was told to ask for "Special Enrollment Period" plans as the coverage would only be needed for two months (until my new employer's benefits kick in). It was recommended to check healthcare.gov and affordablehealthplans.com . My concern is running into similar, unaffordable pricing. I need advice. I'm lost and feel like I'm going to face major medical bills here soon if I don't figure out a plan. I'm at work so I can't provide 100% of my attention to searching plans until later this evening. Help me, Reddit Community. You're my only hope."

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"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

↳ (0): "In short, yes, a provider can always run your information through a carrier website and see if you have insurance or not. Ask for the cash price- say you want to pay cash and not go through insurance."

↳ (0): "They said if I have coverage of any kind (that they don't take of course), then I don't have the option to pay anything but the full cost of the visit :/ I've heard some doctors are more lenient on this than others, which makes me think I should just look for a new doctor. But that feels like a whole other can of worms right now and just kind of overwhelming tbh"

↳ (0): "I mean, OP can ask, but many behavioral health providers don't maintain separate cash-price vs. insurance-price fee schedules. They tend to be more transparent and open about their fees in general, meaning their published fee is the same regardless of payer (although may vary as a function of sliding scales or "scholarships")."

The income cliff and paying credits back at tax time · 19 documents

"If I get a job part way through the year and cut off my ACA insurance right when my new insurance starts what happens as far as my tax credits? Update : I'm in Michigan I know we estimate for yearly income for the ACA but they wouldn't penalize me for not having or isn't ACA insurance for the months I'm covered by employer insurance right? As of right now I estimated my income higher due to making more money last year but business has taken a dive this year. I'm paying more per month because of that higher estimate and I'm looking for a new job with benefits because it's too unpredictable at this point. For what I've made for the first quarter of the year I prob would have been eligible for Medicaid so I'm also worried about getting screwed for that come tax time next year."

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s3qnb3/if_i_get_a_job_part_way_throug_h_the_year_and_cut/

↳ wijwijwij (3): "Your tax credit will be computed using your full year income."

↳ wijwijwij (3): "You only calculate what tax credit you merit during the months you had ACA coverage (so you wouldn't be "paying back" any tax credit for other months). But your share of the cost of insurance for the months you did have ACA coverage is calculated based not on the income of those months, but your income for the entire year. For example, suppose for Jan, Feb, and Mar you were on ACA and estimated your income was going to be 30K for the year. You'd merit some tax credit (which you can elect to use to directly pay premiums) because that's under 400% federal poverty level. If you end up getting a job and you actually make 80K for the year, which is over 400% federal poverty, when it comes time to "reconcile" things you turn out not to merit any tax credit, so you repay to the treasury what they sent in those three months to your insurer, to square things. That is not "paying back the tax credit as if I used the insurance for the whole year." It's paying back the tax credit because the provisional amount advanced to your insurer in Jan, Feb, Mar was wrong, and you actually didn't merit any help, based on the fact that *later in the year* you earned more money. This is just an artifact of the way ACA legislation was written. It was decided not to try to make eligibility a monthly determination. By the same token, if your income prediction when enrolling in ACA is higher than income turns out to be, you'll find at reconciliation time when you file your taxes, you get additional credit that in effect "pays you back" some of the amounts that went to your ACA insurer, in order that your share for the months you had ACA coverage should match what your income (for the year) indicates."

↳ O_o-22 (2): "So say I'm getting \$500 a month in tax credit but I only use the tax credit for 4 months out of the year and end my ACA insurance for the remaining 8 months. At the end of the year the reconciliation says I should have only gotten \$300 a month due to higher income. Thats a \$200 difference X 4 months so I'd owe \$800 back then?"

"I what to cancel our marketplace insurance and go without for a while, this guessing your income, has been causing me so much anxiety and sleepless nights. This Marketplace insurance with advanced tax premiums is complicated and can leave you having to pay a lot of \$\$\$ back if you happen to do better than expected, I can't live this way !!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance for Self Employed: Beyond Marketplace Insurance! · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=allOvX_0uhs&lc=Ugzf4eVxNzdrhPZ2DZB4AaABAg

↳ @SIIm-mb7cq (1): "What did you end up doing? or did you find something better? I'm currently looking ugh"

↳ @splooshkaboom4210 (1): "Have you ever considered medically underwritten insurance?"

↳ @iHealthBrokers (0): "Having to estimate your income can certainly be a little daunting. Have you considered speaking with an accountant? They may be able to provide you with some assurances. Best of luck!"

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tm0cfj/>

↳ (0): "What state are you in? If you live in a state with Medicaid expansion and you truly have zero reportable income, your options are to apply for / receive Medicaid, or don't use Medicaid and instead pay full price for a policy through healthcare.gov."

↳ (0): "Don't only live on cash. Use that time of low income to do some Roth conversions up to the magi limit if you intend on qualifying for Medicaid or higher for ACA with subsidies."

↳ (0): "The assets usually don't matter for medicaid eligibility in most states - they mainly look at monthly income flow. Since you're planning zero income those years you'd probably qualify regardless of your house value and retirement accounts. You can still buy private insurance through the marketplace even with zero income but you'd be paying full price without subsidies. Might be worth running numbers on both options since private plans could give you more provider choices but medicaid is obviously much cheaper. One thing to consider is maybe taking small distributions from retirement accounts or doing some part time work just to stay above medicaid threshold if you prefer private insurance. Even like 20k annual income would open up the subsidized marketplace plans"

Going without insurance · 14 documents

"Is It Better to not Have Health Insurance or Choose a Very Expensive Plan? So these are the issues that we're facing if we have to choose a marketplace plan. Would you guys rather risk it and go without, or pay a lot for a plan? Here's my potential plan with a 50k income: BCBS PPO, 700/month, 9800 deductible, 11000 max oop. It would eat up my income, but if I don't have any major surgeries or a trip to the ER, then I'd be fine without. However, I'd hate to be uninsured if something happens. Realistically, what would you do? Can hospitals negotiate the price down if a bill is very expensive?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 47 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1p965n4/>

↳ (0): "My 64 year old brother was very healthy and never had to go to the doctor for anything until he was recently diagnosed with stage 4 lung cancer. If he didn't have health insurance he'd likely go bankrupt. Don't take any chances."

↳ (0): "Chances are, he still will. >60% of medical bankruptcies held "full" insurance."

↳ (0): "For years I was someone who barely used any of my healthcare benefits. After I got bad results on a mammogram it set off a series of tests that had me halfway to my high deductible in six hours. The sticker price of my healthcare costs in the past year have exceeded a quarter million dollars and that is for a straightforward case of breast cancer. If I had been uninsured I would have gone without many of the tests, procedures, and medications I've received and even if the hospital had accepted 10% it would have exceeded the cost of my insurance premium, even after upgrading to Gold for 2025. If it's all you can afford, get the cheapest plan the marketplace has to offer. Even if it seems like it won't cover anything. If you really need it, it will cover plenty."

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxm828/>

↳ (0): "Health shares are NOT insurance."

↳ (0): "you're young and healthy with no preexisting conditions until you aren't. during a routine physical my doctor found a large mass on my thyroid. it happens in the blink of an eye."

↳ (0): "Healthshares are scams"

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nghi12x/

Medicaid: losing it, or being pushed onto it · 11 documents

"I can't afford COBRA and I'm under court orders... I recently changed jobs. My benefits with my new employer don't kick in for 60 days. I'm under court orders (Child Support) to provide coverage or I risk paying 100% of any medical costs out of pocket. My children's other parent is not willing to work with me and has a history of taking advantage of situations that cause me financial hardship. They are already aware of the lack of coverage since recent Rx had to be paid out of pocket. Although my new position pays better than the last, COBRA coverage is \$1961.25 monthly to continue. Considering my other expenses to just survive, I can't afford an additional \$2k/mo even if it's only for two months. I have two children that are Special Needs so having a PPO plan was the choice to ensure we could see (almost) any doctor we needed. There is no option to only provide coverage for my children. I don't know what to do. I can start looking at other providers. I was told to ask for "Special Enrollment Period" plans as the coverage would only be needed for two months (until my new employer's benefits kick in). It was recommended to check healthcare.gov and affordablehealthplans.com . My concern is running into similar, unaffordable pricing. I need advice. I'm lost and feel like I'm going to face major medical bills here soon if I don't figure out a plan. I'm at work so I can't provide 100% of my attention to searching plans until later this evening. Help me, Reddit Community. You're my only hope."

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↳ (0): "Thank you. I'll look into these options."

↳ (0): "How long have you gone without health insurance? COBRA can be signed up for/used retroactively. So for 60 days from the last date of employment you have a window where you can wait to sign up if you need it, and it covers you retroactively for those 60 days. It's a rare instance where you only have to pay for it if you need to use it. For instance, if you do nothing now, and then your child has a large medical expense, you can sign up after the event of the expense, get coverage, and the event will be paid for as long as you signed up within the first 60 days."

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/112izqi/>

↳ (0): "Cash on hand/assets only matters if you're 65 or older. You HAVE been eligible all along, and you should feel free to use your services. You're in the exact situation this social safety net is intended for....use it all you want until you find a job and get monthly income again. And no, it would not matter even if you weren't eligible You could have knowingly lied and committed fraud to get enrolled in Medi-Cal, but if you haven't made claims Medicaid would never know or care. There's nothing spent by them to try to recover. They'd only come after you if you had claims."

↳ (0): "Medicaid goes by going forward current monthly income, not calendar year income. Previous months do not count at all, and there is no asset test for expansion Medicaid. The monthly income limit for 2022 was \$1,563 and for 2023 \$1,677 a month."

↳ (0): "Are you saying that the "cash on hand" question is basically moot and that it's ALL about monthly income?"

"We need Medicare-For-All/A single payer healthcare system here in the United States, especially during this time with the Coronavirus pandemic! What is more "Pro-Life" than ensuring that every person in America has guaranteed affordable healthcare regardless of their job or social status? Also, if we all had access to basic healthcare, we would all have the "freedom" to live long lives and rarely have to worry about medical bankruptcies. Sure, taxes will go up, but the overall cost will go down so much that everyone will be paying less and saving thousands of dollars every year. Furthermore, if some of us need additional healthcare than Medicare, then we have the "choice" to get additional insurance, but for others Medicare would be more than enough. Finally, if every other developed country (Canada, Germany, the United Kingdom, France, Italy, Sweden, Norway, Denmark, the Netherlands, Switzerland, Japan, South Korea, Australia, and New Zealand) can implement this system and save money, then why can't the United States do the same and help "Make America Great Again" for everybody at least on the issue of healthcare? Oh, and if American citizens die from lacking access to affordable health insurance because the Republicans believe that the government shouldn't provide it then we are failing our country's promise of defending "life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness" for its citizens as well as "promoting the general welfare" of all the people."

— YouTube · Health Insurance After Quitting Your Job · 18 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2xGHnufEwvs&lc=UgzfpC1om_phrxaXD0B4AaABAg

↳ @DoubleDown310 (2): "Why would they do that, when they can squeeze every penny out of every single American?"

↳ @dvran (1): "Americans wanted capitalism; here you go. Greedy healthcare companies making shareholders happy, large corporations taking over ... it's all to make more billionaires."

↳ @BeatTheBush (1): "@momosan11 I wish but I don't see that happening any time soon. Reform is hard when you have such an ingrained system that will have big money behind to resist it."

Leaving a job or retiring before 65 · 9 documents

"I quit a 20 year career at 50 🙄 with terrific health insurance in order to become self employed. I'm in CA and was able to get Covered CA (ACA) at first which was wonderful. Nowadays at 56 I make too much to qualify. And I have a 15 year old son at home. I get Blue Shield Gold PPO which is \$1500 a month for the two of us. 🙄 But no deductible. This was good news considering I ended up with cancer + brain surgery in the last 3 years! I pay a lot for medical insurance but it gives me peace of mind."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgwwS68tKfQws0fQ-V4AaABAg

↳ @PatricLubomir-r2w (1): "Wow, you've been through so much. ❤️ Leaving a 20-year career to build your own business was a brave decision, and then facing cancer and brain surgery on top of that must have been incredibly challenging. I'm so glad you had solid coverage when you needed it most. Even though \$1,500 a month is a huge expense, I can completely understand why the peace of mind is worth it after everything you've experienced. How are you doing these days? I hope you're feeling much stronger now. And how has being self-employed been for you overall —despite the healthcare costs, has it been everything you hoped it would be?"

↳ @scottunclocked (0): "Thank you for your comments. Great example of the reason why you need good health insurance! You just never know when something major is going to hit you and it isn't worth the risk of ruining your whole retirement because of a massive health care bill. I pray you are doing better after surgery and are recovering!"

↳ @Dravlae (0): "Hope you recover well."

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tm0cfj/>

↳ (0): "What state are you in? If you live in a state with Medicaid expansion and you truly have zero reportable income, your options are to apply for / receive Medicaid, or don't use Medicaid and instead pay full price for a policy through healthcare.gov."

↳ (0): "Don't only live on cash. Use that time of low income to do some Roth conversions up to the magi limit if you intend on qualifying for Medicaid or higher for ACA with subsidies."

↳ (0): "The assets usually don't matter for medicaid eligibility in most states - they mainly look at monthly income flow. Since you're planning zero income those years you'd probably qualify regardless of your house value and retirement accounts. You can still buy private insurance through the marketplace even with zero income but you'd be paying full price without subsidies. Might be worth running numbers on both options since private plans could give you more provider choices but medicaid is obviously much cheaper. One thing to consider is maybe taking small distributions from retirement accounts or doing some part time work just to stay above medicaid threshold if you prefer private insurance. Even like 20k annual income would open up the subsidized marketplace plans"

"Cancelled my ACA plan a couple months back. I made too much for the subsidy. My kids are covered under their mom's (my ex) insurance. My bronze plan had a 9k deductible. I'm paying cash moving toward for medical. If I go into a coma.. I don't own a home, my car is worth \$2,500. And they can't touch my retirement, so most of my risk is mitigated. (Under federal law up to \$1,512,350 in IRAs is protected from creditors in bankruptcy)"

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America | People Are Canceling Coverage · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=UgwgRjNmbi3gTenofwB4AaABAg>

Losing coverage or the subsidy · 6 documents

"I'm terrified of losing my Obamacare I'm a one issue voter. I want to keep my Obamacare. Having this allowed me and my husband to quit our terrible soul sucking jobs and start small businesses. It's not perfect and it costs a lot but it's been a life saver. Literally. Now that you know what happened, will I have to get another horrible job that destroys my will to live just to have health insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,425 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1gkt285/>

↳ (0): "Same boat here. We run a small business that employs four people, my husband is a working owner, I do the books. I also do freelance bookkeeping part time for two other businesses. I left a high stress job on the doctor's recommendation. It had no benefits anyway. We are in a tiny town, not many jobs here, much less with benefits. Plus I'm 60 years old with a chronic health condition. Husband has rheumatoid arthritis. Without our ACA plan we are done. Premium would be \$3074 a month non subsidised price. I could foresee us closing the business and putting people out of work so my husband can seek a job with benefits. I'm sorry this is not the way America is supposed to work."

↳ (0): "I would say that anyone who has signed up for a 2025 plan is probably grandfathered in simply because it is ingrained in the health care system so much at this point. By the time Trump is taking office, people's new plans for the year will have already started and even they know the chaos it would cause to try to cancel things immediately. So I'm guessing that for the 2025 year anything that anyone gets for pretty much stay as is. After that however well, we know what they want to do. Speaker Johnson has said as well as several Republican senators that their main goal or at least one of their main goals is to get rid of the ACA. In the past when they tried it, ultimately the supreme Court stopped them telling them they didn't have the authority to do it. The only thing the supreme Court in the past sided with them on was repealing the mandate that required everyone to get a plan to help pay for the system. Everything else they left intact. Since that time however, Trump has put four of his own people in the supreme Court. So I can't imagine they would not side with him now when they approach them about this. The fact that Republicans gained two seats in the Senate and now will have control of the Senate only heightens the possibility that this is going to happen. So again, I think 2025 might be pretty much as is, but after that I would expect sweeping negative changes to health care in this country. No more ACA. A great reduction in the number of people they allow to qualify for Medicaid, etc. The unfortunate thing is even after 4 years and he's gone, he will have put so many people in high position places, this stuff will go on for decades after he's gone. Welcome to the new America folks."

↳ (0): "I'm extremely worried about this because I will lose access to mental health medications that keep me alive and sane. Please, if anyone has any advice or insight on how to keep access to the mental health medications i desperately need please let me know. I am terrified this is going to actually kill me."

"I what to cancel our marketplace insurance and go without for a while, this guessing your income, has been causing me so much anxiety and sleepless nights. This Marketplace insurance with advanced tax premiums is complicated and can leave you having to pay a lot of \$\$\$ back if you happen to do better than expected, I can't live this way !!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance for Self Employed: Beyond Marketplace Insurance! · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=allOvX_0uhs&lc=Ugzf4eVxNzdrhPZ2DZB4AaABAg

↳ @Slm-mb7cq (1): "What did you end up doing? or did you find something better? I'm currently looking ugh"

↳ @splooshkaboom4210 (1): "Have you ever considered medically underwritten insurance?"

↳ @iHealthBrokers (0): "Having to estimate your income can certainly be a little daunting. Have you considered speaking with an accountant? They may be able to provide you with some assurances. Best of luck!"

"Going into my fourth month without a job. I need to cancel my plan if i reach 6 months of no work right? i lost my job in December and thought id find a job by february but rhings fell through. its been really difficult finding a new job and i feel hopeless I'll find one soon. im scared I'll have to pay back if i exceed 6 months without a job so its recommended i cancel then right? then if i find a job I'll have to wait until enrollment but better than paying this shit back without having \$\$"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_with_out_a_job_i_need/

↳ SeaweedWeird7705 (10): "If I were you, I would keep my Obamacare since it's the only way for you to get insurance. If you end up below 100% of the FPL for the year, they typically don't ask you to repay (since you were too LOW). (If you were too high, they would insist on repayment)."

↳ SeaweedWeird7705 (8): "There is no rule that you have to cancel your Obamacare if you lose your job. What is your total income for the year 2026? Is it zero? If your total income for the year is zero, you should consider applying for Medicaid."

↳ PeacefulCW (8): "Everything you said was correct until the paragraph that started with “ you never should’ve had it to begin with...”. That is absolutely incorrect. Marketplace insurance is based on one’s ESTIMATE of their annual income, not necessarily their current income. It’s absolutely OK for our OP to have marketplace insurance."

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

Theme	Documents
A premium they can pay	36
Retiring early or working for themselves	30
A plan they can actually use	20
Not needing care this year	19
Making it to 65 and Medicare	10
Health care that isn't tied to a job	6

A premium they can pay · 36 documents

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

— r/HealthInsurance · 614 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hmjm0o/>

↳ (0): "You know, \$240 for insurance you can actually use? Isn't bad at all. The new Medicare premium for 2025 is \$185. And that? Is for insurance that's about as useful as tits on a nun, and doesn't include vision or dental coverage. Secondly, the Marketplace is open for enrollment until January 15th: https://www.healthcare.gov/subscribe/?gad_source=1&gclid=CjwKCAiAmrS7BhBJEiwAei59i9Oacg0wxG2w-ZA-CIWv7rQmP1f88oKN4m5i8AvwQGxT-DXXSOE0lhoCgioQAvD_BwE&gclsrc=aw.ds You are still eligible for Marketplace coverage and subsidies if: 1. Your employer-offered insurance is more than 9.12% of your annual income, or the lowest-cost option to cover your family is 9.12% of your household's total income. 2. Your employer-offered insurance doesn't meet ACA standards (which is defined generally as those that offer coverage for doctors and hospitals, and generally pay for 60% of medical costs). If you don't qualify for Medicaid? It's because your income is too high to do so. I don't know what to tell you. It sounds like you rolled the dice, took a chance, and lost."

↳ (0): "13 years working in the world of the Affordable Care Act 8 Years of Provider Services dealing with Medical Professionals 7 Years of Customer Service dealing with individuals' questions on claims and benefits 5 years of Medical Claim Processing So what state do you live in? Does your state have a State-Run Health Insurance Marketplace? My state is still in OPEN ENROLLMENT to enroll in a Health Insurance Plan for 2025 with an effective date of February 1, 2025. The deadline for a January 1 Effective date has passed; the deadline line is midnight December 15, 2024. I am not able to use the tools I have to determine if you are eligible for Tax Subsidies to enroll in a healthcare plan with financial assistance. Your age, yearly income, or Adjusted Gross Income, the tax structure of your household, married, children, filing single, etc, are needed to determine this. Secondly, your Employer offers you a health insurance plan (ESI). Most ESI plans meet the Qualified Health Insurance standard (QHP), as set forth by the Affordable Care Act (ACA). There are two things that a QHP must meet A: They must meet "MINIMUM ESSENTIAL VALUE" - which means a healthcare plan must pay at least 60% of all claims AFTER the deductible is met B: They must meet MINIMUM ESSENTIAL COVERAGE" - meaning they MUST cover the 10 essential health care benefits as outlined in the ACA Law they are, Routine Yearly Physical Walk-In Clinic Services Emergency Room Services Laboratory Services - testing blood, Urine Testing, Biopsy services Pharmacy Mental Health Services both in-patient and out-patient Ambulance Services Prenatal Services (I don't remember them all but these are the most important) Without knowing what your employer plan looks like meaning What does it cost per pay period and what would you pay per pay period What is the Deductible on that plan and what is the Max Out of Pocket Expense on that plan ... is the ESI going to cost you more than 9.07% of your income? ...is the ESI plan just an HSA plan? I like BIG HUGE examples to make a point. Let us assume that your ESI plan reads something like this Yearly Deductible: 10,000 Yearly Max Out of Pocket Expense: \$15,000... You get injured, you get transported by ambulance, to the ER then to Surgery, then to a recovery room, then 5 nights in a hospital with physical therapy, medications, etc...and the total amount owed to the hospital and providers on the day of discharge is \$2 Million. If you were enrolled in the ESI plan, the MOST you pay is \$15,000. Everything else is covered at 100%, you are only responsible for \$15,000. - if the same thing happened again just 4 months later or 2 months later, the total expense you would need to pay is \$0. More information is needed to guide you."

↳ (0): "Non of OPs post makes any sense. They are fishing for upvotes."

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1owfr9u/>

↳ (0): "Two reasons you might not be seeing subsidies on ACA plans: * your annual income is too low, or you entered it incorrectly. Your annual income must be over the poverty line to be eligible for subsidies * you answered the questions about employer coverage incorrectly, and you're not seeing subsidies because the application believes you have affordable employer coverage available"

↳ (0): "Can you expand on the international bit? That might change things quite a bit"

↳ (0): "The baby will be born there, but it will be a US citizen after some paperwork. My partner and I are both US citizens."

"Senator King continued: "I don't understand the obsession and I never have...with taking health insurance away from people. I don't get it. Trying to take away the Affordable Care Act in 2017 or 2018 and now this. What's driving this? What's the cruelty to do this, to take health insurance away from people knowing that it's going to cost them...up to and including...their lives.""

— r/obamacare · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0y85an/

Retiring early or working for themselves · 30 documents

"It's a Catch-22. I need medical care to stay alive, but I need a W-2 job for high quality affordable medical care, but the job's killing me. I'm in my 40's, and I could afford to retire now if not for the health insurance issue. An ACA family plan is ridiculously expensive and all but the platinum plans are dog 🐕 (high premiums, very high deductibles, very high max OOP, and limited networks that don't cover the halfway decent docs and hospitals in my area). And the platinums are INSANELY expensive and still don't cover many of my needed specialists. And I can't build my HSA as I max out contributions and spending every year. I think my only hope is to try to find a super easy job (even if super low paying) with good benefits and see if I can survive another 7 years until our kids are all off the plan and my husband (self-employed) qualifies for Medicare. Or 5 years if I pay for COBRA for the last 2 years..."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pJR3wIGOZsc&lc=Ugwc78xLI9v1PhI6QR4AaABAg>

"Is it beneficial to slightly overestimate projected income, to avoid possibly having to pay back subsidies at tax return time? I am trying to get ready to pull the trigger and retire at 62.5 years old. I plan to calculate my income from my Roth IRA (and a tiny part time job). Is it safer to slightly overestimate my income when signing up for ACA, to hopefully avoid the potential of having to pay back anything if I go over what I projected?"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/

↳ Low-Jury-3586 (7): "When you apply, it asks how much of the credit you want to use and you enter the dollar amount. I use only half. Then when I file my taxes, this gets reconciled and I receive the balance of the unused credit. This then helps pay the new year of premiums. Like you, I don't want to worry about any overpayments so I'm more comfortable doing it this way."

↳ CoveredStrangle (7): "You can do Roth conversions from your regular traditional IRA (or 401k)... into your Roth IRA. This Roth conversion amount will count towards your MAGI and help you qualify for ACA."

↳ GlitteringSwan8024 (5): "I estimated my income for 2025 within \$1200 of what it actually was and I still owe \$680! Very frustrating. I can easily pay it but there are probably people who can't. I don't understand how my subsidy amount was of by \$54 per month. I absolutely would overestimate, wish I would have done it for 2026."

"Always been that way. I have had multiple jobs over the decades. Sometimes I hit the jackpot and get great coverage, then I have years of useless healthcare coverage. Those years I get the basic bloodwork and X-rays on my own dime (literally I am paying the preventative care). The issue now is after a lifetime of work I want to retire. How do I get covered for the 60-65 gap? ACA is "limited coverage", almost criminal costs. This countries needs a generational shakeup."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o4ov1l/aca_plans_not_accepted_by_leading_hospitals_and/nj43xoe/

A plan they can actually use · 20 documents

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pcor72/>

↳ (0): "We need basic universal healthcare."

↳ (0): "Yup. I'm in a similar boat. My insurance for my family went from \$800 to \$2700. I basically opted out. I can't afford it. Many many more Americans are hurting too. Stay strong."

↳ (0): "If anybody is in the boat where they find themselves not being able to afford it (absolutely no shame here.) Please try to still look for a catastrophic plan that covers emergencies. It's only going to cover emergencies and nothing else after deductible is met."

"ACA not very affordable anymore ACA is not really affordable without the extra subsidy, but California fines you 100 per month for not having it. It's not really fair to fine people who truly can't afford it. I work front desk hotel. The cheapest plan for me is 200 per month. I have to pay 100% out of pocket until I reach 7200 for the year. Just 2 visits to the dermatologist is costing me 1400 on top of the 200 I already pay. If I want something with normal co-pays, it's going to cost me 400 per month. I make between 45K-50K, but the cost of living is so high in California that there isn't much left for stuff like health insurance. It's really not fair that California fines you at this point when the premiums have literally doubled in price. It's very frustrating."

— r/obamacare · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/

↳ discoduck007 (28): "Thank you BBB (Big Billionaires Bonus)"

↳ Mysterious-Art8838 (18): "I completely empathize re the cost but I still think it's worth having. I absolutely have to have it because I have a serious illness. I'm 44f. My monthly is \$605 and my deductible is 12k which I will probably hit after a hospital visit last month. It completely sucks but not having it would suck 1000x more. As it is I try so hard to stay out of the hospital. Last week I collapsed in an urgent care because I waited too long to get help. Thankfully it's attached to a hospital so they called a code blue on me and brought me over lickity split. But I was focused on how much it would cost and whether I could get through it myself, not what I reasonably should have been considering. When I was on the floor of the hospital staring at the ceiling I was thinking oops. Guess I let this go too far. But I try hard to avoid it because it's so freggin expensive. That same visit I left AMA because it's so much more expensive if they admit me."

↳ Florida1974 (16): "So very true. The first guy I fell in love with, he died when he was 36 years old. He kept going to the hospital because of a severe sore throat. They would give him antibiotics and send him home. Months later, they finally caved and did more testing and he had stage four throat cancer. And he died. There was nothing they could do because it was so far advanced. I had they done that test to begin with, it might be different. I am married and we moved 1200 miles away and one day I happen to look at the obituaries, which I never do, from back home. I told my husband about it that night and his jaw fell. Turns out when I was dating this guy, my would be husband was teaching him how to paint houses on the weekends. My husband is eight years older than we were. But we were together for probably 10 years before we realize this. Still gives me chills. But it's so sad that he died, he had young kids back then. So yes, they do let you die."

"I am with you. Cancelled my ACA plan. Went from \$750 to \$2150 a month for my wife and I, and that is from a Gold plan to a crappy bronze plan with \$10K deductible. They can bite me."

— r/obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qil7n2/my_premium_went_from_200_to_1500_and_now/o0sa18a/

Not needing care this year · 19 documents

"Georgia - just got my estimate on rate increase. Guess I'll be doing without. I've been using Ambetter for a few years with a few hiccups but overall it worked. Make around 23k per year. Had a Silver plan for around \$150.00. Just got my notice via the GA marketplace. Similar plan that no longer includes the vision and dental I had in the old plan, will be \$479.00. Guess I'll be doing without this year and hope for the best. Multiple health issues and prescriptions. Can't get Medicaid here. Welcome to the new world."

— r/HealthInsurance · 82 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oh2fva/>

↳ (0): "Call your representative! This is what the shutdown is about!"

↳ (0): "I've already sent letters to them. For all the good it will do at this point."

↳ (0): "Make an appointment to see them."

"I work a conventional job. I have no benefits and cannot afford insurance without subsidies. I will go without and pray I don't get sick or hurt. Seriously feels like playing a reverse lottery."

— r/obamacare · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lp1un7/if_the_bbb_passes_and_the_aca_is_gutted_what_are/n0rlux/

"I'm two years away from Medicare age and self employed. I have a bronze HSA policy this year with an \$8k deductible. I pay \$750 a month with the subsidy....the premium is \$1500. I won't qualify for subsidiaries next year either and I'm afraid to see what the premium will be. I'll probably just drop health insurance until I qualify for medicare and hope nothing happens. 🙄 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh6uh41/

Making it to 65 and Medicare · 10 documents

"Excellent video!! I retired early and I'm 62 and on the ACA. My biggest concern right now is the current administration is trying to kill the ACA. I have 3 years left until Medicare and feel really vulnerable. I feel like I'm living on a hope and a prayer until 65. Keep the great content coming!!!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugx20_ft51xWWyopGPR4AaABAg

↳ @janetmartin9372 (2): "No. The previous administration added additional subsidies in 2021 and 2023 on top of the original aca. They scheduled them to expire end of 2025. Why should middle income people pay subsidies to higher income people to help them pay their health insurance? We are back to regular aca and there is help for those up to 400 percent of poverty level."

"I completely disagree on ACA being the #1 best option. If you have no pre-existing conditions, your best option is the private insurance market. ACA would have cost me [alone] over \$2,000 per month for a high deductible plan (my income necessary to make ends meet exceeds eligibility for any ACA subsidy). COBRA was going to cost me over \$1,500 per month and would only last for 18 months (I need 21 months to make it to Medicare age). Solution? I found health insurance in the private marketplace for...now get this...\$750 per month. Even better? My maintenance prescriptions have a \$0 copay and my office visit copay is less than when I was working! I'm laughing all the way to the bank now!"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=Ugz_xhwD-Z5OHxsqwgB4AaABAg

↳ @betoxyz68 (1): "You are absolutely correct! There are excellent private insurance options available in most states with very competitive rates similar to yours. Great job on doing your due diligence and exploring all the options that fit your specific circumstances. It's always smart to look at the full picture before deciding."

↳ @detroitgator1 (1): "Please share how you figured this out. I need to go about 5 years on private insurance"

↳ @betoxyz68 (1): "@detroitgator1im a health insurance agent and licensed in multiple states."

"I don't know what we will do, we have the Silver plan at 700 a month and a 12 000 deductible. My husband is a retired firefighter and I retired from the school system early to take care of my mom because nursing home care is terrible. At 63 years old just trying to hang on until Medicare age. My husband still works doing tile work to supplement his pension. Adding up our cost for insurance including home, cars etc we almost pay 1500 month for what it's. Gotta have it aa my husband has had a couple blood clots. Kinda worried to be honest."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh72uuz/

Health care that isn't tied to a job · 6 documents

"Paxlovid \$1600? Anthem ACA in Indiana is pretty terrible -- the cheap "negotiated rate" for 5 days of the anti-COVID medication paxlovid is nearly \$1600. I'm skipping it since I can't afford it even with the \$1000 one-time use coupon from Pfizer. The whole year has been basically Anthem denying all my medications or offering a price that's way higher than those weird "discount cards" like GoodRx. Pretty terrible. Anyone else angry yet are ready for actual universal health care? I retired early and this is literally the only insurance plan available to me in my state. These insurance company scammers and big pharma scammers need to be fixed. Things are getting unsustainable. I understand that there's an active movement to dismantle and destroy ACA without any replacement, so that's part of the problem, but really we need actual universal healthcare and to tear down the existing scam organizations."

— r/HealthInsurance · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj8crd/paxlovid_1600/

↳ Bogg99 (20): "The same drug manufacturers sell these drugs in other countries for significantly less money. There was a piece of legislation that would cap drugs developed in the US for being sold here for more money than other countries. It would have single handedly saved Medicaid/Medicare billions of dollars. Republicans voted against it."

↳ Turbulent-Pay1150 (18): "No anger with the drug manufacturer who set the price?"

↳ The_Derpy_Walrus (15): "Health history plays no role in ACA insurance plans."

"Dang if only we had some Medicare for all"

— r/obamacare · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uqz4tb/how_much_and_why_aca_marketplace_premiums_are/owc0j14/

"We need Medicare-For-All/A single payer healthcare system here in the United States, especially during this time with the Coronavirus pandemic! What is more "Pro-Life" than ensuring that every person in America has guaranteed affordable healthcare regardless of their job or social status? Also, if we all had access to basic healthcare, we would all have the "freedom" to live long lives and rarely have to worry about medical bankruptcies. Sure, taxes will go up, but the overall cost will go down so much that everyone will be paying less and saving thousands of dollars every year. Furthermore, if some of us need additional healthcare than Medicare, then we have the "choice" to get additional insurance, but for others Medicare would be more than enough. Finally, if every other developed country (Canada, Germany, the United Kingdom, France, Italy, Sweden, Norway, Denmark, the Netherlands, Switzerland, Japan, South Korea, Australia, and New Zealand) can implement this system and save money, then why can't the United States do the same and help "Make America Great Again" for everybody at least on the issue of healthcare? Oh, and if American citizens die from lacking access to affordable health insurance because the Republicans believe that the government shouldn't provide it then we are failing our country's promise of defending "life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness" for its citizens as well as "promoting the general welfare" of all the people."

— YouTube · Health Insurance After Quitting Your Job · 18 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2xGHnufEwvs&lc=UgzfpC1om_phraxD0B4AaABAg

↳ @DoubleDown310 (2): "Why would they do that, when they can squeeze every penny out of every single American?"

↳ @dvran (1): "Americans wanted capitalism; here you go. Greedy healthcare companies making shareholders happy, large corporations taking over ... it's all to make more billionaires."

↳ @BeatTheBush (1): "@momosan11 I wish but I don't see that happening any time soon. Reform is hard when you have such an ingrained system that will have big money behind to resist it."

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Theme	Documents
A spouse's job or health deciding the coverage	79
Children on the plan, or left off it	77
Marriage, divorce and filing status changing the price	45
Parents: aging off their plan, helping them, or being helped	14
Pregnancy and a new baby	8

A spouse's job or health deciding the coverage · 79 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om828r/>

↳ (0): "Premiums just went through the roof! Judging by estimated cost increases and comparing to what we've been paying ... yeah, I'd say that's about right. I would definitely call someone tho!"

↳ (0): "Welcome to the new normal. Pay or die"

↳ (0): "In America it's 'pay and still die'."

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1h8c09l/>

↳ (0): "The US is the only country that ties your health insurance to your job. That alone is stunning. Then .. the decision whether you get care or not is made by a for-profit corporation. That is unacceptable."

↳ (0): "Yup! Hurricane Helene hit and my doctors in Sylvia and Asheville were unreachable. Called UHC and was told I could go south into GA (out of state) for the remainder of my pregnancy and it to worry about a thing. This was wonderful as the doctors in GA were only 30 mins away compared to the 4-8 hour, 200+ mile round trip they had me doing. That was on October 2nd, I called the GA doctor immediately and was told the soonest they could get me in was October 29th at 7am so I waited, I also scheduled a ride through UHC via 'motiv care' because i can't drive. October 28th, 6:15pm. UHC calls me to tell me that they were unable to secure me a ride and that they would pay for the gas. Very useful for someone who doesn't drive, and only gave me less than 12 hours (less really since you know most people aren't awake at night) to find an alternative ride. At this point I haven't seen anyone since September... My husband was able to get time off work to drive me (thank god). I got the the office and told me it was \$600 and my insurance wasn't going to cover it. I assumed this was going to be one of those call to straighten things out so I called UHC while in the lobby. It was then, and ONLY then.. did UHC inform me that my ability to go out of state for care had a time limit which was October 21st, 8 days short of the soonest the doctor could see me. They failed to both notify me or the doctors office about this. My baby has a chance to have Down syndrome and lacking 2 months of care already was hard enough and putting my baby at risk, I then asked what to do, where to go and what doctor I could see. UHC told me repeatedly to 'just go to the ER' over and over again. Refusing to do anything else despite the fact that going to the ER would do absolutely NOTHING. I returned home having panic attacks and had to rest. I woke up and called back again demanding that they either withhold their verbal contract OR have me see a doctor in NC that isn't in a disaster zone or have me go through one. There is not a single doctor in WNC that I can see, they verbally confirmed this. They also confirmed that indeed, no one from UHC informed anyone about the first end date for 'out of state care'. The agent informed me I would get a case manager and that it would likely be simple as extending the prior approval. BUT because it was filed in a grievance report, it would possibly take up to 30 days to get a reply.. this was October 29th, 2 months without seeing anyone and now forced to wait longer. I called weekly and got no update and told to wait. None of my begging and pleading over for fact that at that time I was 8 months going on 9 months changed anything. I then by a miracle had my Asheville doctor pop up who was doing special ultrasounds to look for physical check marks say I had an appointment on the 21st of November and I took it and was able to get a ride. At that point my baby was not doing so great, small abdomen and needed to be induced soon. But without knowing WHERE, I decided to schedule another ultra sound on December 4th to see if he would slip off the growth chart or improve and give UHC time to tell me where I was going.. NOVEMBER 27th, I received my update. My update? Nothing, if you want to go out of state have your primary care provider to recommend an out of service provider. I had to ask numerous times because my brain broke about this.. That I was previously approved That I have no doctor in my area that aren't in a disaster zone But they needed me to do the leg work to get seen at 9 months pregnant with 1 week, less than 5 business days to figure it out. Best they could do was file another grievance report that would take another 30 days... Called my pcp asap and got them to work on getting the referral UHC apparently 'needed' and I also called my pregnancy advocate who would call UHC herself and see if she could help. My pcp got the referral in on December 4th. My ultrasound showed my baby was stunted in growth and needed induction asap. My pregnancy advocate was able to get a hold of UHC care management team who was helping

set up for GA and assured me they were going to get me in there. December 5th. I was denied the ability to go to the doctor in GA that was 30 mins away because I needed to be induced so soon and they refused to induce unless they got to see me first before hand leaving an availability next week, way too late. So onto the next option. Sylvia, 2 1/2 hours away. They also denied me because they haven't seen my since September.... So my pregnancy advocate who was working with the UHC care management team told me that my only option now. Was to drive 4 1/2 hours to downtown Asheville to give birth... to just show up and tell them you're here to induce and you'll be taken care of.... And that the UHC management would call me to ensure transportation. UHC never reached out. I had to figure out how to get a 4 1/2 hours drive on my own in less than 24 hours... I got a ride to the hospital, got there and was told .. who are you? Why are you here? Who sent you? We don't have any rooms? Had to wait 3 hours to finally get situated into a room... Still here and working on popping this baby but the amount of stress, panic and tears I had to go through because UHC refused to get off their lazy ass and put my baby at risk was not fun. — — — Also to add, I had a driver from motiv care got a speeding ticket while I was in the car, have the car break down in front of my house and under UHC direction had it towed after two weeks with no one reaching out.. Then had the driver threaten my life if I didn't get his car back that night.. it took 9 hours of me having panic attacks and crying my eyes out for them to go beyond just filing a grievance report. I was 6 months pregnant at the time. Another time I had to drive in a car, 5 months pregnant for 6 hours round trip with a driver who's entire car reeked of marijuana. When on my return ride it was obvious it freshly smoked... Filed a report and UHC and motiv care told me they couldn't say for sure if it was the driver or a previous rider so nothing would be done...."

↳ (0): "Commenting here for visibility of your comment because this has left me absolutely speechless. Imaging pushing paper in a DISASTER. What the actual fuck? I am so sorry!!"

"I'm terrified of losing my Obamacare I'm a one issue voter. I want to keep my Obamacare. Having this allowed me and my husband to quit our terrible soul sucking jobs and start small businesses. It's not perfect and it costs a lot but it's been a life saver. Literally. Now that you know what happened, will I have to get another horrible job that destroys my will to live just to have health insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,425 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1gkt285/>

↳ (0): "Same boat here. We run a small business that employs four people, my husband is a working owner, I do the books. I also do freelance bookkeeping part time for two other businesses. I left a high stress job on the doctor's recommendation. It had no benefits anyway. We are in a tiny town, not many jobs here, much less with benefits. Plus I'm 60 years old with a chronic health condition. Husband has rheumatoid arthritis. Without our ACA plan we are done. Premium would be \$3074 a month non subsidised price. I could foresee us closing the business and putting people out of work so my husband can seek a job with benefits. I'm sorry this is not the way America is supposed to work."

↳ (0): "I would say that anyone who has signed up for a 2025 plan is probably grandfathered in simply because it is ingrained in the health care system so much at this point. By the time Trump is taking office, people's new plans for the year will have already started and even they know the chaos it would cause to try to cancel things immediately. So I'm guessing that for the 2025 year anything that anyone gets for pretty much stay as is. After that however well, we know what they want to do. Speaker Johnson has said as well as several Republican senators that their main goal or at least one of their main goals is to get rid of the ACA. In the past when they tried it, ultimately the supreme Court stopped them telling them they didn't have the authority to do it. The only thing the supreme Court in the past sided with them on was repealing the mandate that required everyone to get a plan to help pay for the system. Everything else they left intact. Since that time however, Trump has put four of his own people in the supreme Court. So I can't imagine they would not side with him now when they approach them about this. The fact that Republicans gained two seats in the Senate and now will have control of the Senate only heightens the possibility that this is going to happen. So again, I think 2025 might be pretty much as is, but after that I would expect sweeping negative changes to health care in this country. No more ACA. A great reduction in the number of people they allow to qualify for Medicaid, etc. The unfortunate thing is even after 4 years and he's gone, he will have put so many people in high position places, this stuff will go on for decades after he's gone. Welcome to the new America folks."

↳ (0): "I'm extremely worried about this because I will lose access to mental health medications that keep me alive and sane. Please, if anyone has any advice or insight on how to keep access to the mental health medications i desperately need please let me know. I am terrified this is going to actually kill me."

Children on the plan, or left off it · 77 documents

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1h8c09l/>

↳ (0): "The US is the only country that ties your health insurance to your job. That alone is stunning. Then .. the decision whether you get care or not is made by a for-profit corporation. That is unacceptable."

↳ (0): "Yup! Hurricane Helene hit and my doctors in Sylvia and Asheville were unreachable. Called UHC and was told I could go south into GA (out of state) for the remainder of my pregnancy and it to worry about a thing. This was wonderful as the doctors in GA were only 30 mins away compared to the 4-8 hour, 200+ mile round trip they had me doing. That was on October 2nd, I called the GA doctor immediately and was told the soonest they could get me in was October 29th at 7am so I waited, I also scheduled a ride through UHC via 'motiv care' because i can't drive. October 28th, 6:15pm. UHC calls me to tell me that they were unable to secure me a ride and that they would pay for the gas. Very useful for someone who doesn't drive, and only gave me less than 12 hours (less really since you know most people aren't awake at night) to find an alternative ride. At this point I haven't seen anyone since September... My husband was able to get time off work to drive me (thank god). I got the the office and told me it was \$600 and my insurance wasn't going to cover it. I assumed this was going to be one of those call to straighten things out so I called UHC while in the lobby. It was then, and ONLY then.. did UHC inform me that my ability to go out of state for care had a time limit which was October 21st, 8 days short of the soonest the doctor could see me. They failed to both notify me or the doctors office about this. My baby has a chance to have Down syndrome and lacking 2 months of care already was hard enough and putting my baby at risk, I then asked what to do, where to go and what doctor I could see. UHC told me repeatedly to 'just go to the ER' over and over again. Refusing to do anything else despite the fact that going to the ER would do absolutely NOTHING. I returned home having panic attacks and had to rest. I woke up and called back again demanding that they either withhold their verbal contract OR have me see a doctor in NC that isn't in a disaster zone or have me go through one. There is not a single doctor in WNC that I can see, they verbally confirmed this. They also confirmed that indeed, no one from UHC informed anyone about the first end date for 'out of state care'. The agent informed me I would get a case manager and that it would likely be simple as extending the prior approval. BUT because it was filed in a grievance report, it would possibly take up to 30 days to get a reply.. this was October 29th, 2 months without seeing anyone and now forced to wait longer. I called weekly and got no update and told to wait. None of my begging and pleading over for fact that at that time I was 8 months going on 9 months changed anything. I then by a miracle had my Asheville doctor pop up who was doing special ultrasounds to look for physical check marks say I had an appointment on the 21st of November and I took it and was able to get a ride. At that point my baby was not doing so great, small abdomen and needed to be induced soon. But without knowing WHERE, I decided to schedule another ultra sound on December 4th to see if he would slip off the growth chart or improve and give UHC time to tell me where I was going.. NOVEMBER 27th, I received my update. My update? Nothing, if you want to go out of state have your primary care provider to recommend an out of service provider. I had to ask numerous times because my brain broke about this.. That I was previously approved That I have no doctor in my area that aren't in a disaster zone But they needed me to do the leg work to get seen at 9 months pregnant with 1 week, less than 5 business days to figure it out. Best they could do was file another grievance report that would take another 30 days... Called my pcp asap and got them to work on getting the referral UHC apparently 'needed' and I also called my pregnancy advocate who would call UHC herself and see if she could help. My pcp got the referral in on December 4th. My ultrasound showed my baby was stunted in growth and needed induction asap. My pregnancy advocate was able to get a hold of UHC care management team who was helping

set up for GA and assured me they were going to get me in there. December 5th. I was denied the ability to go to the doctor in GA that was 30 mins away because I needed to be induced so soon and they refused to induce unless they got to see me first before hand leaving an availability next week, way too late. So onto the next option. Sylvia, 2 1/2 hours away. They also denied me because they haven't seen my since September.... So my pregnancy advocate who was working with the UHC care management team told me that my only option now. Was to drive 4 1/2 hours to downtown Asheville to give birth... to just show up and tell them you're here to induce and you'll be taken care of.... And that the UHC management would call me to ensure transportation. UHC never reached out. I had to figure out how to get a 4 1/2 hours drive on my own in less than 24 hours... I got a ride to the hospital, got there and was told .. who are you? Why are you here? Who sent you? We don't have any rooms? Had to wait 3 hours to finally get situated into a room... Still here and working on popping this baby but the amount of stress, panic and tears I had to go through because UHC refused to get off their lazy ass and put my baby at risk was not fun. — — — Also to add, I had a driver from motiv care got a speeding ticket while I was in the car, have the car break down in front of my house and under UHC direction had it towed after two weeks with no one reaching out.. Then had the driver threaten my life if I didn't get his car back that night.. it took 9 hours of me having panic attacks and crying my eyes out for them to go beyond just filing a grievance report. I was 6 months pregnant at the time. Another time I had to drive in a car, 5 months pregnant for 6 hours round trip with a driver who's entire car reeked of marijuana. When on my return ride it was obvious it freshly smoked... Filed a report and UHC and motiv care told me they couldn't say for sure if it was the driver or a previous rider so nothing would be done...."

↳ (0): "Commenting here for visibility of your comment because this has left me absolutely speechless. Imaging pushing paper in a DISASTER. What the actual fuck? I am so sorry!!"

"My health insurance just went to \$60,000 a year for a silver PPO Prepare for sticker shock. Just checked the IL exchange today, and my BCBS HDHP went from \$1200 a month after subsidies to \$2925 after subsidies (**the plan cost is 60k per year**) the reasons for this are two-fold 1. Expiration of enhanced subsidies 2. The site allowing junk insurers to claim SLC status (benchmark) with plans no one can use. For my area it is an OSCAR HMO which virtually no hospital system or doctor accepts. OSCAR has a 1 star rating from the BBB and dozens of lawsuits against it for failure to pay claims. so I now have to hunt around for a HMO, and my family will lose its doctors. The PPACA as originally passed prevented insurance premiums from eating up more than a certain percentage of your annual income. At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments so I will lose my doctor(s) at the very least and pay way beyond what the law said I was going to. pretty sure I am seeing why some politicians are saying we should tear up the PPACA altogether, because it clearly isn't working, and made a bad situation worse"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,000 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1okz6n1/>

↳ (0): "OP didn't ask for guidance or request any answers. Locking before it spirals even further. Edit: Just to address OP's misguided frustration over the PPACA: In 2021, the Biden administration introduced *enhanced advanced premium tax credits* (eAPTCs) through the American Rescue Plan Act. They were further extended through the Inflation Reduction Act. Through these eAPTCS, folks beyond 400% of the federal poverty level could guarantee they'd spend no more than 8.5% of their household income on health insurance premiums through Marketplace (provided they chose a silver benchmark plan). The reason your subsidies are falling flat is because these enhanced subsidies are not being renewed. This is reason number one behind the government shutdown. One side wants to make these eAPTCs permanent. I'll let you deduce who that is. The PPACA didn't "make a bad situation worse". The current majority party has worked tirelessly to make it worse."

↳ (0): "Wait, how is \$2,925 per month \$60,000 per year?"

↳ (0): "Seems insurance going up regardless of subsidies"

"My daughter is a surg/tech student. The doctor stuck her with a needle during a procedure. My daughter has insurance but not for that hospital. Now she owes \$1800 for getting treated at the hospital where she got stuck. Not sure what to do. My daughter is a surgical tech student. During one of her procedures in February, the doctor accidentally stuck her with a dirty needle. The doctor told her to go down to the triage so she could get the proper care for sticks, which included a blood test (plus a follow-up test 2 weeks later). My daughter has healthcare thru the government (Obamacare, basically). She got a bill from her teaching hospital for her medical care for \$1800. Her insurance is denying it because she isn't covered at the hospital where she works. What should she do? This is such an unusual situation, and I can't find advice anywhere (other than 'call an attorney', which would cost more than the \$1800). Suggestions? (on a good note, the patient was tested for any diseases and came back clean, so no worries on that front)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 929 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jpk09o/>

↳ (0): "The facility where the injury took place should cover it. If they somehow don't it needs to be appealed as urgent/emergent care and the insurance company will pay. A needle stick with a known dirty needle is an emergency. Out of network is normally waived for urgent emergent care."

↳ (0): "Any recommendation on who specifically (department?) to target on this? Seems everyone wants to pass the buck. I'd love to call someone and say "This is your problem to solve""

↳ (0): "Back when I was a medical student at a teaching hospital, needle-stick injuries were covered by the OSHA department of the hospital."

Marriage, divorce and filing status changing the price · 45 documents

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pff3oz/>

↳ (0): "FYI if you get married you get a special enrollment and can enroll her right away."

↳ (0): "This is what my partner and I are doing. We are marrying tomorrow actually, so we can have me enrolled on his health insurance for the new year. My coverage is going up over \$200 with higher deductible and higher co-pays. It's a bit sad that we are "forced" into marriage, when we could have planned a nice elopement with close friends and family, instead of a quick courthouse wedding. Good luck, you aren't the only one dealing with this."

↳ (0): "Getting Married is a life changing event. It opens enrollment and you can get her on instantly."

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

↳ bourbonfan1647 (68): "Elections have consequences. None of this is a surprise. Welcome to the "find out" phase..."

↳ Stop-Looking_For_Me (48): "Well here it is. The numbers don't lie. Healthcare is going to be fun next year for everyone."

↳ Redtoolbox1 (41): "But the billionaires got their tax cuts they so desperately needed 🍌"

"My premium just went up 1500% Posting again because mods removed it since I guess I didn't use the right flair originally I don't know what to do. It's now higher than my mortgage. It is literally impossible for me to pay for now. I won't have insurance anymore starting on the 1st. I have a ton of medication that I need to function. I'm scared Age 36 State Arkansas Income 30k a year Household size of 3. Partner recently laid off. Not married. All my info is updated through the marketplace. The cheapest thing they suggested is \$500. The bill I received for next month is \$744. I rounded up in the comments to \$800 because it's basically the same thing. My Medicaid coverage was \$48 before hand. Someone whose comment is no longer visible said they were happy my premiums went up because they think I voted for Trump. Trump is an evil person and I would rather die than vote for him. Leftists exist in Arkansas. Sorry your stereotypes are incorrect Do only republicans comment on this subreddit or something? Why is everyone treating me like a liar?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 416 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/>

↳ (0): "[Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is telling me that a single 36 year old in Arkansas making \$30,000/year is eligible for \$590/month in tax credits for 2026. That covers all but a few pennies/month in premiums on multiple bronze plans. Even the best GOLD plans would be well under \$100/month in premiums. Like \$40-80/month. Something isn't right with this post or we need more info about household size and income, etc."

↳ (0): "Please list the rates of what premium you paid before, and what it will be in 2026, and how many people in the household (single, 2, etc.). Right now, it reads like you're a single household making \$30K, which is too much to lose credits due to being someone who's supposed to apply for Medicaid, and too low to lose subsidies due to being more than 400% of the fpl. And those are the main ways you'd see that kind of jump, is if you lost all subsidies, and it sounds unlikely that you did."

↳ (0): "What were your premiums before, and what would they be after the increase? Is your insurance through an employer or the Marketplace? What about subsidies? For what it's worth, you're not alone. My husband is a retired state employee, and we're too young for Medicare. Our premiums for the two of us through the state retirement system are \$3,900 a month, up \$1,200 a month from last year. The state only kicks in \$200/month. Between premiums and deductibles, we'll be paying well over \$55,000 a year before insurance even kicks in. But we don't have a choice. I'm chronically ill, and my husband was diagnosed with leukemia last year. Like they say, you're well until you're not. Are your meds available in generics? There are a few options for less expensive generics...."

Parents: aging off their plan, helping them, or being helped · 14 documents

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnyycy/>

↳ (0): "I hope everyone making these posts are also calling their senators and representatives. They may not respond but they do track constituent issues/concerns."

↳ (0): "...and don't forget to VOTE!!!"

↳ (0): "I just wish we had at least one party running on universal healthcare to vote for."

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

↳ Stomoyuki (49): "Medicaid eligibility limits your access to Marketplace subsidies, which is why [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is telling you to apply for Medicaid. My first question is why the out-of-state hospitals won't "accept" PA Medicaid. Medicaid generally provides limited out-of-state coverage, so are they looking for something beyond basic coverage for yourself? Also, you're probably not the first student in your school encountering this issue. I'd contact the student affairs/financial aid office and ask them what they recommend in your situation. They may provide hardship resources you can utilize."

↳ emacsGuy (30): "Thanks for the replies, but I think I'm just going to sign up with PA State Medicaid. They will cover life threatening ER out of state but nothing else. Which should be fine, I won't be out state maybe just 4 months max. I just hope I won't get hassled by some of the hospitals if asked. I'll just deal with it then."

↳ LizzieMac123 (13): "Healthcare.gov plan but you'll have to pay full price with no income if you're not allowed to have out of state medicaid in your program."

"Just don't know what to do. Hey all. My husband and I are both self-employed. Currently, I'm still under 26 and on my parents' plan, though not for much longer. My husband is currently uninsured. We don't qualify for any subsidies, as our income is just over the 400% FPL limit. Despite this, we still live paycheck to paycheck as is, due to living in a high-cost of living area. Packing up and moving isn't really an option, as both of our businesses are based here. We simply can't afford to fork over hundreds to thousands of dollars each month for an ACA compliant plan. I've considered non-ACA, but everyone on this sub seems to think it's a terrible idea and they won't cover anything. At this point I'm just at a loss and don't know what to do. I worry about my husband being uninsured, and I'm considering giving up my business and getting a job that can provide us with insurance, though I really don't want to. Any advice is appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wfnwua/just_dont_know_what_to_do/

↳ Poop_Dolla (15): "Do you have an accountant? Are you certain you're taking advantage of all your write offs for your business? In my opinion you have two options if you want a marketplace ACA plan, you can attempt to get your gross income under the threshold by contributing to retirement plans and making sure your deductions are all accounted for, or you can make more to cover the cost of an unsubsidized plan."

↳ katsrad (11): "Non-ACA isn't recommended if you have any pre-existing condition because you can be denied or they are just indemnity plans that pay a small set amount that won't cover the cost of the service. My advice is to look for employment that provides health insurance as a benefit."

↳ saysee23 (8): "Lots of people get jobs to provide insurance, maybe part time at Starbucks so you would not have to give up your business. Non-ACA isn't worth most of the time unless you really like to gamble with your family's health. You said you two "still" live paycheck to paycheck - the part-time or totally different job might help with this. it's never too often to reevaluate your budgets. The other comment about the CPA is a very good idea."

Pregnancy and a new baby · 8 documents

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1owfr9u/>

↳ (0): "Two reasons you might not be seeing subsidies on ACA plans: * your annual income is too low, or you entered it incorrectly. Your annual income must be over the poverty line to be eligible for subsidies * you answered the questions about employer coverage incorrectly, and you're not seeing subsidies because the application believes you have affordable employer coverage available"

↳ (0): "Can you expand on the international bit? That might change things quite a bit"

↳ (0): "The baby will be born there, but it will be a US citizen after some paperwork. My partner and I are both US citizens."

"Pregnant, called 20+ "in-network" OBs and none accept my plan, what actually works here? I really need advice from anyone who has dealt with marketplace insurance issues like this. I recently got laid off and lost my Aetna PPO. I enrolled through HealthCare.gov and now have WellPoint Essential Bronze POS 4500 (covers my husband, toddler, and me). I'm currently 4 weeks pregnant. My previous OB does not take this plan, and visits would be \$500 out of pocket, so I started trying to find a new provider. Here's everything I've done so far: \- Used the Sydney Health app and contacted customer service \- They emailed me a 14-page list with 52 providers within 20 miles I started calling down the list and got EIGHT (8) pages in. I have now called 20+ providers. Results: Most said they do NOT take my plan at all Some said they only take WellPoint Medicaid for pregnancy None accepted my specific marketplace plan At that point I called the member services number for WellPoint. I got transferred 3 times Finally reached someone who tried calling providers herself. It was late in the day, so offices didn't answer. She said she will call again tomorrow and try to schedule me with someone within 20 miles She also told me to report all the providers I contacted who don't actually accept my plan so they can update the directory Additional complication: \- I do NOT qualify for Texas STAR Medicaid for pregnant women because our income is about \$600 over the monthly limit, even including the unborn fetus \-I also do NOT qualify for CHIP perinatal because I already have marketplace insurance Even if I dropped my current plan to try for CHIP: It would only cover pregnancy, labor, and delivery. I have autoimmune conditions and take ongoing medications. I would lose access to the medications I need for daily functioning So that option doesn't really work for me either. Right now, I technically have insurance but I still have zero confirmed access to prenatal care What are my next steps? My mother-in-law suggested asking for a care coordinator or case manager. My father-in-law suggested requesting a gap exception so I can continue seeing my current OB but pay in-network costs instead of \$500 out of pocket, since the insurance has not provided usable in-network options. Questions: 1. Has anyone had success with a gap exception for pregnancy? 2. Did your insurance actually find you a provider, or did you have to escalate further? 3. Has anyone switched plans outside open enrollment due to something like this? 4. Is there a better way to find OBs that actually take this specific plan? I'm in the DFW, Texas area. I'm trying to stay calm since I'm early, but I know I need to get care lined up soon and this process has been exhausting. Any advice or experiences would help a lot"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1slok4v/>

↳ (0): "The insurance isnt going to agree to a network exception for your preferred provider. They would have to have the provider sign documents indicating they would agree to accept in network rates, and usually they wont proactively try to set that up unless the provider reaches out to them first. While the process exists, the likelihood of them approving it is extremely low. You can ask for a care manager or case manager. Thats a decent recommendation. They should be able to find you a provider that can actually treat you. Theres a good chance some of the providers were incorrect when they said they dont take marketplace plans, though its possible they were right and the insurance has an outdated directory, but 20 providers in a row seems unlikely. You wont be able to change your plan outside open enrollment. No better way other than contacting your insurance directly, unfortunately."

↳ (0): "Best advice here! Also OP - even *if* you could get your insurance to pay in-network rates (and you may be able to if for some reason there is in-fact no providers) - doing so doesn't prevent the provider from still balance-billing you what insurance doesn't pay due to the lack of contract."

↳ (0): "I would do both options. And also, I would report the insurance company and plan to your state Department of insurance. The insurance companies benefit from having fake doctors on their plans."

"My health insurance doesn't covers anything anymore. I paid \$900 a year for additional optical and dental on top of regular health insurance..... saved me \$50, on my glasses.... (still cost me \$760 for my glasses, but wouldn't cover a dime on contact lenses)..... Dental cost me \$1000 for 2 filings AFTER insurance coverage. Pregnancy cost me \$12,000 out of pocket. And My deductible was only \$100. But apparently it doesn't cover unnecessary things like "epidurals" x-rays, ultrasounds, tylenol.... Tylenol..... but if I have a heart attack at 30yo at least they'll cover that....."

— YouTube · How bad is it if I don't have health insurance? · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Rroep7t-6v8&lc=Ugzgw5hwzVwSih7SI-F4AaABAg>

↳ @Xelenteontae_ (1): "So they are just paying what you give them and pocket the rest and try to give as little as possible?"

↳ @RosannasFamilyZannazone_family (0): "@Xelenteontae_ Yesssss! For 6 years. I paid \$850 a month for health insurance, an additional \$75 a month for dental and vision. So, in total, I paid \$126,000 to health insurance. When I had my daughter she costed about \$35,000. \$12,000 wasn't covered,... So They made \$103,000 off of me (btw, I only made \$38K a year)..."

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

Theme	Documents
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What they were told about qualifying	10

What they were told about income and the subsidy · 24 documents

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/>

↳ (0): "We're in a similar situation. We pay over 20,000 a year for a high deductible plan on my husband's policy. We've explored alternatives, including purchasing coverage for me through the Marketplace; but our most "affordable" option is to stay on his plan because it is based on pre-taxed income. We've also tried the pay out of pocket approach, and I had a minor health emergency, which cost several thousand. We decided that going uninsured with little children is too risky."

↳ (0): "... I'm trying very hard not to erupt. 20k. I assume that your husband's plan is an employer plan based on how you framed this. So they are also paying thousands. I guess maybe it is reasonable if you have 50 kids. You do have 50 kids don't you? My ACA which is a decent hmo is \$6k a year for just me. Deductible is 12k and I can reasonably expect to hit it every year. After MUCH consternation they couldn't find a way to avoid paying for an rx for me that runs about 90k a year. I was on it with great results keeping me out of the hospital (mostly) for a year. Then they decided they approved it by mistake and canceled the approval. I got really sick after that and wound up hospitalized repeatedly which they paid tens of thousands for. So that was dumb. My dr did not like seeing me hospitalized repeatedly just to prove to insurance I'm sick so he started giving me pharma samples. We did that for 6 months. So 45k of shots. Eventually the rep said they couldn't keep doing it, which was my greatest fear. I knew it would happen I just didn't know when. It took another few months to get approved for the pharma's 'charity' program. So now they give me the drug for free. I live in constant fear of losing access. There is something very strange that I experienced when they first yanked the approvals where I knew I was going to get very sick and there was not much I could do because the drug was out of reach. I was literally planning to be much sicker. Family wants to see me for Tday and I'm like, well I'm probably going to be a whole lot sicker then, probably not doable to get on a plane. I don't spend much time feeling sorry for myself but I ABSOLUTELY think about a parent that has a child that needs a drug they simply can't afford, and so instead having to watch them struggle. The drug exists. We paid to develop it with tax dollars. We sell it abroad at a competitive price. But it's too expensive for a child in the US to benefit. This disgusts me. At some point, we will decide we have had enough of this system. But I wish we were a lot closer to that point than I think we are."

↳ (0): "1700/month here...basically same exact situation you are in. My wife is just like your husband. My employer pays for employee 100%, as soon as I add my family, wife, 2 kids....1700/month...vision, dental, included. Eastern PA. I've been fighting this for over 10 years with my employer. I love my job, but each year with this nonsense, it gets harder and harder to argue it's worth staying. My mortgage is 1300/month. Good luck, as all I have ever been told is get a new job."

"I thought the income considered for ACA would be income after we retire not total anticipate income for this year. Husband and I are retiring in July this year. I called health broker and was told our 2026 total income does not qualify us for subsidies this year. We can definitely control our MAGI next year. But the cost of health insurance without subsidies for this year is \$2,400 a month for bronze. Crazy"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 155 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgzvkYbzn16KYejn5LV4AaABAg>

↳ @Reanimator7336 (2): "If you work at all in retirement you are not retired."

↳ @TheUnRetired (0): "that is crazy - sorry! here's more about MAGI: https://youtu.be/KDE1jO1z3Sg?si=U8m89wRt_jEUXzMG";

↳ @Reanimator7336 (0): "ACA only goes by taxable income per year period. Its not what tax bracket you are in or gross income."

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

↳ Stomoyuki (49): "Medicaid eligibility limits your access to Marketplace subsidies, which is why [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is telling you to apply for Medicaid. My first question is why the out-of-state hospitals won't "accept" PA Medicaid. Medicaid generally provides limited out-of-state coverage, so are they looking for something beyond basic coverage for yourself? Also, you're probably not the first student in your school encountering this issue. I'd contact the student affairs/financial aid office and ask them what they recommend in your situation. They may provide hardship resources you can utilize."

↳ emacs guy (30): "Thanks for the replies, but I think I'm just going to sign up with PA State Medicaid. They will cover life threatening ER out of state but nothing else. Which should be fine, I won't be out state maybe just 4 months max. I just hope I won't get hassled by some of the hospitals if asked. I'll just deal with it then."

↳ LizzieMac123 (13): "Healthcare.gov plan but you'll have to pay full price with no income if youre not allowed to have out of state medicaid in your program."

What the marketplace told them · 20 documents

"My employer dropped me from health insurance About a year and a half ago I became eligible for health insurance at my new job (one of the reasons I accepted position was for the benefits). After about a month or so of coverage I was asked to come in for a meeting. Our insurance broker was there along with the director of operations. The broker explained that if I continued coverage my coworker's premiums would go up so high that no one could afford them. He said that they could no longer cover me and he would send in someone to help me sign up for coverage on the marketplace (which someone did). I questioned if all this was legal and was told that because their policy is under-written then, yes, it is legal for them to drop me. I should also add that I am a breast cancer survivor. I still get preventative treatment monthly at a local cancer center. It was after the first claim was submitted by the center that this all went down. Was this legal?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 206 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mvkoso/>

↳ (0): "Is the company paying for your marketplace premiums and is it the same level of coverage your company offers to the other employees, including deductibles, co-insurance, and co-pays? Do you have a copy of the company's policy where it says that cancer coverage is excluded? Does this company employ more than 50 people? Need more info to determine if it was legal or not. You might call your state's department of labor and ask."

↳ (0): "I would pay it then they would add the reimbursement to my paycheck. The coverage was similar. I only did it for a few months. I got married and I'm now on my husband's policy. Nowhere did I read that cancer was excluded. More than 50 people during peak seasons, less in the off season."

↳ (0): "If it has fewer than 50 full-time year-round employees it actually doesn't have to offer health insurance at all, but if they do they have to offer it to everyone. You were reimbursed for the premium and the coverage was similar to what the company offered. It sounds like they were doing the right thing for you while keeping costs down for the rest of the employees. Not a lawyer but I don't see anything illegal about it."

"Employer Won't Sign Me Up For Insurance Until Apr 2026 I started a new job today and I was talking to the HR rep about health insurance. She said that the OE period passed in Apr and I wouldn't be able to sign up again until next Apr. Cue me freaking out because I have conditions that need to be managed with meds. I pushed back because any job I worked at you were always allowed to enroll after the probation period. She said she has to check with I guess the insurance broker. She then told me since I'm losing my coverage at my previous job what going on COBRA, which I would think any HR rep would know how ridiculous of a question that is. I just want to make sure I'm right about them needing to allow me to enroll before Apr 2026. **UPDATE:** it is 90 days so I just have to hold out until Oct. HR rep is new and needs to learn the job better."

— r/HealthInsurance · 136 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1luih01/>

↳ (0): "If new job with a new company, then you have a qualifying event. The rep needs to provide you with details for you to enroll. Press them on this."

↳ (0): "The good news is that now you know that your HR contact is an idiot, and that their initial reaction to any request will be NO, rather than curiosity. Your situation is "employer-based health insurance 101". A new job is a qualifying event in any state."

↳ (0): "It's a qualifying event, but we also don't know when the employer stated that coverage begins when they sent out an offer letter. It is not out of the question for there to be a waiting period with no benefits on day 1. The question is what OP was told in the offer letter."

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the

worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

↳ (0): "Did they drop you because you didn't pay your deductible or because you didn't pay your premium? You say deductible, but the circumstances seem like you didn't pay your premium. The terminology really matters here. If you didn't pay your premium, yes, they will drop you, as will any insurance company. This is typically automatic, as are the letters that are generated to notify you of this. Just trying to get the facts straight. Without accurate facts, no one can provide accurate guidance."

↳ (0): "First, I don't suspect CareFirst would cancel your coverage because of a diagnosis. Granted, it might feel that way, but consider they'd cancel *all* policies for people with an expensive chronic condition following that logic. It was canceled for nonpayment, which you seemed to have remedied. Provided your retroactive payment was enough for reinstatement (and the reinstatement part is what's getting gummed up), you can take this to the VA Bureau of Insurance, as Marketplace plans are regulated at the state level: [<https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-a-n-insurance-complaint/>](<https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-an-insurance-complaint/>);

↳ (0): "automatic resolute arrest chase sip nail rain head treatment crawl *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home>)*";

What the broker or agent told them · 12 documents

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/>

↳ (0): "We're in a similar situation. We pay over 20,000 a year for a high deductible plan on my husband's policy. We've explored alternatives, including purchasing coverage for me through the Marketplace; but our most "affordable" option is to stay on his plan because it is based on pre-taxed income. We've also tried the pay out of pocket approach, and I had a minor health emergency, which cost several thousand. We decided that going uninsured with little children is too risky."

↳ (0): "... I'm trying very hard not to erupt. 20k. I assume that your husband's plan is an employer plan based on how you framed this. So they are also paying thousands. I guess maybe it is reasonable if you have 50 kids. You do have 50 kids don't you? My ACA which is a decent hmo is \$6k a year for just me. Deductible is 12k and I can reasonably expect to hit it every year. After MUCH consternation they couldn't find a way to avoid paying for an rx for me that runs about 90k a year. I was on it with great results keeping me out of the hospital (mostly) for a year. Then they decided they approved it by mistake and canceled the approval. I got really sick after that and wound up hospitalized repeatedly which they paid tens of thousands for. So that was dumb. My dr did not like seeing me hospitalized repeatedly just to prove to insurance I'm sick so he started giving me pharma samples. We did that for 6 months. So 45k of shots. Eventually the rep said they couldn't keep doing it, which was my greatest fear. I knew it would happen I just didn't know when. It took another few months to get approved for the pharma's 'charity' program. So now they give me the drug for free. I live in constant fear of losing access. There is something very strange that I experienced when they first yanked the approvals where I knew I was going to get very sick and there was not much I could do because the drug was out of reach. I was literally planning to be much sicker. Family wants to see me for Tday and I'm like, well I'm probably going to be a whole lot sicker then, probably not doable to get on a plane. I don't spend much time feeling sorry for myself but I ABSOLUTELY think about a parent that has a child that needs a drug they simply can't afford, and so instead having to watch them struggle. The drug exists. We paid to develop it with tax dollars. We sell it abroad at a competitive price. But it's too expensive for a child in the US to benefit. This disgusts me. At some point, we will decide we have had enough of this system. But I wish we were a lot closer to that point than I think we are."

↳ (0): "1700/month here...basically same exact situation you are in. My wife is just like your husband. My employer pays for employee 100%, as soon as I add my family, wife, 2 kids....1700/month...vision, dental, included. Eastern PA. I've been fighting this for over 10 years with my employer. I love my job, but each year with this nonsense, it gets harder and harder to argue it's worth staying. My mortgage is 1300/month. Good luck, as all I have ever been told is get a new job."

"I thought the income considered for ACA would be income after we retire not total anticipate income for this year. Husband and I are retiring in July this year. I called health broker and was told our 2026 total income does not qualify us for subsidies this year. We can definitely control our MAGI next year. But the cost of health insurance without subsidies for this year is \$2,400 a month for bronze. Crazy"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 155 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgzvkYbznI6KYejn5LV4AaABAg>

↳ @Reanimator7336 (2): "If you work at all in retirement you are not retired."

↳ @TheUnRetired (0): "that is crazy - sorry! here's more about MAGI: https://youtu.be/KDE1jO1z3Sg?si=U8m89wRt_jEUXzMG";

↳ @Reanimator7336 (0): "ACA only goes by taxable income per year period. Its not what tax bracket you are in or gross income."

"Employer Won't Sign Me Up For Insurance Until Apr 2026 I started a new job today and I was talking to the HR rep about health insurance. She said that the OE period passed in Apr and I wouldn't be able to sign up again until next Apr. Cue me freaking out because I have conditions that need to be managed with meds. I pushed back because any job I worked at you were always allowed to enroll after the probation period. She said she has to check with I guess the insurance broker. She then told me since I'm losing my coverage at my previous job what going on COBRA, which I would think any HR rep would know how ridiculous of a question that is. I just want to make sure I'm right about them needing to allow me to enroll before Apr 2026. **UPDATE:** it is 90 days so I just have to hold out until Oct. HR rep is new and needs to learn the job better."

— r/HealthInsurance · 136 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1luih01/>

↳ (0): "If new job with a new company, then you have a qualifying event. The rep needs to provide you with details for you to enroll. Press them on this."

↳ (0): "The good news is that now you know that your HR contact is an idiot, and that their initial reaction to any request will be NO, rather than curiosity. Your situation is "employer-based health insurance 101". A new job is a qualifying event in any state."

↳ (0): "It's a qualifying event, but we also don't know when the employer stated that coverage begins when they sent out an offer letter. It is not out of the question for there to be a waiting period with no benefits on day 1. The question is what OP was told in the offer letter."

What the plan or the office told them · 11 documents

"Am I misinterpreting my plan or is my insurance violating the ACA Two months ago I had my first annual gyno exam. A few days later I check my myChart and I have a 177.77 bill, which surprised me. I check my BCBS member portal and the EOB. They both say the total was 336, a discount was applied, plan paid 0.00, leaving me to pay a 177.77 copayment. (The insurance claim and EOB both specifically call it a copay). I thought it was a weird amount for a "copayment". I called customer service because I thought Under the Affordable Care Act your insurance can't charge you copayment, coinsurance, or a deductible on preventative care (i.e. routine gyno exams). The guy told me he saw I was entitled to a one covered yearly exam and would investigate it for me and call me back. Then they told me that the billing department says it was billed correctly because my benefits say "Annual Gynecological Exam - one per benefit period Covered - 100% after 100% copay" That wording is extremely confusing to me and more confusing is that my member handbook in the portal literally says... You have coverage for preventive care as required by the Affordable Care Act. As part of this law, you do not have a copayment, coinsurance or deductible when you receive preventive care, which include: • Routine gynecological exams Is this not contradiction and violation of the ACA? The provider was in network and all of the codes were correct."

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wnogvc/am_i_misinterpreting_my_plan_or_is_my_insurance/

↳ emmyjag (64): "What were the billing codes? The routine physical exams that are covered at no cost to you are very very narrowly defined, and any deviation changes the billing code from your free preventive exam to a diagnostic exam"

↳ positivelycat (37): "Sounds like your insurance processed incorrectly then. Try calling again sometimes you get someone newer who don't know what they are talking about"

↳ Melodic_Turnover_340 (18): "Diagnosis: Z01419 Procedure: 99385 I'm pretty sure those are the ones necessary for preventive and not diagnostic ?"

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qsd3bg/>

↳ (0): "Why are you trying to do this? What's your goal?"

↳ (0): "This is the right question!"

↳ (0): "It sounds like you're looking to get a secondary plan as your work plan is primary and doesn't provide the treatments you're wanting. If you go this route make sure that the secondary plan will cover non-covered charges from the primary plan. I've seen a lot of secondary plans that won't cover if the primary doesn't even if the plan normally would"

"How many Americans are on PPO health insurance that covers seeing specialists/doctors across state lines compared to being on insurance that only covers within the state? I'm on Medicaid in Rhode Island for disability and it's frustrating dealing with out of state approvals. Any advice welcomed. I've had long-term neurological issues like neuropathy, muscle pain, and memory issues for nearly 6 years that neurologists in my state (and in Connecticut) haven't been able to definitively diagnose. I am on SSI for disability, which means I get Neighborhood Health Plan of Rhode Island as my primary insurance, with Medicaid as the secondary. I was told by a neurologist I saw across the border in Connecticut recently (Some doctors in CT take my insurance it seems) that being seen at a bigger hospital like Mass General may lead to a definitive diagnosis. From what I was told by his office after they tried referring me to the hospital, Mass General/MGH is no longer accepting my insurance even with prior authorization, when a few years ago i was told by Mass General they were taking my insurance with those stipulations. I was told by MGH's neurology department staff (who were very nice and compassionate about my situation, to be fair to them) that it's possible the hospital chose not to contract with my insurance this year, hence the change, and that because I am on Medicaid, I couldn't even choose to self-pay to go there. They said it's possible in the future the contractual issue could change, and they also told me to try contacting Neighborhood Health myself and explain the situation and see if they could somehow get me approved to be seen at Mass General. I will be calling them this upcoming week. I was curious as to how often Americans are on health insurance plans that cover seeing specialists across state lines, how difficult it is for them to be approved to see specialists in different states, etc. I find it frustrating that my insurance doesn't work across state lines considering this is the smallest state in the country. Not every specialist is going to be here. Logistically it seems to make sense to me that CT/MA should have a deal with RI insurance to cover people if they at least get prior authorization/approval. As of right now Mass General wouldn't take me no matter what, which I find very concerning and depressing. I have had multiple neurologists say I should be seen in a place like Boston to possibly get a definitive diagnosis, why is that not enough to be seen there? That makes no sense to me."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uheytb/how_many_americans_are_on_ppo_health_insurance/

↳ Good_Educator4872 (3): "Originally they wanted to control what plans you could buy. Govt plans always limited coverage to care within the relevant political entity. No one ever accused the designers of Obamacare of being forward thinking. It was about control. The original thinking was to use the British NHS as a model. There were problems with this. We are different than EUROPEAN COUNTRIES. We have the most extensive checks and balances balance system. The states are sovereign political entities. European states have always been organized from the top down. The US. is the inverse. Our constitution is a mutual agreement among sovereign states to cede certain powers to the Federal government. This limits the federal governments ability to dictate internal state action except in delineated areas. Generally, the Fed can only exert oversight in areas the state is not currently regulating. The Federal government doesn't regulate insurance policies unless the state agrees. Insurance is the purview of the states as an example not the Federal Government"

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes. And I had a policy in RI from the market place there (recently moved out of state). It was a BCBS PPO, the lowest level with an HSA. It has a national provider network and allows for seeing doctors, specialists, labs,etc anywhere in the country. I never had even a single issue and I've got doctors in multiple states (though not in RI because well...)."

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes! It's weird because it's almost impossible to get a doctor or most specialists in RI but we have one of the very best marketplaces. But it's only the BCBS PPO with the national provider network so look for one of theirs."

What they were told about qualifying · 10 documents

"I thought the income considered for ACA would be income after we retire not total anticipate income for this year. Husband and I are retiring in July this year. I called health broker and was told our 2026 total income does not qualify us for subsidies this year. We can definitely control our MAGI next year. But the cost of health insurance without subsidies for this year is \$2,400 a month for bronze. Crazy"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 155 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgzvkYbzn16KYejn5LV4AaABAg>

↳ @Reanimator7336 (2): "If you work at all in retirement you are not retired."

↳ @TheUnRetired (0): "that is crazy - sorry! here's more about MAGI: https://youtu.be/KDE1jO1z3Sg?si=U8m89wRt_jEUXzMG";

↳ @Reanimator7336 (0): "ACA only goes by taxable income per year period. Its not what tax bracket you are in or gross income."

"18 currently unemployed and need insurance To start off I've never used Reddit really so I'm not sure if this is appropriate here but it seems like the place to go. I turned 18 in June and haven't had health insurance for YEARS. It honestly wouldn't be a crazy issue for me if I wasn't dealing with some reproductive health issues and wanting birth control. I used to just go to the ER when things happened or visit Planned Parenthood but my mom seems against it now because of money. It'd be over \$1,000 per month for me to just be placed on her own plan so I'm at a wall. I went to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and I was told that I qualified for a marketplace plan yet open enrollment has closed. I don't believe I account for a special enrollment period because I never really had insurance to begin with. I don't understand what to do in my case. I still live with my mother, I have a job interview lined up but everything feels like a waiting game except I never actually get the medical attention I really need. I'm frustrated and just want to see an GYN or somebody that can help me, I'm very tired."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wdtgmh/18_currently_unemployed_and_need_insurance/

↳ TremendouslyMuffled (20): "Medicaid is exactly what you need here, being 18 and no income means you'll almost certainly qualify, and unlike the marketplace it's open year-round"

↳ LizzieMac123 (11): "That is if a parent doesn't claim OP as a dependent on their taxes. If a parent claims OP, they have to include the household income- which is likely the case if the Marketplace told OP they were eligible, but open enrollment is closed vs. sending them to medicaid directly."

↳ Blossom73 (5): "Because you're under 19, your mom's income counts if you live with her and/or are her tax dependent. That's because children's Medicaid ends at age 19 in Texas. Once you turn 19 you unfortunately won't qualify for Medicaid in Texas unless you're pregnant, disabled, as in deemed disabled by the SSA or the state, or an extremely low income parent of a minor child. The monthly income limit for children's Medicaid in TX for a household of 2 is \$2448. \$3714 for CHIP. <https://www.snapscreener.com/medicaid/guides/texas> Is your mom married? Does she have any other dependents?"

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😞 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/

↳ BaltimoreBee (52): "Your broker is giving you misinformation and you should stop working with them and find a competent one. Married filed separately automatically disqualifies from any subsidies, it doesn't matter how much you earn. You will definitely owe back 100% of any subsidies they give you if you are married filing separately. The only way you can qualify for subsidies is if you file a joint tax return and those subsidies are based on your combined household income."

↳ Dakota51871 (23): "You're broker not only gave you false information but violate the rules and regulations of their contract with NYS Department of Financial Services. You should definitely file a complaint with DFS by calling 800-342-3736 and the attorney general health care line at 800-428-9071. They work on commission so they will say or do anything to make a sale."

↳ whim_sea (11): "Woah. I'm so glad I asked! Thank you !"

Tab 5 — Frustrations

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Agents, brokers and plans changed without consent	6

Premiums that doubled or tripled · 105 documents

"My premium just went up 1500% Posting again because mods removed it since I guess I didn't use the right flair originally I don't know what to do. It's now higher than my mortgage. It is literally impossible for me to pay for now. I won't have insurance anymore starting on the 1st. I have a ton of medication that I need to function. I'm scared Age 36 State Arkansas Income 30k a year Household size of 3. Partner recently laid off. Not married. All my info is updated through the marketplace. The cheapest thing they suggested is \$500. The bill I received for next month is \$744. I rounded up in the comments to \$800 because it's basically the same thing. My Medicaid coverage was \$48 before hand. Someone whose comment is no longer visible said they were happy my premiums went up because they think I voted for Trump. Trump is an evil person and I would rather die than vote for him. Leftists exist in Arkansas. Sorry your stereotypes are incorrect Do only republicans comment on this subreddit or something? Why is everyone treating me like a liar?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 416 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/>

↳ (0): "[Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is telling me that a single 36 year old in Arkansas making \$30,000/year is eligible for \$590/month in tax credits for 2026. That covers all but a few pennies/month in premiums on multiple bronze plans. Even the best GOLD plans would be well under \$100/month in premiums. Like \$40-80/month. Something isn't right with this post or we need more info about household size and income, etc."

↳ (0): "Please list the rates of what premium you paid before, and what it will be in 2026, and how many people in the household (single, 2, etc.). Right now, it reads like you're a single household making \$30K, which is too much to lose credits due to being someone who's supposed to apply for Medicaid, and too low to lose subsidies due to being more than 400% of the fpl. And those are the main ways you'd see that kind of jump, is if you lost all subsidies, and it sounds unlikely that you did."

↳ (0): "What were your premiums before, and what would they be after the increase? Is your insurance through an employer or the Marketplace? What about subsidies? For what it's worth, you're not alone. My husband is a retired state employee, and we're too young for Medicare. Our premiums for the two of us through the state retirement system are \$3,900 a month, up \$1,200 a month from last year. The state only kicks in \$200/month. Between premiums and deductibles, we'll be paying well over \$55,000 a year before insurance even kicks in. But we don't have a choice. I'm chronically ill, and my husband was diagnosed with leukemia last year. Like they say, you're well until you're not. Are your meds available in generics? There are a few options for less expensive generics...."

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oonov2/>

↳ (0): "The ACA requires insurance companies to spend a minimum percentage of the premiums they collect on medical care and quality improvements. If an insurer spends less than this threshold, they must refund the difference to policyholders in the form of a rebate check or premium credit."

↳ (0): "I didn't know this was a thing until a few weeks ago when my health insurance company sent me a check along with an admission that they underspent our premium dollars."

↳ (0): "Yup, the medical loss ratio. There is a distinct possibility that they don't spend 80% on actual healthcare and would have to issue rebate checks to the owners of the policy."

"My employer dropped me from health insurance About a year and a half ago I became eligible for health insurance at my new job (one of the reasons I accepted position was for the benefits). After about a month or so of coverage I was asked to come in for a meeting. Our insurance broker was there along with the director of operations. The broker explained that if I continued coverage my coworker's premiums would go up so high that no one could afford them. He said that they could no longer cover me and he would send in someone to help me sign up for coverage on the marketplace (which someone did). I questioned if all this was legal and was told that because their policy is under-written then, yes, it is legal for them to drop me. I should also add that I am a breast cancer survivor. I still get preventative treatment monthly at a local cancer center. It was after the first claim was submitted by the center that this all went down. Was this legal?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 206 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mvkoso/>

↳ (0): "Is the company paying for your marketplace premiums and is it the same level of coverage your company offers to the other employees, including deductibles, co-insurance, and co-pays? Do you have a copy of the company's policy where it says that cancer coverage is excluded? Does this company employ more than 50 people? Need more info to determine if it was legal or not. You might call your state's department of labor and ask."

↳ (0): "I would pay it then they would add the reimbursement to my paycheck. The coverage was similar. I only did it for a few months. I got married and I'm now on my husband's policy. Nowhere did I read that cancer was excluded. More than 50 people during peak seasons, less in the off season."

↳ (0): "If it has fewer than 50 full-time year-round employees it actually doesn't have to offer health insurance at all, but if they do they have to offer it to everyone. You were reimbursed for the premium and the coverage was similar to what the company offered. It sounds like they were doing the right thing for you while keeping costs down for the rest of the employees. Not a lawyer but I don't see anything illegal about it."

The income cliff and paying it back · 91 documents

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>

↳ (0): "Man, it's a big risk, and if you lose the bet, you're well and truly bad off. One chronic illness, cancer, pregnancy, broken bone, torn ligament and you are SOL. Sure, you can be seen for emergency care under EMTALA, but they don't have to give you chemo or surgery or insulin once you're past the emergency part. 25 is typically young and healthy, but it isn't a guarantee. Best of luck to you."

↳ (0): "My MS first happened at 25, but bc I didn't have insurance until 29 to get diagnosed I have permanent damage and now disabled and unable to work."

↳ (0): "I don't want to upvote this, because it is terrible that you had to go through that, but I'll upvote anyway because it is a perfect example of how things can turn quickly."

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😞) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday.

UPDATE: I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😞) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to

forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 🥰 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 🙄 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting, failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an" — r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tmp52c/>

↳ (0): "If she is an in-network provider she has a contract with your insurance provider and has agreed to their reimbursement rates. Confirm with your insurance company that her and her office are in-network. If she's collecting the "remaining balance" from patients she's breaking her contractual obligation. Providers cannot ask you to give up your rights to not be balance billed. Also, it sounds like you're no longer comfortable with her either way and it'd be best to find another provider"

↳ (0): "OP your insurance can also do a three-way call with the provider and you to explain everything (if they actually are in network)."

↳ (0): "I'm a psychologist. Your therapist is in network and has agreed to the rate that the insurance company set. She or he cannot "balance bill" you. Depending on your state, it may be illegal. Regardless of state, it's unethical and in violation of the agreement that the therapist made with the insurance company as an in-network provider. If you want to go hard, you can report them to their licensing board for unethical behavior. At a minimum, I would not stick with this therapist. They're either uneducated or unethical. You don't want either of those in a therapist."

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

↳ Zphr (35): "OP, if you are just over the cliff (up to about 440% FPL), then you have an out due to a change in the OBBA. Select a Bronze during open enrollment, commit to fully funding the accompanying HSA the Bronze will make you eligible for, and you can reduce your estimated MAGI at application by the full HSA contribution amount. This can pull you back into subsidy eligibility, which will cap your costs for the benchmark Silver at just under 10% of your MAGI, which right near the cliff for a household of two should be about \$700/month. Bronzes are cheaper than the benchmark, so you might be looking at \$400 to \$550/month for the Bronze. You can further reduce your AGI by making contributions to non-Roth retirement accounts if you aren't already doing so. Better to put \$16K into accounts for yourself than pay half or more of that amount in avoidable health insurance premiums."

↳ NBA-014 (19): "This is what the majority of Americans voted for. America is insane."

↳ Stand_With_Students (15): ""Why do we put up with this?" Exactly what I want to know too."

Insurance companies and the system as a scam · 73 documents

"\$2600/mth, \$6k deductible for wife and I Blue Shield Bronze HSA PPO w/ \$6k deductible is looking like \$2650/mth for 2026, for wife and I (middle aged, in good health). This is a CoveredCA ACA plan, and I'm self-employed. This is completely unaffordable. Having already cut all our costs to the bone, I only have one option, which is to raise my rates, and hope that my competitors will also be raising theirs too so mine aren't extortionate. The only other thing I could do it seems is to become younger, which I'll try and organize, but seems to have some complex issues. This is going to massively, massively spike inflation."

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o9m8gp/>

↳ (0): "Please don't worry the golden ballroom and Arch monument funding is safe."

↳ (0): "But what about Argentina???"

↳ (0): "They're good, we just doubled down and sent another 20 billion"

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today-turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vnue4v/>

↳ (0): "You can report any insurance carrier operating an aca marketplace plan to your state department of insurance."

↳ (0): "**Nevada Division of Insurance:** Northern NV (775) 687-0700 or Southern NV (702) 486-4009"

↳ (0): "Name and shame. Who is the insurance carrier? What exact plan did you purchase? Any plan documents you can share here to give us something to review and provide direction? Edit: This thread is kind of all over the place, but since this is a higher-level comment: Imperial *is* a legitimate, ACA-qualified carrier and this is a qualified health plan sold through Nevada Health Link, the state's official marketplace. What's more, since Imperial is a very small carrier with a narrow network, OP didn't have a choice and went to an OON emergency room. So it's crystal clear: Imperial hasn't "not paid anything"--they haven't even been billed for anything. The onus is now on OP to submit a super bill / claim directly to Imperial since this is an OON hospital with no mechanism to submit a claim on their behalf. Annoying, no doubt, but is necessary if they want to have any coverage for this encounter."

"Billed \$1600 so far for free preventative colonoscopy I'm 52 years old and never had a colonoscopy so I thought I would take advantage of the \$0 out of pocket preventative colon cancer screening through my ACA health plan. I had the colonoscopy last month and a couple days ago I got an email from the hospital saying that I have a bill. It's \$1600 for the colonoscopy. I went to reddit of course and saw that reddit seems to agree that it should have been free. No polyps were found. I spent hours on the phone yesterday with the hospital and the insurance company. The lady at the hospital told me that I was mistaken about preventative care being free. She said that there are thousands of different plans and each plan does it differently. She said they submitted my claim and the insurance paid for part of it and that I am responsible for the other \$1600. After talking to her for a while I wasn't getting anywhere so we agreed to disagree and I called the insurance company. The insurance rep spoke English as a second language and didn't seem to understand the point I was making. She told me how much the total was, how much insurance had paid, and how much I was responsible for. When I said things like "I think there is a mistake, this should be free of charge since it was preventative" she simply repeated the totals as if she didn't understand. She was supposed to call me back at 2pm today and never called. I guess I will be spending tomorrow on the phone again trying to get the \$1600 taken off my bill. Nobody I have talked to so far is aware of the ACA policy that preventative care is covered in full. They seem to think that I am just saying that to get out of paying my bill. Any advice for what I can say tomorrow. Edit: OK, I just got off the phone with the United Healthcare rep. She said that there was no mistake. She said I had 2 procedures done and only one was preventative. I asked her for the diagnostic codes for the procedures and she only gave me one code G0121. She seemed like she wanted to get me off the phone so I didn't argue. She apologized several times and said there was no mistake, I have to pay the \$1600. I had a referral for "Screening for colon cancer Z12.11" and have no knowledge of any second procedure. EDIT 2 OK I got some more info today. I confirmed that my plan offers the colon cancer screening at 0% copay and no deductible. The insurance says that I got the colon cancer screening paid for (they paid \$150). But I was charged \$1600 for an endoscopy that was not preventative care. All the CPT codes are missing for the non-preventative endoscopy. Here it is called a HC colonoscopy. The person I talked to said that my primary code was Z12.11 and my secondary code was K57.30 <https://preview.redd.it/3qbqhqld7ug1.png?width=700&format=png&auto=webp&s=7ec1b565073bcc88f0403c5064e0be6ec17b28b6> <https://preview.redd.it/09k2gdppd7ug1.png?width=691&format=png&auto=webp&s=9e15198b82f8833f30009a763184c6e58817a42f> Update 3 I talked to a different insurance rep today and got a completely different reason for my bill. This one acknowledged that I only had one procedure and that it was a colonoscopy, not an endoscopy. She said that while a colonoscopy can be preventative, mine was not preventative because I had it done in a hospital. I asked her where I should have gone to get a preventative colonoscopy and she said that I should have gone to an office. I told her I went to my doctor's office and they referred me to the hospital. She said she understands it is frustrating and offered to help me file a claim adjustment request. So in 10 to 15 days I should be getting the decision. I still think it makes no sense because they paid the claim submitted by the doctor who performed the colonoscopy even though he did it at a hospital. But the claim submitted by the hospital was not preventative because the colonoscopy happened at a hospital."

— r/HealthInsurance · 233 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sg3ast/>

↳ (0): "If it's a true ACA plan, you'd be correct and there seems there would be some sort of issue with them processing. Where did you get your ACA plan? Do you have a copy of the EOB you can post?"

↳ (0): "Did you confirm the doctor you used was in network?"

↳ (0): "Also - an issue we ran into once is that the procedure the colonoscopy being done by the doctor is indeed included but not the facility fee. So you have to pay a facility fee - and even if they are in network they could be not covered."

Politics deciding their premium · 64 documents

"My daughter is a surg/tech student. The doctor stuck her with a needle during a procedure. My daughter has insurance but not for that hospital. Now she owes \$1800 for getting treated at the hospital where she got stuck. Not sure what to do. My daughter is a surgical tech student. During one of her procedures in February, the doctor accidentally stuck her with a dirty needle. The doctor told her to go down to the triage so she could get the proper care for sticks, which included a blood test (plus a follow-up test 2 weeks later). My daughter has healthcare thru the government (Obamacare, basically). She got a bill from her teaching hospital for her medical care for \$1800. Her insurance is denying it because she isn't covered at the hospital where she works. What should she do? This is such an unusual situation, and I can't find advice anywhere (other than 'call an attorney', which would cost more than the \$1800). Suggestions? (on a good note, the patient was tested for any diseases and came back clean, so no worries on that front)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 929 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jqp09o/>

↳ (0): "The facility where the injury took place should cover it. If they somehow don't it needs to be appealed as urgent/emergent care and the insurance company will pay. A needle stick with a known dirty needle is an emergency. Out of network is normally waived for urgent emergent care."

↳ (0): "Any recommendation on who specifically (department?) to target on this? Seems everyone wants to pass the buck. I'd love to call someone and say "This is your problem to solve""

↳ (0): "Back when I was a medical student at a teaching hospital, needle-stick injuries were covered by the OSHA department of the hospital."

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pff3oz/>

↳ (0): "FYI if you get married you get a special enrollment and can enroll her right away."

↳ (0): "This is what my partner and I are doing. We are marrying tomorrow actually, so we can have me enrolled on his health insurance for the new year. My coverage is going up over \$200 with higher deductible and higher co-pays. It's a bit sad that we are "forced" into marriage, when we could have planned a nice elopement with close friends and family, instead of a quick courthouse wedding. Good luck, you aren't the only one dealing with this."

↳ (0): "Getting Married is a life changing event. It opens enrollment and you can get her on instantly."

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

↳ bourbonfan1647 (68): "Elections have consequences. None of this is a surprise. Welcome to the "find out" phase..."

↳ Stop-Looking_For_Me (48): "Well here it is. The numbers don't lie. Healthcare is going to be fun next year for everyone."

↳ Redtoolbox1 (41): "But the billionaires got their tax cuts they so desperately needed 🍌"

Too much income for help, too little to afford it · 45 documents

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

— r/HealthInsurance · 614 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hmjm0o/>

↳ (0): "You know, \$240 for insurance you can actually use? Isn't bad at all. The new Medicare premium for 2025 is \$185. And that? Is for insurance that's about as useful as tits on a nun, and doesn't include vision or dental coverage. Secondly, the Marketplace is open for enrollment until January 15th: https://www.healthcare.gov/subscribe/?gad_source=1&gclid=CjwKCAiAmrS7BhBJEiwAei59i9Oacg0wxG2w-ZA-CIWv7rQmP1f88oKN4m5i8AvwQGxT-DXXSOE0lhoCgioQAvD_BwE&gclsrc=aw.ds You are still eligible for Marketplace coverage and subsidies if: 1. Your employer-offered insurance is more than 9.12% of your annual income, or the lowest-cost option to cover your family is 9.12% of your household's total income. 2. Your employer-offered insurance doesn't meet ACA standards (which is defined generally as those that offer coverage for doctors and hospitals, and generally pay for 60% of medical costs). If you don't qualify for Medicaid? It's because your income is too high to do so. I don't know what to tell you. It sounds like you rolled the dice, took a chance, and lost."

↳ (0): "13 years working in the world of the Affordable Care Act 8 Years of Provider Services dealing with Medical Professionals 7 Years of Customer Service dealing with individuals' questions on claims and benefits 5 years of Medical Claim Processing So what state do you live in? Does your state have a State-Run Health Insurance Marketplace? My state is still in OPEN ENROLLMENT to enroll in a Health Insurance Plan for 2025 with an effective date of February 1, 2025. The deadline for a January 1 Effective date has passed; the deadline line is midnight December 15, 2024. I am not able to use the tools I have to determine if you are eligible for Tax Subsidies to enroll in a healthcare plan with financial assistance. Your age, yearly income, or Adjusted Gross Income, the tax structure of your household, married, children, filing single, etc, are needed to determine this. Secondly, your Employer offers you a health insurance plan (ESI). Most ESI plans meet the Qualified Health Insurance standard (QHP), as set forth by the Affordable Care Act (ACA). There are two things that a QHP must meet A: They must meet "MINIMUM ESSENTIAL VALUE" - which means a healthcare plan must pay at least 60% of all claims AFTER the deductible is met B: They must meet MINIMUM ESSENTIAL COVERAGE" - meaning they MUST cover the 10 essential health care benefits as outlined in the ACA Law they are, Routine Yearly Physical Walk-In Clinic Services Emergency Room Services Laboratory Services - testing blood, Urine Testing, Biopsy services Pharmacy Mental Health Services both in-patient and out-patient Ambulance Services Prenatal Services (I don't remember them all but these are the most important) Without knowing what your employer plan looks like meaning What does it cost per pay period and what would you pay per pay period What is the Deductible on that plan and what is the Max Out of Pocket Expense on that plan ... is the ESI going to cost you more than 9.07% of your income? ...is the ESI plan just an HSA plan? I like BIG HUGE examples to make a point. Let us assume that your ESI plan reads something like this Yearly Deductible: 10,000 Yearly Max Out of Pocket Expense: \$15,000... You get injured, you get transported by ambulance, to the ER then to Surgery, then to a recovery room, then 5 nights in a hospital with physical therapy, medications, etc...and the total amount owed to the hospital and providers on the day of discharge is \$2 Million. If you were enrolled in the ESI plan, the MOST you pay is \$15,000. Everything else is covered at 100%, you are only responsible for \$15,000. - if the same thing happened again just 4 months later or 2 months later, the total expense you would need to pay is \$0. More information is needed to guide you."

↳ (0): "Non of OPs post makes any sense. They are fishing for upvotes."

"Someone please explain why I (or anyone) should pay a premium that costs more than the oop max The maths aren't mathing. Someone help me understand what I am missing here. We live in NY. I am a self-employed general contractor. Wife is an attorney and recently left her job to open her own firm so we lost great health insurance through her previous employer. Cobra would cost us around \$7k/ month for 2 healthy adults and our 8yo healthy son. Now we're shopping on the marketplace in what appears to be the worst time in history to be doing so. We make too much for any subsidies, so a silver plan is coming in around \$3k/month. Catastrophic is coming in around \$750/month. After a lot of research I can't understand why I would buy anything other than catastrophic. All ACA plans include the same preventive care at no cost. All ACA plans have the same out of pocket maximum limit. Aside from a catastrophe, we would maybe spend \$1k/ year at most seeking care that isn't covered under ACA preventive care. So why would I pay \$36k/year for a silver plan when I could just buy catastrophic for 1/4 the price and pay out of pocket for everything else, knowing I have the same oop cap as the silver \$36k/year plan?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 577 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ozntee/>

↳ (0): "All ACA plans don't have the same out of pocket max.. they all have a maximum out of pocket max, but they vary. Sounds like catastrophic would be the choice for you. I have a silver plan and I like it because it has 0 deductible and covers my expensive meds and treatment. You don't need that much coverage it sounds like."

↳ (0): "Before you choose do a search to see what hospitals or providers are in network. During a period of unemployment I chose a cheap bronze plan only there were literally NO doctors or hospitals in my network within 50 miles. While all policies must cover emergency room visits, what constitutes an emergency now can be redefined by your insurance and your bills denied."

↳ (0): "It's layers and layers and layers of fucked up, isn't it?"

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1owfr9u/>

↳ (0): "Two reasons you might not be seeing subsidies on ACA plans: * your annual income is too low, or you entered it incorrectly. Your annual income must be over the poverty line to be eligible for subsidies * you answered the questions about employer coverage incorrectly, and you're not seeing subsidies because the application believes you have affordable employer coverage available"

↳ (0): "Can you expand on the international bit? That might change things quite a bit"

↳ (0): "The baby will be born there, but it will be a US citizen after some paperwork. My partner and I are both US citizens."

Denied claims and surprise bills · 36 documents

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1h8c09l/>

↳ (0): "The US is the only country that ties your health insurance to your job. That alone is stunning. Then .. the decision whether you get care or not is made by a for-profit corporation. That is unacceptable."

↳ (0): "Yup! Hurricane Helene hit and my doctors in Sylvia and Asheville were unreachable. Called UHC and was told I could go south into GA (out of state) for the remainder of my pregnancy and it to worry about a thing. This was wonderful as the doctors in GA were only 30 mins away compared to the 4-8 hour, 200+ mile round trip they had me doing. That was on October 2nd, I called the GA doctor immediately and was told the soonest they could get me in was October 29th at 7am so I waited, I also scheduled a ride through UHC via 'motiv care' because i can't drive. October 28th, 6:15pm. UHC calls me to tell me that they were unable to secure me a ride and that they would pay for the gas. Very useful for someone who doesn't drive, and only gave me less than 12 hours (less really since you know most people aren't awake at night) to find an alternative ride. At this point I haven't seen anyone since September... My husband was able to get time off work to drive me (thank god). I got the the office and told me it was \$600 and my insurance wasn't going to cover it. I assumed this was going to be one of those call to straighten things out so I called UHC while in the lobby. It was then, and ONLY then.. did UHC inform me that my ability to go out of state for care had a time limit which was October 21st, 8 days short of the soonest the doctor could see me. They failed to both notify me or the doctors office about this. My baby has a chance to have Down syndrome and lacking 2 months of care already was hard enough and putting my baby at risk, I then asked what to do, where to go and what doctor I could see. UHC told me repeatedly to 'just go to the ER' over and over again. Refusing to do anything else despite the fact that going to the ER would do absolutely NOTHING. I returned home having panic attacks and had to rest. I woke up and called back again demanding that they either withhold their verbal contract OR have me see a doctor in NC that isn't in a disaster zone or have me go through one. There is not a single doctor in WNC that I can see, they verbally confirmed this. They also confirmed that indeed, no one from UHC informed anyone about the first end date for 'out of state care'. The agent informed me I would get a case manager and that it would likely be simple as extending the prior approval. BUT because it was filed in a grievance report, it would possibly take up to 30 days to get a reply.. this was October 29th, 2 months without seeing anyone and now forced to wait longer. I called weekly and got no update and told to wait. None of my begging and pleading over for fact that at that time I was 8 months going on 9 months changed anything. I then by a miracle had my Asheville doctor pop up who was doing special ultrasounds to look for physical check marks say I had an appointment on the 21st of November and I took it and was able to get a ride. At that point my baby was not doing so great, small abdomen and needed to be induced soon. But without knowing WHERE, I decided to schedule another ultra sound on December 4th to see if he would slip off the growth chart or improve and give UHC time to tell me where I was going.. NOVEMBER 27th, I received my update. My update? Nothing, if you want to go out of state have your primary care provider to recommend an out of service provider. I had to ask numerous times because my brain broke about this.. That I was previously approved That I have no doctor in my area that aren't in a disaster zone But they needed me to do the leg work to get seen at 9 months pregnant with 1 week, less than 5 business days to figure it out. Best they could do was file another grievance report that would take another 30 days... Called my pcp asap and got them to work on getting the referral UHC apparently 'needed' and I also called my pregnancy advocate who would call UHC herself and see if she could help. My pcp got the referral in on December 4th. My ultrasound showed my baby was stunted in growth and needed induction asap. My pregnancy advocate was able to get a hold of UHC care management team who was helping

set up for GA and assured me they were going to get me in there. December 5th. I was denied the ability to go to the doctor in GA that was 30 mins away because I needed to be induced so soon and they refused to induce unless they got to see me first before hand leaving an availability next week, way too late. So onto the next option. Sylvia, 2 1/2 hours away. They also denied me because they haven't seen my since September.... So my pregnancy advocate who was working with the UHC care management team told me that my only option now. Was to drive 4 1/2 hours to downtown Asheville to give birth... to just show up and tell them you're here to induce and you'll be taken care of.... And that the UHC management would call me to ensure transportation. UHC never reached out. I had to figure out how to get a 4 1/2 hours drive on my own in less than 24 hours... I got a ride to the hospital, got there and was told .. who are you? Why are you here? Who sent you? We don't have any rooms? Had to wait 3 hours to finally get situated into a room... Still here and working on popping this baby but the amount of stress, panic and tears I had to go through because UHC refused to get off their lazy ass and put my baby at risk was not fun. — — — Also to add, I had a driver from motiv care got a speeding ticket while I was in the car, have the car break down in front of my house and under UHC direction had it towed after two weeks with no one reaching out.. Then had the driver threaten my life if I didn't get his car back that night.. it took 9 hours of me having panic attacks and crying my eyes out for them to go beyond just filing a grievance report. I was 6 months pregnant at the time. Another time I had to drive in a car, 5 months pregnant for 6 hours round trip with a driver who's entire car reeked of marijuana. When on my return ride it was obvious it freshly smoked... Filed a report and UHC and motiv care told me they couldn't say for sure if it was the driver or a previous rider so nothing would be done...."

↳ (0): "Commenting here for visibility of your comment because this has left me absolutely speechless. Imaging pushing paper in a DISASTER. What the actual fuck? I am so sorry!!"

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today-turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vnue4v/>

↳ (0): "You can report any insurance carrier operating an aca marketplace plan to your state department of insurance."

↳ (0): "**Nevada Division of Insurance:** Northern NV (775) 687-0700 or Southern NV (702) 486-4009"

↳ (0): "Name and shame. Who is the insurance carrier? What exact plan did you purchase? Any plan documents you can share here to give us something to review and provide direction? Edit: This thread is kind of all over the place, but since this is a higher-level comment: Imperial *is* a legitimate, ACA-qualified carrier and this is a qualified health plan sold through Nevada Health Link, the state's official marketplace. What's more, since Imperial is a very small carrier with a narrow network, OP didn't have a choice and went to an OON emergency room. So it's crystal clear: Imperial hasn't "not paid anything"--they haven't even been billed for anything. The onus is now on OP to submit a super bill / claim directly to Imperial since this is an OON hospital with no mechanism to submit a claim on their behalf. Annoying, no doubt, but is necessary if they want to have any coverage for this encounter."

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😞) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday.

UPDATE: I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😞) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to

forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 🙄 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 🙄 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting, failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an" — r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tmp52c/>

↳ (0): "If she is an in-network provider she has a contract with your insurance provider and has agreed to their reimbursement rates. Confirm with your insurance company that her and her office are in-network. If she's collecting the "remaining balance" from patients she's breaking her contractual obligation. Providers cannot ask you to give up your rights to not be balance billed. Also, it sounds like you're no longer comfortable with her either way and it'd be best to find another provider"

↳ (0): "OP your insurance can also do a three-way call with the provider and you to explain everything (if they actually are in network)."

↳ (0): "I'm a psychologist. Your therapist is in network and has agreed to the rate that the insurance company set. She or he cannot "balance bill" you. Depending on your state, it may be illegal. Regardless of state, it's unethical and in violation of the agreement that the therapist made with the insurance company as an in-network provider. If you want to go hard, you can report them to their licensing board for unethical behavior. At a minimum, I would not stick with this therapist. They're either uneducated or unethical. You don't want either of those in a therapist."

Paying cash instead of using the plan · 23 documents

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>

↳ (0): "Man, it's a big risk, and if you lose the bet, you're well and truly bad off. One chronic illness, cancer, pregnancy, broken bone, torn ligament and you are SOL. Sure, you can be seen for emergency care under EMTALA, but they dont have to give you chemo or surgery or insulin once you're past the emergency part. 25 is typically young and healthy, but it isn't a guarantee. Best of luck to you."

↳ (0): "My MS first happened at 25, but bc I didn't have insurance until 29 to get diagnosed I have permanent damage and now disabled and unable to work."

↳ (0): "I don't want to upvote this, because it is terrible that you had to go through that, but I'll upvote anyway because it is a perfect example of how things can turn quickly."

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/>

↳ (0): "We're in a similar situation. We pay over 20,000 a year for a high deductible plan on my husband's policy. We've explored alternatives, including purchasing coverage for me through the Marketplace; but our most "affordable" option is to stay on his plan because it is based on pre-taxed income. We've also tried the pay out of pocket approach, and I had a minor health emergency, which cost several thousand. We decided that going uninsured with little children is too risky."

↳ (0): "... I'm trying very hard not to erupt. 20k. I assume that your husband's plan is an employer plan based on how you framed this. So they are also paying thousands. I guess maybe it is reasonable if you have 50 kids. You do have 50 kids don't you? My ACA which is a decent hmo is \$6k a year for just me. Deductible is 12k and I can reasonably expect to hit it every year. After MUCH consternation they couldn't find a way to avoid paying for an rx for me that runs about 90k a year. I was on it with great results keeping me out of the hospital (mostly) for a year. Then they decided they approved it by mistake and canceled the approval. I got really sick after that and wound up hospitalized repeatedly which they paid tens of thousands for. So that was dumb. My dr did not like seeing me hospitalized repeatedly just to prove to insurance I'm sick so he started giving me pharma samples. We did that for 6 months. So 45k of shots. Eventually the rep said they couldn't keep doing it, which was my greatest fear. I knew it would happen I just didn't know when. It took another few months to get approved for the pharma's 'charity' program. So now they give me the drug for free. I live in constant fear of losing access. There is something very strange that I experienced when they first yanked the approvals where I knew I was going to get very sick and there was not much I could do because the drug was out of reach. I was literally planning to be much sicker. Family wants to see me for Tday and I'm like, well I'm probably going to be a whole lot sicker then, probably not doable to get on a plane. I don't spend much time feeling sorry for myself but I ABSOLUTELY think about a parent that has a child that needs a drug they simply can't afford, and so instead having to watch them struggle. The drug exists. We paid to develop it with tax dollars. We sell it abroad at a competitive price. But it's too expensive for a child in the US to benefit. This disgusts me. At some point, we will decide we have had enough of this system. But I wish we were a lot closer to that point than I think we are."

↳ (0): "1700/month here...basically same exact situation you are in. My wife is just like your husband. My employer pays for employee 100%, as soon as I add my family, wife, 2 kids....1700/month...vision, dental, included. Eastern PA. I've been fighting this for over 10 years with my employer. I love my job, but each year with this nonsense, it gets harder and harder to argue it's worth staying. My mortgage is 1300/month. Good luck, as all I have ever been told is get a new job."

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future. 💙 "

— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q4ew3x/>

↳ (0): "Republicans could not care less if people are uninsured and it actually seems like they enjoy kicking people off insurance, hurting poor people, and punching down while they laugh. And they proclaim to be Christian. Jesus would be disgusted with them!"

↳ (0): "But you don't know what you're going to make in 2026. Estimate your income above the poverty level and get coverage."

↳ (0): "Be prepared to owe if you end up making more than you estimate. This happened to me. Not fun."

Deductibles so high the plan is useless · 15 documents

"Sat through new job orientation in a deep red state and the cognitive dissonance was something else Just started a new job in a red state. Orientation day, 50+ new hires packed into a hall, and eventually we get to the health insurance and benefits section. That's when the room came alive. People complaining left and right about insurance companies ripping them off. My meds aren't covered. My deductible is insane. I can't get the care I actually need. Half the room had a story. And honestly, looking around, a lot of these folks clearly have real health issues and genuinely need coverage that works. Meanwhile HR is up there basically doing damage control, pitching workarounds and cheaper tiers like "this plan gets you more bang for your buck" which is corporate speak for "we know it's bad, here's how to make it slightly less bad." Here's the part that got me. Based on where I am and the conversations around me, most of this room votes red every single time. The same people furious about unaffordable meds and garbage coverage are voting for the party actively working to gut affordable healthcare. They'll rage at the insurance company all day but never connect it to the ballot they cast. Nobody in that room made the connection. Not one person. They see the symptom every day and keep voting for the disease. I just sat there quietly filling out my forms."

— r/obamacare · 325 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v5g93m/sat_through_new_job_orientation_in_a_deep_red/

↳ Consistent_Ad_6400 (76): "Exactly this. I live in a blue state but my town is 90% red. Trump loves the uneducated voter. The BBB had this all in black and white. Come 2027 with the medicaid work requirement....maybe then they will see...but doubtful"

↳ Mistral1111 (59): "An ignorant electorate is their jam"

↳ hikerdaze (36): "I love Obamacare!!! Rump screwed it up a bit this year and I hear it's going to be even worse next year. While my Republican brother was working and had insurance through his employer, he HATED Obamacare and told anyone who'd listen how evil it was. He's currently out of work, but guess what he has now? Um, yeah."

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today-turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vnue4v/>

↳ (0): "You can report any insurance carrier operating an aca marketplace plan to your state department of insurance."

↳ (0): "**Nevada Division of Insurance:** Northern NV (775) 687-0700 or Southern NV (702) 486-4009"

↳ (0): "Name and shame. Who is the insurance carrier? What exact plan did you purchase? Any plan documents you can share here to give us something to review and provide direction? Edit: This thread is kind of all over the place, but since this is a higher-level comment: Imperial *is* a legitimate, ACA-qualified carrier and this is a qualified health plan sold through Nevada Health Link, the state's official marketplace. What's more, since Imperial is a very small carrier with a narrow network, OP didn't have a choice and went to an OON emergency room. So it's crystal clear: Imperial hasn't "not paid anything"--they haven't even been billed for anything. The onus is now on OP to submit a super bill / claim directly to Imperial since this is an OON hospital with no mechanism to submit a claim on their behalf. Annoying, no doubt, but is necessary if they want to have any coverage for this encounter."

"We retired early and we took the silver plan from the market place. \$2400 a month and it was useless. The deductible and out of pocket was so high, the insurance never paid for anything. What a scam! It honestly drove me back to work, just for the insurance. I sure wish my husband was willing to live out of country for a time."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgxWsbWgrBC4jKr28s54AaABAg>

↳ @ariefraiser140 (11): "If you guys were paying \$2400/month that means you guys had a pretty big AGI."

↳ @michaelcoglianese4292 (7): "@ariefraiser140so what? That's still ridiculously high amount for insurance"

↳ @metalgirl (2): "I agree... our insurance is twice that. Stupid high. So not fair!!!"

Resentment over who pays (in both directions) · 10 documents

"I don't have that obamacare , I got mine on the exchange /s"

— r/obamacare · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ofrwc/the_new_aca_rates_will_post_next_saturday_and_all/nlbnrvr/

"I did not buy mine through the ACA. I got mine directly from an insurance carrier. My premium is going up \$500. I had to go with a more affordable and cheaper plan that doesn't cover much of anything. I'm guessing there is a connection as to why these premiums have gone so high related to the ACA credits expiring."

— YouTube · Health insurance premiums set to soar as ACA subsidies expire · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zWP4luZpu4&lc=UgzmaNfyNuF7YKdevv54AaABAg>

↳ @emmacooper3573 (7): "It is, that's why the democrats were trying to keep the government closed because the Obama' affordable care act contract was about to expire and they TRIED to keep this from happening. People were getting upset with the government being closed and food/benefits becoming scarcely low, they were hungry and wanted it opened and THIS is what happened.....let's see what happens to the next government shutdown MAYBE a new revised affordable care act could be written in BUT maybe not, the newly built ballroom need more money?"

↳ @3y4c (0): "Thank the Republicans for this Trump and Kennedy don't want us to have health insurance so they can kiss my ass I hope their family doesn't need a doctor because they will need a referral to get the help they need I know this because I broke my acko and had to wait until I got a referral to get my ankle fixed this is what you get when you put a Republican in office you get fucked"

↳ @metaldreams3595 (0): "@emmacooper3573not bad Emma youre sort of close. Due to COVID the dems wanted this package passed that simply was not sustainable. They promised the GOP it would be only temporary. Set to expire in 2025, the dems...the worst money managers in history, went back on their word and didnt want it to expire. Listen thats how they got the GOP to vote for it. That it was temporary. Peoples premiums went back to pre COVID amounts. Were seeing a lot of lying gojng on but thats how yall roll."

"I'm tired of my tax dollars being other people's subsidies... Go back to work if you need to. Bring back private insurances. I have always been self employed and bought my insurance without subsidies. Obamacare made it tricky but I got it done."

— YouTube · HOW the One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBBA) CHANGES Early Retirement HEALTH INSURANCE · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6rMBAlebcU&lc=UgwnLfxJKYMUUV9G3gmx4AaABAg>

↳ @40NorthFinances (0): "I hear you. The system is definitely messed up. Sadly, no easy solutions. Thanks for watching."

↳ @savannahsmiles1797 (0): "ACA was a nightmare...as an insurance producer I wanted to personally SLAP Obama for it. Now you have JD, Thiel and Vivek running Chapter Insurance...medicare plans. We need to keep the slimy hands of politicians out of healthcare."

The marketplace itself: website, verification, hold times · 8 documents

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hsyb50/>

↳ (0): "This is a blunder by your former employer if they failed to notify your COBRA administrator. First step is to contact your former employer and get some answers and see what their solution is. Notice should have been sent to you for any changes to your coverage. Something else to consider: since you're in the new year (and I'm assuming your deductible resets on a calendar year basis), you may consider subsidized coverage through your state's ACA marketplace, or even Medicaid if you're eligible. Not enough info shared in your OP to make that determination, but it may help save some coin while you're still (again, assuming here) unemployed."

↳ (0): "I believe this would be on the COBRA vendor. Your prior employer pays the cobra vendor to send out policy documents. I'm sure there is a way for the cobra vendor to alert the ex-employer and they get the policy reinstated, especially since you're paid to date."

↳ (0): "Contact your former employer, bc they made a mistake in not communicating the proper info to the COBRA

administrator. They should be able to fix this quickly, and your enrollment in the new policy should be retrospective to Jan 1. Keep your appointments. The worst case scenario is that you pay for the first PT session out of pocket and then submit the superbill to the new insurer and they will reimburse you. It usually takes 4-6 weeks for the claim to be evaluated and a check to be cut."

"Billed \$1600 so far for free preventative colonoscopy I'm 52 years old and never had a colonoscopy so I thought I would take advantage of the \$0 out of pocket preventative colon cancer screening through my ACA health plan. I had the colonoscopy last month and a couple days ago I got an email from the hospital saying that I have a bill. It's \$1600 for the colonoscopy. I went to reddit of course and saw that reddit seems to agree that it should have been free. No polyps were found. I spent hours on the phone yesterday with the hospital and the insurance company. The lady at the hospital told me that I was mistaken about preventative care being free. She said that there are thousands of different plans and each plan does it differently. She said they submitted my claim and the insurance paid for part of it and that I am responsible for the other \$1600. After talking to her for a while I wasn't getting anywhere so we agreed to disagree and I called the insurance company. The insurance rep spoke English as a second language and didn't seem to understand the point I was making. She told me how much the total was, how much insurance had paid, and how much I was responsible for. When I said things like "I think there is a mistake, this should be free of charge since it was preventative" she simply repeated the totals as if she didn't understand. She was supposed to call me back at 2pm today and never called. I guess I will be spending tomorrow on the phone again trying to get the \$1600 taken off my bill. Nobody I have talked to so far is aware of the ACA policy that preventative care is covered in full. They seem to think that I am just saying that to get out of paying my bill. Any advice for what I can say tomorrow. Edit: OK, I just got off the phone with the United Healthcare rep. She said that there was no mistake. She said I had 2 procedures done and only one was preventative. I asked her for the diagnostic codes for the procedures and she only gave me one code G0121. She seemed like she wanted to get me off the phone so I didn't argue. She apologized several times and said there was no mistake, I have to pay the \$1600. I had a referral for "Screening for colon cancer Z12.11" and have no knowledge of any second procedure. EDIT 2 OK I got some more info today. I confirmed that my plan offers the colon cancer screening at 0% copay and no deductible. The insurance says that I got the colon cancer screening paid for (they paid \$150). But I was charged \$1600 for an endoscopy that was not preventative care. All the CPT codes are missing for the non-preventative endoscopy. Here it is called a HC colonoscopy. The person I talked to said that my primary code was Z12.11 and my secondary code was K57.30 <https://preview.redd.it/3qbqhqlod7ug1.png?width=700&format=png&auto=webp&s=7ec1b565073bcc88f0403c5064e0be6ec17b28b6> <https://preview.redd.it/09k2gdppd7ug1.png?width=691&format=png&auto=webp&s=9e15198b82f8833f30009a763184c6e58817a42f> Update 3 I talked to a different insurance rep today and got a completely different reason for my bill. This one acknowledged that I only had one procedure and that it was a colonoscopy, not an endoscopy. She said that while a colonoscopy can be preventative, mine was not preventative because I had it done in a hospital. I asked her where I should have gone to get a preventative colonoscopy and she said that I should have gone to an office. I told her I went to my doctor's office and they referred me to the hospital. She said she understands it is frustrating and offered to help me file a claim adjustment request. So in 10 to 15 days I should be getting the decision. I still think it makes no sense because they paid the claim submitted by the doctor who performed the colonoscopy even though he did it at a hospital. But the claim submitted by the hospital was not preventative because the colonoscopy happened at a hospital."

— r/HealthInsurance · 233 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sg3ast/>

↳ (0): "If it's a true ACA plan, you'd be correct and there seems there would be some sort of issue with them processing. Where did you get your ACA plan? Do you have a copy of the EOB you can post?"

↳ (0): "Did you confirm the doctor you used was in network?"

↳ (0): "Also - an issue we ran into once is that the procedure the colonoscopy being done by the doctor is indeed included but not the facility fee. So you have to pay a facility fee - and even if they are in network they could be not covered."

"Ambetter admitting to missing three P2P's and recording inaccurate data I have Ambetter through the ACA marketplace and have been trying since March to get ivabradine (Corlanor) 5 mg approved for Inappropriate Sinus Tachycardia (IST). The medication was denied, so my cardiologist and I started the appeal process. We submitted multiple documents and were repeatedly told some variation of, "We just need one more document and you should be approved." Over the next few months, I received conflicting information from different representatives. One rep told me my doctor never submitted an appeal, while another confirmed that the appeal had been received. I was also repeatedly transferred to an offshore team that often couldn't locate my account or case information and could only read from a script. Eventually, Ambetter told us a peer-to-peer (P2P) review was needed. My doctor scheduled and waited for three separate P2P calls. On each occasion, they reserved two hours of their time and never received a call from Ambetter. When I questioned this, I was initially told that my physician likely missed the calls. After pushing for escalation, I was given a complaint number and promised a callback. No one ever called. I later reached someone on the escalation team who seemed genuinely helpful. He reviewed the case notes and stated that he could see all three missed P2P reviews. He also found documentation indicating that my physician's office had supposedly been contacted before a P2P had even been approved, which didn't make sense chronologically. He told me he had rarely seen a case file this disorganized and said he would immediately contact the pharmacy medical director. After I was on hold for approximately 90 minutes, the call disconnected. The next day, I called back with all of my reference numbers and complaint information. The escalation team transferred me back to the main customer service line. Pharmacy transferred me back to escalation. Escalation then sent me back to the main line again. At one point, the pharmacy representative called for me and was literally transferred back into his own department. To make matters worse, I ended up in the ER during this process and nearly lost my job because my symptoms remained uncontrolled while I fought through these delays. At this point, I'm preparing to file a complaint with my states Department of Insurance. My physician's office has documentation of the missed P2P appointments. Has anyone dealt with anything similar with their insurance? Beyond filing with the state and pursuing external review, is there anything else I should be doing? I pay \$550 a month for just me. TL:DR: My insurance has no internal workflow/communication, recorded inaccurate data, and has no actual escalation team. I'm at a loss of how to navigate other than filing with the state."

— r/HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tx9333/>

↳ (0): "First off, Ambetter sucks. Not just a little, but a lot. The pharmacy area is a joke. The initial round of reviews are done by non US based pharmacists with questionable decision making. Most often this results in denials that are overturned later on. Their decisions on step therapy often recommend options that are not appropriate for patients. The escalation and P2P processes are astoundingly bad. Lots of no callbacks on escalations, never scheduled or no response to P2P requests, and missed scheduled P2P. The only way i've found to push the process forward (from my experience and peers) is to have the patient file a grievance with their state insurance commissioner's office. I usually get a follow up from Ambetter within 24 hours of receipt of the complaint. The key is that on the provider side they must track every call, fax, and email. Have receipts. We print off a detailed log, along with recommended wording for a state grievance. Patients understand we're on their side, but with the low reimbursements that Ambetter offers, it's often done at a deficit for the practice."

↳ (0): "In the future, file a grievance immediately with the insurance once you are beyond 7-14 calendar days from the initial request. Then, file a complaint with the division of insurance immediately if they don't resolve your grievance within 7-14 calendar days. Aka don't pass 30 days without a call to the state division of insurance. Complaint filing should be an easy process at the state level, they want and need to know."

↳ (0): "I'm sorry you're going through this. The first step is to confirm which state your Ambetter plan is based in, since the appeal process can vary by state. As an agent, when a prior authorization is denied, I immediately submit an expedited appeal so the member can get a final resolution quickly. If that appeal is denied, I help them file an Independent Review Organization (IRO) request right away. The full process usually takes about 14 days. Most denials happen because the medical criteria simply aren't met — for example, when the provider prescribes something off-label, experimental, or fails to submit the required documentation. If the denial is due to a health plan error, the IRO often

overturns it at no cost to the member. Sometimes appeals succeed because the Medical Director contacts the provider's office for more information. However, since Medical Directors handle dozens of cases per shift, if they can't connect with the provider promptly, the denial is usually upheld. The IRO process is more thorough because it requests documentation directly from the provider and reviews everything comprehensively. In certain states, like Florida, Centene Pharmacy Services handles appeals directly, leaving agents with little influence. Also, the so-called "Member Escalation Team" is essentially experienced customer service representatives — they don't escalate issues beyond standard procedures. True escalation happens through appeals or grievances, where the health plan must act according to your Evidence of Coverage and applicable law. Corporate staff may get involved, but unless your contract or policy language allows exceptions, their role is limited. Recommended Steps Call Ambetter and request to file an appeal as the patient for the denied prior authorization. Note the complaint number if your state allows appeals by phone, or complete the appeal form and send it to your state's designated address. Wait for the letter of determination. If denial is upheld, submit an IRO request. If the IRO also upholds the denial, you can file a complaint with your state's Department of Insurance. You can also skip directly to the Department of Insurance, but they'll usually redirect you back into the same process I described — only with corporate agents involved. That may be preferable if you'd rather speak with someone based in the U.S., since most contact center agents are overseas. Good luck — persistence is key in these cases, and following the proper steps gives you the best chance of success"

Narrow networks and doctors who don't take marketplace plans · 7 documents

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1lwkcch/>

↳ (0): "It's a class H felony in NC for a provider that accepts medicaid (opted in) to take out of pocket payment for services that would be covered under medicaid. Say you went to a dentist that accepted it, they can only bill you for procedures not covered under medicaid like a crown. They wouldn't be able to bill you for services that are covered under medicaid like a cavity filling. If they never opted in to accept medicaid, then it is not fraud. They never agreed to medicaid terms and conditions at all. If you are concerned, before you do anything, you can always call NCDOI or medicaid and make sure you are okay."

↳ (0): "Yes, it can be. Medicaid is for people who cannot pay their own medical expenses. If you show that you have means to pay for your own medical expenses, the state will assume you do not need Medicaid and have been fraudulently receiving benefits. In my state (MD), there are some Medicaid MCOs that do not require referrals from your PCP to receive specialty care. If you are healthy enough to not need to be followed by a PCP, then it matters a lot less if you cannot find one."

↳ (0): "And provider (practitioner/facility) that is contracted with Medicaid must sign a participation agreement that includes the following: In accordance with 10A NCAC 22J .0106 Providers may bill a patient accepted as a Medicaid patient only in the following situations: For allowable deductibles, co-insurance, or co-payments; Before the service is provided the provider has informed the patient that the patient may be billed for a service that is not one covered by Medicaid regardless of the type of provider or is beyond the limits on Medicaid services; The patient is 65 years of age or older and is enrolled in the Medicare program at the time services are received but has failed to supply a Medicare number as proof of coverage; or The patient is no longer eligible for Medicaid as defined in 10A NCAC 21B."

"How many Americans are on PPO health insurance that covers seeing specialists/doctors across state lines compared to being on insurance that only covers within the state? I'm on Medicaid in Rhode Island for disability and it's frustrating dealing with out of state approvals. Any advice welcomed. I've had long-term neurological issues like neuropathy, muscle pain, and memory issues for nearly 6 years that neurologists in my state (and in Connecticut) haven't been able to definitively diagnose. I am on SSI for disability, which means I get Neighborhood Health Plan of Rhode Island as my primary insurance, with Medicaid as the secondary. I was told by a neurologist I saw across the border in Connecticut recently (Some doctors in CT take my insurance it seems) that being seen at a bigger hospital like Mass General may lead to a definitive diagnosis. From what I was told by his office after they tried referring me to the hospital, Mass General/MGH is no longer accepting my insurance even with prior authorization, when a few years ago i was told by Mass General they were taking my insurance with those stipulations. I was told by MGH's neurology department staff (who were very nice and compassionate about my situation, to be fair to them) that it's possible the hospital chose not to contract with my insurance this year, hence the change, and that because I am on Medicaid, I couldn't even choose to self-pay to go there. They said it's possible in the future the contractual issue could change, and they also told me to try contacting Neighborhood Health myself and explain the situation and see if they could somehow get me approved to be seen at Mass General. I will be calling them this upcoming week. I was curious as to how often Americans are on health insurance plans that cover seeing specialists across state lines, how difficult it is for them to be approved to see specialists in different states, etc. I find it frustrating that my insurance doesn't work across state lines considering this is the smallest state in the country. Not every specialist is going to be here. Logistically it seems to make sense to me that CT/MA should have a deal with RI insurance to cover people if they at least get prior authorization/approval. As of right now Mass General wouldn't take me no matter what, which I find very concerning and depressing. I have had multiple neurologists say I should be seen in a place like Boston to possibly get a definitive diagnosis, why is that not enough to be seen there? That makes no sense to me."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uheytb/how_many_americans_are_on_ppo_health_insurance/

↳ Good_Educator4872 (3): "Originally they wanted to control what plans you could buy. Govt plans always limited coverage to care within the relevant political entity. No one ever accused the designers of Obamacare of being forward thinking. It was about control. The original thinking was to use the British NHS as a model. There were problems with this. We are different than EUROPEAN COUNTRIES. We have the most extensive checks and balances balance system. The states are sovereign political entities. European states have always been organized from the top down. The US. is the inverse. Our constitution is a mutual agreement among sovereign states to cede certain powers to the Federal government. This limits the federal governments ability to dictate internal state action except in delineated areas. Generally, the Fed can only exert oversight in areas the state is not currently regulating. The Federal government doesn't regulate insurance policies unless the state agrees. Insurance is the purview of the states as an example not the Federal Government"

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes. And I had a policy in RI from the market place there (recently moved out of state). It was a BCBS PPO, the lowest level with an HSA. It has a national provider network and allows for seeing doctors, specialists, labs,etc anywhere in the country. I never had even a single issue and I've got doctors in multiple states (though not in RI because well...)."

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes! It's weird because it's almost impossible to get a doctor or most specialists in RI but we have one of the very best marketplaces. But it's only the BCBS PPO with the national provider network so look for one of theirs."

"There is a page on MD Anderson's webpage regarding what insurance they accept and it does say "no ACA plans". I have seen the page myself recently and will look for it for you in a bit (after dinner). Here: <https://www.mdanderson.org/patients-family/becoming-our-patient/planning-for-care/insurance-billing-financial-support/insurance-plans.html> Yet it is not as simple as it sounds. However, I spoke to them about it and they are specifically mentioning it in regards to the ACA plans available in TX. And that's because not only are there not any PPO plans available on the TX marketplace but they also don't accept any of the plans that are available on the TX ACA marketplace (it is slim pickings and not very good plans). So that's why they say they don't take any ACA plans. But I have an ACA plan from another state that offers better plans (because not all do, it's not just TX with only crap plans available) and they had no problem accepting my ACA plan. In fact, as others have surmised, they didn't know it was ACA or not. All they really knew was that my (very good) plan was a BCBS PPO with a National Provider Network and that's a plan they accept. FWIW, there's not a hospital or cancer center that doesn't accept my plan. So it isn't that MD Anderson doesn't accept any ACA plans. It's that they don't accept lesser/crappy plans and that's all that is offered on the TX ACA marketplace (as well as some other states)."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o4ov1l/aca_plans_not_accepted_by_leading_hospitals_and/nj7wo7a/

Agents, brokers and plans changed without consent · 6 documents

"I don't know if it's changed, but when I was on the marketplace a decade ago, the application hard stopped if you didn't put in an SSN. So how are there applications without SSN's? Which is one problem I have with the statement they made about it. Also, if they identify problematic brokers, why not kick them off but still allow new brokers to sign up especially this close to open enrollment for the year. This is going to cause a restriction and how many agents are allowed to assist people. I feel like this is just going to hurt consumers more than the potentially fraudulent brokers. Usually, when I heard stories about fraudulent brokers signing people up for the marketplace, it wasn't people that never existed. It was people that came to them looking for plans and then they would either back out of getting a marketplace plan and then the broker still just enrolled them, especially if they qualified for a full subsidy or close to a full subsidy. Or they would encourage people to understate their income so that they would get a bigger subsidy and people would be more inclined to sign up and then get surprised at tax time."

— r/HealthInsurance · 89 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbmia90/

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qsd3bg/>

↳ (0): "Why are you trying to do this? What's your goal?"

↳ (0): "This is the right question!"

↳ (0): "It sounds like you're looking to get a secondary plan as your work plan is primary and doesn't provide the treatments you're wanting. If you go this route make sure that the secondary plan will cover non-covered charges from the primary plan. I've seen a lot of secondary plans that won't cover if the primary doesn't even if the plan normally would"

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qyg8ms/>

↳ (0): "This happens more often than people realize, and no, you are not crazy. Agents or lead generators are motivated by sales. Your agreement and signature are required. What probably occurred is a Marketplace enrollment was completed without your informed consent, often by a third-party agent or lead generator out of need to meet quotas or just greed. Checking eligibility alone does not authorize enrollment. Actual enrollment requires affirmative plan selection and attestation. If that did not occur, this is improper enrollment. Here is what you do, in order. First, call Ambetter immediately and demand the following in writing: • The original application • The agent or broker of record • The date and method of enrollment • The address used and who supplied it • Whether premium tax credits were applied Tell them explicitly you dispute the enrollment as unauthorized and demand a retroactive cancellation to the effective date. Use the phrase unauthorized enrollment without consent. That language matters. Second, contact HealthCare.gov and request a Marketplace case escalation. Ask them to flag the policy as fraudulent enrollment. This is not customer service. This is an eligibility integrity issue. Third, file a complaint with your state Department of Insurance. This creates regulatory pressure and forces documentation. Insurers and agents move fast once DOI is involved. Fourth, protect your tax position. If any premium tax credit was applied, you need a corrected 1095-A showing zero coverage. Otherwise the IRS assumes you accepted subsidized coverage and will claw it back. Fifth, do not pay the bills until the dispute is resolved. Paying can be construed as ratification. Key point: Using your old address is a red flag. That usually indicates data scraping or recycled lead enrollment, not a consumer-initiated action. This is not your fault. It is fixable. But it must be handled surgically and documented. If Ambetter or the Marketplace resists, escalate again and document everything. Paper trails win these cases. In many cases the threat to Department of Insurance is enough."

↳ (0): "CSR from Ambetter here. We do not have the enrollment information that you mention. Only the plan, aptc, effective date and information of the identity of the subscriber. What I do when I receive a call like this is that I call the marketplace and I assist the member to initiate a HICS case for fraud with the rep of marketplace sharing the enrollment dates we have on the system. An investigation is made by a case worker, and once the source it's confirmed was fraudulent they claim back the APTC sent to the health plan, the plan is retroactively cancelled and member receives a letter of termination from the health plan. 9 out of 10 times the fraud is confirmed. The exceptions happen because member did sign up and granted consent to a broker and forgot about it for the rewards card which the brokers did activities and the like so the member could get a few dollars, but I don't expect to see that happen because fewer people qualify for the Silver 94% plan with 0 member responsibility. To avoid that we now have to ask a \$5 dollars payment per month for those accounts that is refunded at the end of the year. Crazy stuff."

↳ (0): "You need to make two calls. One to the insurance commissioner in your state and ask for their help. Second call CMS and make a complaint, ask for the issue to be resolved."

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Theme	Documents
Bronze, silver or gold: picking the tier	109
COBRA or a spouse's employer plan	105

HealthCare.gov or the state exchange on their own	104
Medicaid or CHIP	101
Managing income to keep the subsidy	40
Went without insurance	40
An HSA with a high-deductible plan	33
A broker or agent	24
Direct primary care and paying cash	18
An accountant or planner and Roth conversions	8
Took a job, or kept one, for the insurance	6

Bronze, silver or gold: picking the tier · 109 documents

"Someone please explain why I (or anyone) should pay a premium that costs more than the oop max The maths aren't mathing. Someone help me understand what I am missing here. We live in NY. I am a self-employed general contractor. Wife is an attorney and recently left her job to open her own firm so we lost great health insurance through her previous employer. Cobra would cost us around \$7k/ month for 2 healthy adults and our 8yo healthy son. Now we're shopping on the marketplace in what appears to be the worst time in history to be doing so. We make too much for any subsidies, so a silver plan is coming in around \$3k/month. Catastrophic is coming in around \$750/month. After a lot of research I can't understand why I would buy anything other than catastrophic. All ACA plans include the same preventive care at no cost. All ACA plans have the same out of pocket maximum limit. Aside from a catastrophe, we would maybe spend \$1k/ year at most seeking care that isn't covered under ACA preventive care. So why would I pay \$36k/year for a silver plan when I could just buy catastrophic for 1/4 the price and pay out of pocket for everything else, knowing I have the same oop cap as the silver \$36k/year plan?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 577 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ozntee/>

↳ (0): "All ACA plans don't have the same out of pocket max.. they all have a maximum out of pocket max, but they vary. Sounds like catastrophic would be the choice for you. I have a silver plan and I like it because it has 0 deductible and covers my expensive meds and treatment. You don't need that much coverage it sounds like."

↳ (0): "Before you choose do a search to see what hospitals or providers are in network. During a period of unemployment I chose a cheap bronze plan only there were literally NO doctors or hospitals in my network within 50 miles. While all policies must cover emergency room visits, what constitutes an emergency now can be redefined by your insurance and your bills denied."

↳ (0): "It's layers and layers and layers of fucked up, isn't it?"

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

↳ bourbonfan1647 (68): "Elections have consequences. None of this is a surprise. Welcome to the "find out" phase..."

↳ Stop-Looking_For_Me (48): "Well here it is. The numbers don't lie. Healthcare is going to be fun next year for everyone."

↳ Redtoolbox1 (41): "But the billionaires got their tax cuts they so desperately needed 🍌"

"Just canceled my 2026 health insurance through Covered CA My situation is i made more money this year than i expected and now my insurance is about 450 \$ for the bronze plan the problem is everything went up for me, my car insurance went from 280 to 400 this year, my rent went up by 100 \$, my utilities went absolutely crazy, i am living in the studio apartment and used to pay 80-100 \$ max, but now every month is more and more, this month it got to 250 \$...and my apt manager said it's shared so it's not me lol So yeah, even tho i made more money than i expected, i don't have more money on hands, i used to pay 100 \$ per month for insurance and it was ok, but 450 \$ for bronze plan ??? I just can't do it... Can you guys recommend any other good alternatives in LA ? i have good health, nothing chronical and don't take any meds ? Thanks"

— r/HealthInsurance · 307 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1przn9r/>

↳ (0): "Since you're in LA, check out enrollment in the LA County Ability To Pay program. It's not health insurance, but provides healthcare through its clinics and hospitals at a flat monthly fee for lots of outpatient services and a flat per-admission fee for inpatient services."

↳ (0): "We need to form a sub for people going without"

↳ (0): "Mine went from 500 to 820. Just cant afford it now. Barely could before even working 2 jobs"

COBRA or a spouse's employer plan · 105 documents

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>

↳ (0): "Man, it's a big risk, and if you lose the bet, you're well and truly bad off. One chronic illness, cancer, pregnancy, broken bone, torn ligament and you are SOL. Sure, you can be seen for emergency care under EMTALA, but they dont have to give you chemo or surgery or insulin once you're past the emergency part. 25 is typically young and healthy, but it isn't a guarantee. Best of luck to you."

↳ (0): "My MS first happened at 25, but bc I didn't have insurance until 29 to get diagnosed I have permanent damage and now disabled and unable to work."

↳ (0): "I don't want to upvote this, because it is terrible that you had to go through that, but I'll upvote anyway because it is a perfect example of how things can turn quickly."

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hsvb50/>

↳ (0): "This is a blunder by your former employer if they failed to notify your COBRA administrator. First step is to contact your former employer and get some answers and see what their solution is. Notice should have been sent to you for any changes to your coverage. Something else to consider: since you're in the new year (and I'm assuming your deductible resets on a calendar year basis), you may consider subsidized coverage through your state's ACA marketplace, or even Medicaid if you're eligible. Not enough info shared in your OP to make that determination, but it may help save some coin while you're still (again, assuming here) unemployed."

↳ (0): "I believe this would be on the COBRA vendor. Your prior employer pays the cobra vendor to send out policy documents. I'm sure there is a way for the cobra vendor to alert the ex-employer and they get the policy reinstated, especially since you're paid to date."

↳ (0): "Contact your former employer, bc they made a mistake in not communicating the proper info to the COBRA

administrator. They should be able to fix this quickly, and your enrollment in the new policy should be retrospective to Jan 1. Keep your appointments. The worst case scenario is that you pay for the first PT session out of pocket and then submit the superbill to the new insurer and they will reimburse you. It usually takes 4-6 weeks for the claim to be evaluated and a check to be cut."

"The government should really open up Medicare with reasonable premiums for those 55 -65. Age discrimination is preventing a lot of people from getting hired these days. Even ACA is costing me 1K a month for me and spouse. My spouse's work insurance was much more expensive. My COBRA just ended after I lost my job 18 months ago and it was 1500 a month going up to 2K this year. I stayed on COBRA because we already satisfied the max out of pocket and it was good insurance."

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Retire Before 65 · 72 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l8VY8AcaLww&lc=UgxUWCq0OC_S-rSQahN4AaABAq

↳ @DesigningRetirement (2): "Health sharing ministries like Medishare, Samaritan Ministries, and Christian Healthcare Ministries are an option some people use, but it's crucial to understand what they are and aren't before making this choice - especially for people over 50. What they are: Member-based cost-sharing programs where members contribute monthly "shares" that are used to pay each other's medical expenses. They're often significantly cheaper than ACA plans (\$300-500/month vs. \$800-1,500+) and are based on shared religious values and community support. What they're NOT: Insurance. They have no legal obligation to pay your medical bills. If the ministry determines your situation doesn't meet their guidelines, you're responsible for the full bill - and you have no legal recourse. Critical limitations for people approaching or in retirement: 1. Pre-existing conditions: Most health sharing ministries don't cover pre-existing conditions at all, or impose waiting periods of 1-3+ years. For people over 50, the vast majority have at least one pre-existing condition - high blood pressure, high cholesterol, diabetes, previous surgeries, arthritis, etc. If you develop cancer, need heart surgery, or face other major medical needs related to a pre-existing condition, your bills may not be "shared." 2. No guarantee of payment: If the ministry determines your situation doesn't qualify (didn't follow protocols, didn't get pre-approval, condition isn't "shareable" per their guidelines), you pay the full bill. There's no insurance commissioner to appeal to, no legal protection. 3. Coverage exclusions vary widely: Many exclude mental health care, some exclude certain cancer treatments, some require you to try lower-cost treatments first, some won't share bills if you didn't get pre-approval. You must read the specific guidelines carefully - not the marketing materials, but the actual sharing guidelines. Real-world outcomes - both exist: Some people use health sharing ministries for years successfully, paying for routine care and minor issues at much lower monthly cost than insurance. Other people have been left with \$50,000-200,000+ in medical debt when the ministry denied their shares for cancer treatment, heart surgery, or other major expenses - often after treatment has already occurred, when they're most vulnerable. Where they might work: Healthy people under 50 with no pre-existing conditions People with strong religious convictions about community-based sharing People who have financial resources to self-pay if shares are denied Very short-term bridge situations (though risky) Where they're dangerous: People over 50 (very high likelihood of health issues) Anyone with chronic conditions or health history People who can't afford large unexpected medical bills Anyone facing major illness (exactly when you need guaranteed coverage) My honest perspective: For most people over 50 navigating the gap before Medicare, I strongly encourage sticking with ACA-compliant insurance despite the cost. The guaranteed coverage of pre-existing conditions and legal consumer protections are worth the premium difference when you're at the age where major health issues become more likely. If ACA premiums feel truly unaffordable, explore subsidies based on current income (not last year's - this trips people up), Medicaid eligibility if income is low enough, or working with a healthcare navigator to find the most affordable ACA-compliant option. If you're still considering health sharing ministries: Read the actual sharing guidelines (not marketing materials) - understand exactly what is and isn't shareable Assume you'll need to self-pay for major illness - if you can't afford that risk, don't take it Understand you have no legal recourse if shares are denied Consider your age and health realistically - any pre-existing condition puts you at significant risk The monthly savings aren't worth six-figure medical debt if shares are denied when you need them most. That said, I respect that some people have used them successfully and are comfortable with the risks. Just make sure you understand what you're accepting before making this choice, because the consequences of getting it wrong are severe."

↳ @patriot2510 (0): "medicare would go bankrupt in one month"

HealthCare.gov or the state exchange on their own · 104 documents

"ACA isn't so affordable Long story short, we'll be losing our healthcare come June. My wife has inherited a long list of health issues, and has been hospitalized 5x since January, anywhere from a week to 2 at a time. Essentially she's been hospitalized for 2 of the last 3 months in total. There's no end in sight for this. I make 62,500 a year, and she made 70,000 a year prior to this, providing insurance from her job as well. She'll be down to whatever SSDI is come June, and has made 60% of her normal wages thus far. I estimate our income at about 90k per year after this. My job is for a semi small family company, and our insurance is ok, but asks about pre-existing conditions. I tried marketplace which said if our income was below 108k per year we qualified for discounts! Yeah no. It's at a minimum \$12k per year in premiums, plus \$18k max out of pockets. I don't know about you, but it's a bit difficult paying 30 grand per year on a 90k income BEFORE taxes. And she will absolutely max the out of pocket week one. These stays are ICU stays, we're already in the millions. If you factor out taxes, we're left with about \$70k, giving me 40k for her, myself, and our 1 year old. This sucks. My only other option would be a divorce, and since her only income would be social security she would then qualify for Medicaid, but I guess that takes 2 years after you have a disability."

— r/HealthInsurance · 323 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jtjbsg/>

↳ (0): "Your ACA subsidy is based of MAGI and not your W2 income. So you may be eligible for a larger ACA subsidy. Your spouse may be eligible for Medicare irrespective of her age, if she is eligible for SSDI"

↳ (0): "The \$18,000 maximum out of pockets is the only place that I know I have some advise on. You can apply for financial assistance wherever you get care. If you have a remaining balance after they award you financial assistance on your bill, you can make payments. For medications, you can use co-payment cards or have the medications donated to your family as you need. For it to be donated, there is a process to apply, but much less intensive than a bonafide medical bill from a hospital or physician's office. If you are able to utilize co-payment cards for the medications your family needs, it does eat at your out of pocket and deductible under some plans. For me, it has eaten roughly \$3,000.00 of my out of pocket so far, alone."

↳ (0): "The 18K is the family max, the individual out of pocket max is more like 9K. So if she is the major consumer of health care the 9K number is more applicable."

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1s4qs2m/>

↳ (0): "Your husband absolutely needs to find a different new job or you do. Going without insurance is way too risky"

↳ (0): "Try to think of it this way: you can't afford not to have insurance through your employer. Also, you're not going to get much sympathy about having to pay 840 per month for 3 people."

↳ (0): "I saw you commented below you have a combined household income of roughly \$93,000. I don't know what zip code you live in, but just picking a random zip code in Kansas City, there are multiple bronze plans for both your husband and daughter in the range of \$550 per month. I believe you may be entering something in on healthcare.gov incorrectly. If your employer does not offer 'affordable' insurance per the ACA-guidelines, you could also qualify for ACA subsidies as well"

"I had to retire due to medical issues at 55 so we had to go with Marketplace. It's been pretty good, our premiums are under \$150 per month for 2 people and our deductible for family was \$800. No HSA is allowed but we created a medical bucket in our high yield savings account and just transfer money as needed. We keep our income below \$60,000 too. I fear big changes are coming for 2026 though. Guess we will cross that bridge when it comes. God bless all!"

— YouTube · Want to Retire Early? HERE ARE 4 OPTIONS FOR HEALTH INSURANCE! · 145 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wmu0NOIjsfU&lc=Ugyd3n-O0reHcMX3grJ4AaABAg>

↳ @iHealthBrokers (3): "Yes, it is likely that we will see largely increased premiums in the upcoming year. We will release a video previewing 2026 plans soon! Thank you for your comment."

Medicaid or CHIP · 101 documents

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

— r/HealthInsurance · 614 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hmjm0o/>

↳ (0): "You know, \$240 for insurance you can actually use? Isn't bad at all. The new Medicare premium for 2025 is \$185. And that? Is for insurance that's about as useful as tits on a nun, and doesn't include vision or dental coverage. Secondly, the Marketplace is open for enrollment until January 15th: https://www.healthcare.gov/subscribe/?gad_source=1&gclid=CjwKCAiAmrS7BhBJEiwAei59i9Oacg0wxG2w-ZA-CIWv7rQmP1f88oKN4m5i8AvwQGxT-DXXSOE0lhoCgioQAvD_BwE&gclsrc=aw.ds You are still eligible for Marketplace coverage and subsidies if: 1. Your employer-offered insurance is more than 9.12% of your annual income, or the lowest-cost option to cover your family is 9.12% of your household's total income. 2. Your employer-offered insurance doesn't meet ACA standards (which is defined generally as those that offer coverage for doctors and hospitals, and generally pay for 60% of medical costs). If you don't qualify for Medicaid? It's because your income is too high to do so. I don't know what to tell you. It sounds like you rolled the dice, took a chance, and lost."

↳ (0): "13 years working in the world of the Affordable Care Act 8 Years of Provider Services dealing with Medical Professionals 7 Years of Customer Service dealing with individuals' questions on claims and benefits 5 years of Medical Claim Processing So what state do you live in? Does your state have a State-Run Health Insurance Marketplace? My state is still in OPEN ENROLLMENT to enroll in a Health Insurance Plan for 2025 with an effective date of February 1, 2025. The deadline for a January 1 Effective date has passed; the deadline line is midnight December 15, 2024. I am not able to use the tools I have to determine if you are eligible for Tax Subsidies to enroll in a healthcare plan with financial assistance. Your age, yearly income, or Adjusted Gross Income, the tax structure of your household, married, children, filing single, etc, are needed to determine this. Secondly, your Employer offers you a health insurance plan (ESI). Most ESI plans meet the Qualified Health Insurance standard (QHP), as set forth by the Affordable Care Act (ACA). There are two things that a QHP must meet A: They must meet "MINIMUM ESSENTIAL VALUE" - which means a healthcare plan must pay at least 60% of all claims AFTER the deductible is met B: They must meet MINIMUM ESSENTIAL COVERAGE" - meaning they MUST cover the 10 essential health care benefits as outlined in the ACA Law they are, Routine Yearly Physical Walk-In Clinic Services Emergency Room Services Laboratory Services - testing blood, Urine Testing, Biopsy services Pharmacy Mental Health Services both in-patient and out-patient Ambulance Services Prenatal Services (I don't remember them all but these are the most important) Without knowing what your employer plan looks like meaning What does it cost per pay period and what would you pay per pay period What is the Deductible on that plan and what is the Max Out of Pocket Expense on that plan ... is the ESI going to cost you more than 9.07% of your income? ...is the ESI plan just an HSA plan? I like BIG HUGE examples to make a point. Let us assume that your ESI plan reads something like this Yearly Deductible: 10,000 Yearly Max Out of Pocket Expense: \$15,000... You get injured, you get transported by ambulance, to the ER then to Surgery, then to a recovery room, then 5 nights in a hospital with physical therapy, medications, etc...and the total amount owed to the hospital and providers on the day of discharge is \$2 Million. If you were enrolled in the ESI plan, the MOST you pay is \$15,000. Everything else is covered at 100%, you are only responsible for \$15,000. - if the same thing happened again just 4 months later or 2 months later, the total expense you would need to pay is \$0. More information is needed to guide you."

↳ (0): "Non of OPs post makes any sense. They are fishing for upvotes."

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

↳ bourbonfan1647 (68): "Elections have consequences. None of this is a surprise. Welcome to the "find out" phase..."

↳ Stop-Looking_For_Me (48): "Well here it is. The numbers don't lie. Healthcare is going to be fun next year for everyone."

↳ Redtoolbox1 (41): "But the billionaires got their tax cuts they so desperately needed 👍"

"I had to retire due to medical issues at 55 so we had to go with Marketplace. It's been pretty good, our premiums are under \$150 per month for 2 people and our deductible for family was \$800. No HSA is allowed but we created a medical bucket in our high yield savings account and just transfer money as needed. We keep our income below \$60,000 too. I fear big changes are coming for 2026 though. Guess we will cross that bridge when it comes. God bless all!"

— YouTube · Want to Retire Early? HERE ARE 4 OPTIONS FOR HEALTH INSURANCE! · 145 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wmu0NOIjsfU&lc=Ugyd3n-O0reHcMX3grJ4AaABAg>

↳ @iHealthBrokers (3): "Yes, it is likely that we will see largely increased premiums in the upcoming year. We will release a video previewing 2026 plans soon! Thank you for your comment."

Managing income to keep the subsidy · 40 documents

"One strategy i used was a high deductible ACA plan and fully funding a HSA account to lower my MAGI,"

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 42 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgwRt45pBiZY8nTOJTZ4AaABAg>

↳ @Retirement4life (4): "Is it possible to contribute to an existing HSA if you no longer have W2 income? Still learning, TIA"

↳ @randolphh8005 (1): "We did the same, AND contributed to Roth with some PT income. Received \$15k in credits, while contributing \$25k to HSA and Roth. Our premiums were barely \$300/month. It obviously takes some planning the year before."

↳ @LM-lb6tl (1): "Good tip. A few other ones is to use cash savings, line of credit, or high ROC dividend stocks to create a stream of income to lower your AGI until Medicare."

"ACA plans versus just enrolling through private insurer I cannot seem to find an answer to this anywhere I estimate my MAGI to be around ~40k next year. I am not offered health insurance through employer bc I work part time. I have decent amount of assets so I don't have trouble paying higher premiums each month (it also makes my income less predictable with dividends, capital gains etc but i try to keep it as close to 40k as possible with 401k contributions, trad IRA etc.) My question is -- If I go with [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and get a plan there with a subsidy, at the end of the year does it all even out if I were to just pay the higher premium and get the tax rebate when I file taxes? My accountant complains about [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) plans when I file taxes and recommends I just get it directly with the insurer. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1or63n2/>

↳ (0): "I'm an accountant and would never suggest this unless your income was so high you could not possibly qualify for subsidies."

↳ (0): "Yeah I'm also an accountant and I am puzzled by that comment"

↳ (0): "if I understand your question correctly, yes - if you go on [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and get a policy and ask for no subsidy, you will get the subsidy when you file taxes if you qualified. Assuming your accountant files the forms. :). its not exactly hard to file the forms btw. maybe they don't like the manual entry of the 1095-a information. if you don't get the policy from the marketplace, then you will not be eligible for the subsidy."

"Thanks for posting. This is a lot to take in. We are all in a waiting game. We got notice a month or so ago that our provider is not participating in the VA marketplace next year. So we have to choose a new plan. Damn this is frustrating. Fortunately we have been able to control our income this year. So we should get affordable premiums."

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1m60tzo/important_obamacareaca_changes_to_know_heading/n4g5n76/

Went without insurance · 40 documents

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>

↳ (0): "Man, it's a big risk, and if you lose the bet, you're well and truly bad off. One chronic illness, cancer, pregnancy, broken bone, torn ligament and you are SOL. Sure, you can be seen for emergency care under EMTALA, but they don't have to give you chemo or surgery or insulin once you're past the emergency part. 25 is typically young and healthy, but it isn't a guarantee. Best of luck to you."

↳ (0): "My MS first happened at 25, but bc I didn't have insurance until 29 to get diagnosed I have permanent damage and now disabled and unable to work."

↳ (0): "I don't want to upvote this, because it is terrible that you had to go through that, but I'll upvote anyway because it is a perfect example of how things can turn quickly."

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1s4qs2m/>

↳ (0): "Your husband absolutely needs to find a different new job or you do. Going without insurance is way too risky"

↳ (0): "Try to think of it this way: you can't afford not to have insurance through your employer. Also, you're not going to get much sympathy about having to pay 840 per month for 3 people."

↳ (0): "I saw you commented below you have a combined household income of roughly \$93,000. I don't know what zip code you live in, but just picking a random zip code in Kansas City, there are multiple bronze plans for both your husband and daughter in the range of \$550 per month. I believe you may be entering something in on healthcare.gov incorrectly. If your employer does not offer 'affordable' insurance per the ACA-guidelines, you could also qualify for ACA subsidies as well"

"Any self-employed? I don't know how anyone will be able to cover the increase. I have read some will be forced to go without coverage. How will you manage the sticker shock? This is unfathomable, scary, and needless to say, appalling to hear a country as big as the US is forcing people to do this."

— r/obamacare · 98 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojey71/any_selfemployed/

↳ anabanana100 (36): "This is the biggest source of stress in my life. It makes the future look so bleak."

↳ ForeignRevolution905 (22): "Self employed, super stressed about it. Scared to look at the new rates and hoping against hope the Dems prevail in the shutdown fight"

↳ Rigorous-Geek-2916 (18): "Mine doubled. Over \$2300/mo now. No subsidies any more. Still > 1 year to Medicare. Will need to tap into savings to pay for healthcare. Fuck the GOP"

An HSA with a high-deductible plan · 33 documents

"Good video. Learned about ACA 8 years ago. Stopped our 401k contributions immediately and funded a brokerage account. Three years later we retired with a sizeable brokerage account and small IRA withdrawals keep our income low. We pay \$7 a month for a bronze plan with an HSA. We have 3 more years till Medicare"

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 53 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgzYjF309QwWvC00Ald4AaABAg

↳ @scottunclocked (7): "In general No (let me explain). This is the beauty of having the taxable brokerage account. However, capital gains DO count toward your MAGI and any interest earned counts toward MAGI... So a portion of your withdrawal from a taxable brokerage may count toward your MAGI. it does count, but not like withdrawals from a traditional IRA or 401K where all of the withdrawal amounts from these count toward your MAGI because they are treated as "ordinary income"."

↳ @scottunclocked (6): "Thank you for sharing your costs with the ACA option. With getting the subsidies, you can certainly get your costs WAY down. I do wish we would have gotten started a few years sooner with stockpiling money in a taxable brokerage account. This is one thing I would do differently if I was 5-10 years from early retirement. We got started a little late on building a taxable brokerage account. Great moves on your part to prepare for this.... It is going to save you a fortune! How long have you been retired?"

↳ @dereks4228 (4): "Just remember the taxable brokerage account has no bankruptcy protection and can vanish with a serious lawsuit"

"One strategy i used was a high deductible ACA plan and fully funding a HSA account to lower my MAGI,"

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 42 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgwRt45pBiZY8nTOJTZ4AaABAg>

↳ @Retirement4life (4): "Is it possible to contribute to an existing HSA if you no longer have W2 income? Still learning, TIA"

↳ @randolphh8005 (1): "We did the same, AND contributed to Roth with some PT income. Received \$15k in credits, while contributing \$25k to HSA and Roth. Our premiums were barely \$300/month. It obviously takes some planning the year before."

↳ @LM-lb6tl (1): "Good tip. A few other ones is to use cash savings, line of credit, or high ROC dividend stocks to create a stream of income to lower your AGI until Medicare."

"ACA until Medicare? I'm 63 and want to retire soon, so I would be losing my employer coverage at that time. During my employee coverage years, I chose an HDHP plan and put almost 10K into an HSA. I plan on getting the lowest cost Bronze plan and use the HSA funds to cover meds and any other coverages for the 2 years. I realize that if I have a major medical event, I'll need to cover a big deductible/out of pocket maximum, but even that would be less than \$20K per year for a comprehensive gold plan. I have a pre-existing condition, so a private plan is out of the question and my COBRA would cost \$1350/mth. The only downside I can think of with ACA is needing to adhere to the income limit to keep the subsidy for the 2 years. What else am I missing?"

— r/obamacare · 21 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qmvzcn/>

↳ (0): "Just remember, you can't use HSA funds to pay ACA premiums."

↳ (0): "➤ What else am I missing? If your income is controllable during this time (only LTCG, etc. And you have enough available cash in savings or investments that won't incur capital gains to sell) and you can get to 100-150% of FPL, then you should get a silver plan. Will have no deductibles and around \$1000 OOP max. Max cost sharing (lowered deductibles/OOP max) is at 100-150% FPL."

↳ (0): "Yes, only silver plans are eligible for income-based CSR (cost sharing reductions), which lower deductibles, max out of pockets, copays etc. The CSRs can make silver plans way better than gold. If you can get your MAGI (modified adjusted gross income) low enough, it is definitely worth considering silver plans."

A broker or agent · 24 documents

"I thought the income considered for ACA would be income after we retire not total anticipate income for this year. Husband and I are retiring in July this year. I called health broker and was told our 2026 total income does not qualify us for subsidies this year. We can definitely control our MAGI next year. But the cost of health insurance without subsidies for this year is \$2,400 a month for bronze. Crazy"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 155 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgzvkYbznI6KYejn5LV4AaABAq>

↳ @Reanimator7336 (2): "If you work at all in retirement you are not retired."

↳ @TheUnRetired (0): "that is crazy - sorry! here's more about MAGI: https://youtu.be/KDE1jO1z3Sg?si=U8m89wRt_jEUXzMG";

↳ @Reanimator7336 (0): "ACA only goes by taxable income per year period. Its not what tax bracket you are in or gross income."

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the

worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

↳ (0): "Did they drop you because you didn't pay your deductible or because you didn't pay your premium? You say deductible, but the circumstances seem like you didn't pay your premium. The terminology really matters here. If you didn't pay your premium, yes, they will drop you, as will any insurance company. This is typically automatic, as are the letters that are generated to notify you of this. Just trying to get the facts straight. Without accurate facts, no one can provide accurate guidance."

↳ (0): "First, I don't suspect CareFirst would cancel your coverage because of a diagnosis. Granted, it might feel that way, but consider they'd cancel *all* policies for people with an expensive chronic condition following that logic. It was canceled for nonpayment, which you seemed to have remedied. Provided your retroactive payment was enough for reinstatement (and the reinstatement part is what's getting gummed up), you can take this to the VA Bureau of Insurance, as Marketplace plans are regulated at the state level: [<https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-a-n-insurance-complaint/>](<https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-an-insurance-complaint/>);

↳ (0): "automatic resolute arrest chase sip nail rain head treatment crawl *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home>)*!";

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxtql8/>

↳ (0): "Nope. The moving QLE requires the individual to have had qualified coverage for at least one of the 60 days prior to the move. Moving QLE is predicated on the loss of coverage or moving outside the effective coverage area of the current policy."

↳ (0): "These premiums are unsustainable. These prices are like sending a kid to college each year, and that's before your out of pocket costs. But to your question: No, simply changing residency won't allow you to insure after the fact. If you have an accident or emergency situation like a burst appendix, a new plan would not cover those bills retroactively. A cancer or cardiac diagnosis requiring treatment next month? That could work, but you would still face the up front costs of biopsy, tests and diagnosis."

↳ (0): "The thing is that medical bills without insurance are staggeringly high - far, far more than you could save from not paying these extortionate rates. You can very easily be in the \$100k+ territory for some fairly 'routine' surgeries, without even a night in hospital."

Direct primary care and paying cash · 18 documents

"The key to avoiding high healthcare costs is to be healthy. I've been self-employed for over 16 years and have the ACA since it came out. I pick the cheapest plan which gives my coverage in case of an emergency and all my wellness care. I pay \$131 per month for a bronze plan. I have paid up to \$270 per month in past higher earning years. I pay out of pocket for things not covered if I need them and get a 45% self pay discount. I don't pay a lot for healthcare per year and focus on being active and eating healthy non processed foods. I pay less on medical costs than many pay for insurance alone per year. This has been my way to not fund a ridiculously priced industry. I'm nearing 59. Protect your health at all costs!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgxcstwBmYAJgMrsGvh4AaABAg>

↳ @sct4040 (12): "Accidents happen too."

↳ @vogeljennifer6318 (8): "Although this is a great mindset, some people don't have the ability to undo medical issues that require care"

↳ @kona6451 (0): "How old are you? That sounds really cheap"

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

↳ (0): "In short, yes, a provider can always run your information through a carrier website and see if you have insurance or not. Ask for the cash price- say you want to pay cash and not go through insurance."

↳ (0): "They said if I have coverage of any kind (that they don't take of course), then I don't have the option to pay anything but the full cost of the visit :/ I've heard some doctors are more lenient on this than others, which makes me think I should just look for a new doctor. But that feels like a whole other can of worms right now and just kind of overwhelming tbh"

↳ (0): "I mean, OP can ask, but many behavioral health providers don't maintain separate cash-price vs. insurance-price fee schedules. They tend to be more transparent and open about their fees in general, meaning their published fee is the same regardless of payer (although may vary as a function of sliding scales or "scholarships")."

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1lwkcch/>

↳ (0): "It's a class H felony in NC for a provider that accepts medicaid (opted in) to take out of pocket payment for services that would be covered under medicaid. Say you went to a dentist that accepted it, they can only bill you for procedures not covered under medicaid like a crown. They wouldn't be able to bill you for services that are covered under medicaid like a cavity filling. If they never opted in to accept medicaid, then it is not fraud. They never agreed to medicaid terms and conditions at all. If you are concerned, before you do anything, you can always call NCDOI or medicaid and make sure you are okay."

↳ (0): "Yes, it can be. Medicaid is for people who cannot pay their own medical expenses. If you show that you have means to pay for your own medical expenses, the state will assume you do not need Medicaid and have been fraudulently receiving benefits. In my state (MD), there are some Medicaid MCOs that do not require referrals from your PCP to receive specialty care. If you are healthy enough to not need to be followed by a PCP, then it matters a lot less if you cannot find one."

↳ (0): "And provider (practitioner/facility) that is contracted with Medicaid must sign a participation agreement that includes the following: In accordance with 10A NCAC 22J .0106 Providers may bill a patient accepted as a Medicaid patient only in the following situations: For allowable deductibles, co-insurance, or co-payments; Before the service is provided the provider has informed the patient that the patient may be billed for a service that is not one covered by Medicaid regardless of the type of provider or is beyond the limits on Medicaid services; The patient is 65 years of age or older and is enrolled in the Medicare program at the time services are received but has failed to supply a Medicare number as proof of coverage; or The patient is no longer eligible for Medicaid as defined in 10A NCAC 21B."

An accountant or planner and Roth conversions · 8 documents

"That is ridiculously wrong! I am doing it right now! I'm 60 and living on my cash/CD ladder while the majority of my assets sit in my Vanguard ETFs. I have minimal capital gains and interest income... after the standard deduction my income doesn't take me even close 150% of FPL. Therefore I actually have plenty of room to do some Roth conversions. At the 150% FPL I qualify for the absolute highest subsidies. I get my ACA coverage for \$0, most of my copays are between \$0 and \$10, while my deductible is \$0."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=Ugy46l6gaydfloJhDnJ4AaABAq.A2_0CYUxLIJA2_7uy5vnm1

"My wife and I signed up for ACA for 2026 but I got rejected since I'm a vet with a VA disability rating (anybody else have this experience?). So, I use the VA and she uses ACA but we plan on her using faith based coverage in 2027 so we can start doing more Roth conversions before RMDs. I missed the boat on the bridge account but I'm doing the rule of 55 on my 401k."

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHlYeM&lc=UgyAdZaJlkDYopRSV8R4AaABAq>

↳ @keithgilbert835 (3): "Glad you have options."

↳ @BoxTruckNomads (0): "@keithgilbert835yep, it's working out!"

"In the past when I absolutely needed to keep the kids on our ACA/non CHIP plan, we converted small portions of our IRAs to ROTH in low tax brackets. In my case, I had decently healthy kids who would spend the summer away at camps/grandparents, and they needed OOS coverage. since then, our state no longer has any plans with OOS coverage, so it is moot. (The plans have gotten so much worse- the 'network' area is three counties, so even going to an in state school is problematic) A note about teens/young adults on ACA plans. My two were already in college on fantastic financial aid packages when the OOS national network was removed. I ended up having to purchase the plans offered by the colleges, which are extremely comprehensive, but 300\$/ mo each. By the end, I was paying \$300 (kid1), \$300 (kid 2) ~\$300 (older parent on Medicare plus part G and D) \$100 (younger parent on ACA) In previous years, we had managed to get a fantastic plan for all of us for under 100\$ total. As of this moment, the cheapest bronze plan with no subsidy is \$980/ mo just for me. We squeaked by for this year with subsidies, but for 2027 we will have a family size of 2 and also need to do Roth conversions to plan ahead, so maybe 15k just for me plus another ~4K for my spouse."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vli30e/chip_costs_more_than_aca/p31rvcp/

Took a job, or kept one, for the insurance · 6 documents

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— r/obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

↳ Mysterious_Might008 (10): "My bronze ACA plan (TX) has a flat \$50 office visit for my PCP. Specialist office visits are flat \$100. So, I wouldn't be afraid of getting a diagnosis based on office visit fees. As of 2026, all bronze ACA plans are HDHPs. Lab work and other diagnostic procedures are a different story: that's where the mystery hit to the wallet really happens."

↳ SunLillyFairy (8): "Yep! I got charged over \$300 for a diagnostic Vit D test because my ACA insurance deemed it "medically unnecessary" (even though it came back low, they said it wasn't low enough to be necessary), so I didn't even get the contracted rate. I fought it. It took months to get it resolved, and while waiting the lab said I was past due and wouldn't do further lab work, and also kept sending me notices that they were sending me to collections (even though they knew I was appealing through insurance). In the end the insurance changed the category and I paid less than 50.. but SO lame."

↳ MrLB____ (8): "Yes, I agree total scam. You could even buy insurance from the hospital itself via the affordable care act go to their own net work, all owned by the same company the doctor office hospital scam their own insurance company LOL Then insurance scams them back"

"We retired early and we took the silver plan from the market place. \$2400 a month and it was useless. The deductible and out of pocket was so high, the insurance never paid for anything. What a scam! It honestly drove me back to work, just for the insurance. I sure wish my husband was willing to live out of country for a time."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvoxJEWGo&lc=UgxWsbWgrBC4jKr28s54AaABAq>

↳ @ariefraiser140 (11): "If you guys were paying \$2400/month that means you guys had a pretty big AGI."

↳ @michaelcoglianese4292 (7): "@ariefraiser140so what? That's still ridiculously high amount for insurance"

↳ @metalgirl (2): "I agree... our insurance is twice that. Stupid high. So not fair!!!"

"I've made the decision to quit my dead-end job at Starbucks with nothing lined up. I posted my plan on Reddit and several posters asked me "but what about your health insurance?!?" People really think it's crazy that I'm leaving my toxic job because I will lose these benefits. I have not used my health insurance once in my three years there. I'm young and healthy so I don't need to visit a doctor. The only thing is if I were to get in a big accident or suddenly fall extremely ill. But I would just deal with it if it happens. It's just terrible that people stay in soul-sucking jobs just for health insurance, and I'm not going to be one of those people. I'll figure it out. So many jobs, including low-level retail jobs if I needed to go that route again in desperation, have health insurance included, so I will be just fine."

— YouTube · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236lZc&lc=UgyJ3WQDGaGA0qwi3PR4AaABAq>

↳ @tammihazard8362 (0): "They are fanatical on there"

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Wish sentences are rare in this voice: they describe what happened and ask what to do. The tab is stated as thin rather than padded.

Theme	Documents
Wishing premiums matched what they can pay	13
Should have chosen or estimated differently	6

Wishing premiums matched what they can pay · 13 documents

"My health insurance just went to \$60,000 a year for a silver PPO Prepare for sticker shock. Just checked the IL exchange today, and my BCBS HDHP went from \$1200 a month after subsidies to \$2925 after subsidies (**the plan cost is 60k per year**) the reasons for this are two-fold 1. Expiration of enhanced subsidies 2. The site allowing junk insurers to claim SLC status (benchmark) with plans no one can use. For my area it is an OSCAR HMO which virtually no hospital system or doctor accepts. OSCAR has a 1 star rating from the BBB and dozens of lawsuits against it for failure to pay claims. so I now have to hunt around for a HMO, and my family will lose its doctors. The PPACA as originally passed prevented insurance premiums from eating up more than a certain percentage of your annual income. At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments so I will lose my doctor(s) at the very least and pay way beyond what the law said I was going to. pretty sure I am seeing why some politicians are saying we should tear up the PPACA altogether, because it clearly isn't working, and made a bad situation worse"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,000 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1okz6n1/>

↳ (0): "OP didn't ask for guidance or request any answers. Locking before it spirals even further. Edit: Just to address OP's misguided frustration over the PPACA: In 2021, the Biden administration introduced *enhanced advanced premium tax credits* (eAPTCs) through the American Rescue Plan Act. They were further extended through the Inflation Reduction Act. Through these eAPTCS, folks beyond 400% of the federal poverty level could guarantee they'd spend no more than 8.5% of their household income on health insurance premiums through Marketplace (provided they chose a silver benchmark plan). The reason your subsidies are falling flat is because these enhanced subsidies are not being renewed. This is reason number one behind the government shutdown. One side wants to make these eAPTCs permanent. I'll let you deduce who that is. The PPACA didn't "make a bad situation worse". The current majority party has worked tirelessly to make it worse."

↳ (0): "Wait, how is \$2,925 per month \$60,000 per year?"

↳ (0): "Seems insurance going up regardless of subsidies"

"I retired at 47 and the ACA subsidies are returning to exactly the way they worked then. I surely didn't expect the enhanced subsidies to become permanent. I would love it if they did, but people who pursue early retirement have a plan for maximizing subsidies and this shouldn't be a major hurdle for them. Keeping your MAGI low as an early retiree isn't particularly hard and should have been planned for. I'm still hoping for the return of the enhanced subsidies as they make a lot more sense. The cliff was always such a terrible part of the original ACA."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oodemw/aca_the_cliff_is_a_big_issue/nn3h71t/

"As nice as it is, the ridiculous gulf between with subsidy monthly premium cost at 400% FPL and 400% FPL+\$1 cliff needs to be addressed. My Bronze plan if under 400% FPL is around \$50/month. One dollar over the 400% FPL it jumps to \$1048/month. Jesus Christ how regressive can you get that me making \$62,601 (a buck over the 400% threshold) pays the same amount as someone making \$10,000,000 a year for the same plan? Sure, if it would really help the program charge me \$100/month at less than 400% FPL, and drop the insane cliff bullshit. Say add 10% to the cost for every \$10k above the 400% FPL? This madness is going to kill a lot of people as it stands; shit even with a low cost premium, so many can not cover the deductible, co-pays, etc."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pupkpu/hakeem_jeffries_says_obamacare_subsidy_extension/nvtftj4/

Should have chosen or estimated differently · 6 documents

"Billed \$1600 so far for free preventative colonoscopy I'm 52 years old and never had a colonoscopy so I thought I would take advantage of the \$0 out of pocket preventative colon cancer screening through my ACA health plan. I had the colonoscopy last month and a couple days ago I got an email from the hospital saying that I have a bill. It's \$1600 for the colonoscopy. I went to reddit of course and saw that reddit seems to agree that it should have been free. No polyps were found. I spent hours on the phone yesterday with the hospital and the insurance company. The lady at the hospital told me that I was mistaken about preventative care being free. She said that there are thousands of different plans and each plan does it differently. She said they submitted my claim and the insurance paid for part of it and that I am responsible for the other \$1600. After talking to her for a while I wasn't getting anywhere so we agreed to disagree and I called the insurance company. The insurance rep spoke English as a second language and didn't seem to understand the point I was making. She told me how much the total was, how much insurance had paid, and how much I was responsible for. When I said things like "I think there is a mistake, this should be free of charge since it was preventative" she simply repeated the totals as if she didn't understand. She was supposed to call me back at 2pm today and never called. I guess I will be spending tomorrow on the phone again trying to get the \$1600 taken off my bill. Nobody I have talked to so far is aware of the ACA policy that preventative care is covered in full. They seem to think that I am just saying that to get out of paying my bill. Any advice for what I can say tomorrow. Edit: OK, I just got off the phone with the United Healthcare rep. She said that there was no mistake. She said I had 2 procedures done and only one was preventative. I asked her for the diagnostic codes for the procedures and she only gave me one code G0121. She seemed like she wanted to get me off the phone so I didn't argue. She apologized several times and said there was no mistake, I have to pay the \$1600. I had a referral for "Screening for colon cancer Z12.11" and have no knowledge of any second procedure. EDIT 2 OK I got some more info today. I confirmed that my plan offers the colon cancer screening at 0% copay and no deductible. The insurance says that I got the colon cancer screening paid for (they paid \$150). But I was charged \$1600 for an endoscopy that was not preventative care. All the CPT codes are missing for the non-preventative endoscopy. Here it is called a HC colonoscopy. The person I talked to said that my primary code was Z12.11 and my secondary code was K57.30 <https://preview.redd.it/3qbqhqld7ug1.png?width=700&format=png&auto=webp&s=7ec1b565073bcc88f0403c5064e0be6ec17b28b6> <https://preview.redd.it/09k2gdppd7ug1.png?width=691&format=png&auto=webp&s=9e15198b82f8833f30009a763184c6e58817a42f> Update 3 I talked to a different insurance rep today and got a completely different reason for my bill. This one acknowledged that I only had one procedure and that it was a colonoscopy, not an endoscopy. She said that while a colonoscopy can be preventative, mine was not preventative because I had it done in a hospital. I asked her where I should have gone to get a preventative colonoscopy and she said that I should have gone to an office. I told her I went to my doctor's office and they referred me to the hospital. She said she understands it is frustrating and offered to help me file a claim adjustment request. So in 10 to 15 days I should be getting the decision. I still think it makes no sense because they paid the claim submitted by the doctor who performed the colonoscopy even though he did it at a hospital. But the claim submitted by the hospital was not preventative because the colonoscopy happened at a hospital."

— r/HealthInsurance · 233 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sg3ast/>

↳ (0): "If it's a true ACA plan, you'd be correct and there seems there would be some sort of issue with them processing. Where did you get your ACA plan? Do you have a copy of the EOB you can post?"

↳ (0): "Did you confirm the doctor you used was in network?"

↳ (0): "Also - an issue we ran into once is that the procedure the colonoscopy being done by the doctor is indeed included but not the facility fee. So you have to pay a facility fee - and even if they are in network they could be not covered."

"I estimated my income for 2025 within \$1200 of what it actually was and I still owe \$680! Very frustrating. I can easily pay it but there are probably people who can't. I don't understand how my subsidy amount was off by \$54 per month. I absolutely would overestimate, wish I would have done it for 2026."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/o7l2a6a/

"@davidnprogressI reimbursed myself for my medical expenses for about five years before the lightbulb went off, and I switched to cash flowing the expenses while stockpiling the ACA contributions as an investment account. A few years ago, I moved the HSA from my local credit union to Fidelity for a vastly improved interest rate. Wish I had known to do that sooner!"

— YouTube · Why I Chose a Bronze ACA Plan With Heart Failure (2026 Coverage + HSA Strategy) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Vt81218uhdU&lc=Ugz-wboCcPlzPYW7D3J4AaABAq.APOrJfdX-yYAPQnfdDfrXD>

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Theme	Documents
Free to work for themselves or retire early	29
Covered at a price they can pay	21
Medicaid worked for them	7
The ACA saved them: pre-existing conditions covered	6
Found a better or cheaper plan by shopping	6

Free to work for themselves or retire early · 29 documents

"\$2600/mth, \$6k deductible for wife and I Blue Shield Bronze HSA PPO w/ \$6k deductible is looking like \$2650/mth for 2026, for wife and I (middle aged, in good health). This is a CoveredCA ACA plan, and I'm self-employed. This is completely unaffordable. Having already cut all our costs to the bone, I only have one option, which is to raise my rates, and hope that my competitors will also be raising theirs too so mine aren't extortionate. The only other thing I could do it seems is to become younger, which I'll try and organize, but seems to have some complex issues. This is going to massively, massively spike inflation."

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o9m8gp/>

↳ (0): "Please don't worry the golden ballroom and Arch monument funding is safe."

↳ (0): "But what about Argentina???"

↳ (0): "They're good, we just doubled down and sent another 20 billion"

"[US] How many of you are going without health insurance? Like everybody else my health insurance almost doubled this year, and I'm honestly not sure I can take another (probably) 20% increase next year. It's to the point where I'm sacrificing contributing to retirement to pay for health insurance (I'm 35, healthy, single and literally have never used my insurance) Are there any options out there other than marketplace for those who are self employed?"

— r/selfemployed · 23 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1w2kg0j/>

↳ (0): "Hey OP. Before you drop it — "healthy and never use it" is exactly the profile one bad day wrecks. It's not the doctor visits. It's the accident or the scan that comes back wrong. Insurance isn't for the year nothing happens; it's for the year something does. I'm 29 and a self-employed health insurance broker myself (total transparency), and that's the only reason I have it (the big what-ifs) A better question than "should I keep insurance?" is "what's the cheapest real coverage for someone healthy?" Worth knowing: **Private, medically underwritten plans** can be priced based on your actual health instead of averaging you in. Often cheaper if you're genuinely healthy. They can also decline you, so if there's anything in your history, it's usually not the route. **High-deductible plan plus an HSA**. Low premium, and the HSA money is yours — it rolls over and follows you, unlike a deductible that resets every January. **Skip health shares**. They aren't insurance, aren't regulated like it, and aren't legally required to pay anything. People find that out at the worst time. At 35 and healthy, price a bronze marketplace plan against an underwritten private one and compare. Your income decides which wins — under the subsidy threshold, the marketplace math changes completely."

↳ (0): "I'm saving this comment"

↳ (0): "I only have it thanks to my wife's work."

"The subsidy is the ONLY reason I have been able to quit working at 62 and have insurance."

— YouTube · Will ACA Subsidies Disappear After 2025? What You NEED to Know! · 21 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzXsJQmS9xs&lc=Ugytp8nxLMd_bBU8xgx4AaABAg

↳ @Sebastian-CoveredCA (3): "Absolutely! I know a fellow broker who's helped countless people retire early by leveraging ACA subsidies. More people deserve to know about these affordable options — I might even make a video on this soon thanks to your comment."

↳ @JackBenny-o1g (0): "I dont qualify for them now. Cant retire."

↳ @anniesshenanigans3815 (0): "@JackBenny-o1g why is that?"

Covered at a price they can pay · 21 documents

"The government should really open up Medicare with reasonable premiums for those 55 -65. Age discrimination is preventing a lot of people from getting hired these days. Even ACA is costing me 1K a month for me and spouse. My spouse's work insurance was much more expensive. My COBRA just ended after I lost my job 18 months ago and it was 1500 a month going up to 2K this year. I stayed on COBRA because we already satisfied the max out of pocket and it was good insurance."

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Retire Before 65 · 72 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l8VY8AcaLww&lc=UgxUWCq0OC_S-rSQahN4AaABAq

↳ @DesigningRetirement (2): "Health sharing ministries like Medishare, Samaritan Ministries, and Christian Healthcare Ministries are an option some people use, but it's crucial to understand what they are and aren't before making this choice - especially for people over 50. What they are: Member-based cost-sharing programs where members contribute monthly "shares" that are used to pay each other's medical expenses. They're often significantly cheaper than ACA plans (\$300-500/month vs. \$800-1,500+) and are based on shared religious values and community support. What they're NOT: Insurance. They have no legal obligation to pay your medical bills. If the ministry determines your situation doesn't meet their guidelines, you're responsible for the full bill - and you have no legal recourse. Critical limitations for people approaching or in retirement: 1. Pre-existing conditions: Most health sharing ministries don't cover pre-existing conditions at all, or impose waiting periods of 1-3+ years. For people over 50, the vast majority have at least one pre-existing condition - high blood pressure, high cholesterol, diabetes, previous surgeries, arthritis, etc. If you develop cancer, need heart surgery, or face other major medical needs related to a pre-existing condition, your bills may not be "shared." 2. No guarantee of payment: If the ministry determines your situation doesn't qualify (didn't follow protocols, didn't get pre-approval, condition isn't "shareable" per their guidelines), you pay the full bill. There's no insurance commissioner to appeal to, no legal protection. 3. Coverage exclusions vary widely: Many exclude mental health care, some exclude certain cancer treatments, some require you to try lower-cost treatments first, some won't share bills if you didn't get pre-approval. You must read the specific guidelines carefully - not the marketing materials, but the actual sharing guidelines. Real-world outcomes - both exist: Some people use health sharing ministries for years successfully, paying for routine care and minor issues at much lower monthly cost than insurance. Other people have been left with \$50,000-200,000+ in medical debt when the ministry denied their shares for cancer treatment, heart surgery, or other major expenses - often after treatment has already occurred, when they're most vulnerable. Where they might work: Healthy people under 50 with no pre-existing conditions People with strong religious convictions about community-based sharing People who have financial resources to self-pay if shares are denied Very short-term bridge situations (though risky) Where they're dangerous: People over 50 (very high likelihood of health issues) Anyone with chronic conditions or health history People who can't afford large unexpected medical bills Anyone facing major illness (exactly when you need guaranteed coverage) My honest perspective: For most people over 50 navigating the gap before Medicare, I strongly encourage sticking with ACA-compliant insurance despite the cost. The guaranteed coverage of pre-existing conditions and legal consumer protections are worth the premium difference when you're at the age where major health issues become more likely. If ACA premiums feel truly unaffordable, explore subsidies based on current income (not last year's - this trips people up), Medicaid eligibility if income is low enough, or working with a healthcare navigator to find the most affordable ACA-compliant option. If you're still considering health sharing ministries: Read the actual sharing guidelines (not marketing materials) - understand exactly what is and isn't shareable Assume you'll need to self-pay for major illness - if you can't afford that risk, don't take it Understand you have no legal recourse if shares are denied Consider your age and health realistically - any pre-existing condition puts you at significant risk The monthly savings aren't worth six-figure medical debt if shares are denied when you need them most. That said, I respect that some people have used them successfully and are comfortable with the risks. Just make sure you understand what you're accepting before making this choice, because the consequences of getting it wrong are severe."

↳ @patriot2510 (0): "medicare would go bankrupt in one month"

"Thanks for posting. This is a lot to take in. We are all in a waiting game. We got notice a month or so ago that our provider is not participating in the VA marketplace next year. So we have to choose a new plan. Damn this is frustrating. Fortunately we have been able to control our income this year. So we should get affordable premiums."

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1m60tzo/important_obamacareaca_changes_to_know_heading/n4g5n76/

"First time viewer... and now a subscriber. I retired early at 58, after 35 yrs in the health insurance world. I am a self proclaimed ACA expert.... and loved seeing how accurate you are at outlining the details. Well done!!! I was fortunate enough to have planned my cash bucket (CDs) and investments to allow me to keep my MAGI at the absolute bottom, so I pay \$0 premium for the best silver.... and have been trying to help everyone achieve the same status."

— YouTube · Will ACA Subsidies Disappear After 2025? What You NEED to Know! · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzXsJQmS9xs&lc=Ugw53JBOOcJ3-XYDzgl4AaABAg>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (0): "Thanks so much for subscribing and for the kind words! Coming from someone with your background in health insurance, that really means a lot! Sounds like you've done an amazing job planning your early retirement and keeping your MAGI low — great example for others and that's such a great service you're providing by helping others!"

↳ @heflight (0): "@Davek111 do you offer a service that helps folks keep their MAGI low?"

Medicaid worked for them · 7 documents

"The income requirement is ridiculous. Medicaid saved me at least \$20k when I had to find my own insurance for my family after a layoff. The tech job market was terrible and it took me 10 months to find something. Even cutting out all unnecessary spending we were burning cash. I am fortunate in that I was/am in a much better financial place than most people and I could absorb the hit without collateral damage. They are going to wipe a lot of people out when they crash the economy if this becomes the law."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1kzrpq7/it_appears_that_the_big_bill_now_has_a_minimum/mvidpyu/

"When I was an independent contractor, I was shelling out \$1800/month for health insurance for a family of four. Let that sink in. \$1800-a-month! Fortunately, the contract paid well so it was worth it. And, yes, there are cheaper options via Bronze or Silver plans but, for our family needs, a Gold plan made more sense. As BTB mentioned, California has subsidies if you are in a lower income bracket and we also have Medi-Cal (aka Medicaid or free government insurance) for those in the lowest income brackets."

— YouTube · Health Insurance After Quitting Your Job · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2xGHnufEwvs&lc=UgxO0HHIarKOQILHo854AaABAg>

↳ @BeatTheBush (0): "\$1800 is more than what I spend in a month. OMG"

"I retired 24 years ago at 45 financed mostly by slow flipping houses I live in. \$250k cap gain tax free. When ACA started I qualified for Medicaid.\$0 cost, \$0 copay, \$0 deductible. Best insurance I ever had. At 65 Medicare + Medicaid so parts B and D, copays, deductible all free. Plus a free phone via Lifeline. Waiting until 70 to take SS. Also sweet is I don't even have to file income tax!"

— YouTube · New Health Insurance Rules Just Created a Hack For Retirees · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MZfLaPA1bsM&lc=UgxHu3N_p-xbF-wp6vt4AaABAq

↳ @devilsfmetfan6393 (1): "Medicaid insurance is crap, no good doctors accept it"

↳ @ginaforfsu (1): "A lot of the middle class supplements healthcare for those with far more money and worth. The tax strategy is legal, but it's not moral. My neighbor retired with \$2M and a few rental properties and pays nothing for healthcare. I haven't received child support for 3 years and frequently pick up part-time work to pay bills and save for my own retirement, yet I get to help pay for her healthcare."

↳ @MotionRetirement (0): "Thanks for watching and sharing!"

The ACA saved them: pre-existing conditions covered · 6 documents

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxm828/>

↳ (0): "Health shares are NOT insurance."

↳ (0): "you're young and healthy with no preexisting conditions until you aren't. during a routine physical my doctor found a large mass on my thyroid. it happens in the blink of an eye."

↳ (0): "Healthshares are scams"

"Turning 60 in October and in early retirement due to a reduction in force. I'm now on ACA and thankful for not having to pay \$1100 a month for medical insurance. Thanks ACA and Julie!"

— YouTube · Is It UNETHICAL to Get ACA Subsidies in EARLY Retirement? (An Early Retiree's Perspective) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NDJZHalcgJw&lc=Ugy7Cfqjo1j4MsBFqGB4AaABAq>

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "Well congrats on retiring! 🥳🎉 You're welcome! I'm also grateful for ACA! 😊"

"When I was in my early thirties I had appendicitis, my insurance ended shortly after and I was stuck paying the aftercare. Meanwhile I was looking for new insurance and I got complications of the surgery. To make a long story short, I ended up with a very large medical bill. (They gave me 28 years to pay!) The rare complication made me uninsurable, so I wasn't able to get insurance until I heard about the ACA bridge program that was for uninsurable people until the ACA was implemented— so I racked up more medical debt. Shortly after that a family member living abroad got cancer and needed her payments up front before treatment, I couldn't not help. Already financially strained, I started a go fund me for her and got \$0, which is not uncommon! I always tell people to take my story as a warning, make sure you always have medical insurance. I too had insurance on and off when I was young, not anymore!"

— YouTube · I'm Young & Healthy, Can I Skip Health Insurance? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WTtjmdyTCRM&lc=UgwJ15O0yVvXengFhdl4AaABAg>

Found a better or cheaper plan by shopping · 6 documents

"Great video Erin. You are truly the best at explaining these financial concepts on YouTube. There is one other option that might be available for some people. I recently lost my COBRA coverage, and was planning on moving to an ACA plan. The ACA plans were very expensive for me, so I contacted an insurance broker who was able to get me coverage for \$600 less per month. I believe it's insurance used by an association of people who are self employed or run small businesses. I think it's cheaper because I am getting a group rate."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 25 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgxdZnnFFEMvll3FaXN4AaABAg

↳ @jinxjink7457 (1): "How in the world was COBRA cheaper than ACA?! COBRA is criminally exorbitantly pocket-draining lol. I see premiums for >\$1k, so I'm surprised you were struggling with shifting from COBRA to ACA."

↳ @Steve-w7x6h (0): "@jinxjink7457 Without subsidies from the government, the ACA policies were much more expensive. They went up a lot from last year also."

↳ @WestonMorrisdoBrasil (0): "@jinxjink7457 Some companies self insure rather than using an insurance company for their employees. Depending on the medical costs incurred by the employees, that companies medical insurance costs could be relatively low."

"Imperial Health on ACA I just wanted to post about my experience with Imperial which I purchased on the exchange. I have used "Obamacare" since it first started. I was without insurance before that as I hired a broker to find me insurance while I was self employed and because of a medication I took at the time .. no one would cover me so ACA was a god send. Until about 2 years ago .. I never really had medical issues. I visit a doctor 4 times a year maybe and used teladoc but about 2 years ago I got very sick which required emergency room care, paddles to the chest to get my heart working right and 5 days in the hospital. Bill before insurance came to just about \$80,000. Add to that some additional aftercare added later. Insurance did their part and I averted financial catastrophe. Yay ACA!!!!!!!!!!!!!! This year selections on ACA in Arizona seemed far less than usual and the company I had been using was priced out of reach so I selected Imperial Health Gold Standard. It costs me just \$200 less than what my rent does a month but .. When you need it the cost pales in comparison to hospital costs. About a week or so after choosing the plan I got the bill. Paid on November 24. Then .. nothing. I got a receipt but didnt hear anything else From Imperial Health Insurance for weeks. Wasn't even sure I was going to have insurance since I received no confirmation. Nothing. Second week of December I start looking around on the net for information and many of their links dont work. The links that do work point you at websites that look like they haven't been updated since 1990. A little nervous but I figure "hey if removing polished (functioning) websites and extra paper helps keep the cost down cool" Finally I find a number and call only to do the phone chase through different people out of country trying to find out if I am indeed covered for the coming year. I do get my membership number and am assured I will be covered. This took about 3 hours. With it I find my online membership card. I am now HOURS into this. I discover the pcp they picked for me is 60 miles from where I live. I do not live in some remote area. I live in Mesa AZ so I know there must be closer doctors. Problem is, while my last insurance company allowed you to change PCP online .. there was no provision for doing so with Imperial health so back to the phones. A primary reason I selected Imperial Insurance is because on ACA it stated that Imperial health Insurance covered my PCP who I used for 5 years+ and the hospital my doctor was associated with. I got it changed and was told to expect a packet from them with my card and that the first card would have the Assigned PCP and a little later I would get the card with my chosen PCP. The company was a little behind and was just sending out "Packages" And I waited. it was nerve racking as I had always received at least a welcome to the company letter/email something but nothing .. just ghost. No "packet" no nothing. Comes Jan1 .. still no card. Now I already downloaded the card from the site I found but .. not everyone knows how to dig through internet garbage to get to that point and had I indeed needed doctoring on the 1st .. I would have been unable to prove I had insurance. I paid for insurance that would begin on the 1st and had no way of proving I had insurance on the 1st. On Jan 2nd .. I try to call to find out where the "Packet and card were. Automated service said would I like a call back .. Nope I will wait .. Great you are number 250 on line. I guess a bunch of other people were wondering where their card was as well!?!? The morning of the 3rd I picked up my card at the mail. There was a single sheet. at the bottom was a paper thin card. Fine we are saving money. The letter had a brief three sentences that said here is your card and if you want to know anything go to Imperial health . com. There is virtually no useful information at the site they direct you to. You will have to do long term digging from there. Personal .. here is your plan and here is what is covered is not available at that site or its links Had I not started to chase this down earlier I would have had to submit a request to change pcp and wait 24 hrs plus or use the one they gave me which was 60 miles away. No snap shot of coverage no nothing .. here is your card 2 days late and if you want to know anything .. go to our shitty website and try and find out. Luckily I take care of my health so hope to have a year like last year where I used insurance 4 times but if this is their level of organization up front .. I am very concerned what will happen if an emergency arises .. I am not two weeks into Insurance with Imperial Health, cant afford to go without insurance and cant change it but .. If your still selecting for Feb1 start .. I would look elsewhere. This company does not seem to have its shit together and trust me .. when the medical bills start flying .. you need a company that has their shit together. We learned that with my Emergency and with my wifes cancer diagnosis and treatment. I do not feel confident with Imperial health but wont go without insurance so now I am stuck Edited to add I have been trying this website since I received my membership number so about 3 weeks. This is what I get .. a spinning wheel that says Processing and this will spin forever. Tried it in Brave, Firefox and Edge. None of them can open this page. It contains information about my plan .. I cant see it!? I have been trying for almost a month. I think the site servers are overwhelmed so I cant arrange autopay, see my policy or .. anything but that spinning circle. <https://preview.redd.it/cokxg0a9jkcg1.jpg?width=3060&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=83258471e1a05666f536b5fd6d325b744f7507d6>";

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q9bscn/>

↳ (0): "DO NOT USE THIS SCAM COMPANY. PAY EXTRA FOR A BETTER OPTION. THESE PEOPLE WILL SIMPLY TAKE YOUR (AND TAXPAYER) MONEY AND FIND CHICKENSHIT WAYS NOT TO COVER YOUR CLAIMS (Like refusing to give you your PCP even though they're in network)"

↳ (0): "I still have not received any information or contact from them. No information about my plan coverage not even a welcome letter. I received a bill for sure but what it covers .. Who knows because I haven't received any information and none is available online. I'm paying 650 a month out of pocket .. All I can do is hope I don't need it and wait out until next year"

↳ (0): "i strongly suggest switching to a different carrier. these guys are worthless. when you need them to cover something, you'll probably have to hire an attorney to get them to cover anything"

"UHC has 49m members, so that's about \$125/member. About \$600 annually. Considering my health insurance premiums were 15k last year, I currently have bigger fish to fry than getting UHC to take a pay cut. Saving \$600 is a 4% savings, it's immaterial."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1w7m4qf/paid_premium_denied_care/p7xha0m/

Tab 9 — Typical Day

There is no daily routine in this corpus; what repeats is watching income against the limit, bills and appeals, and skipped care.

Theme	Documents
Steering income to stay under the line: Roth conversions, fewer hours, turned-down work	78
Bills, EOBs and fighting charges	53
Checking the marketplace and doing the math	27
Skipping care and rationing prescriptions	12

Steering income to stay under the line: Roth conversions, fewer hours, turned-down work · 78 documents

"I had to retire due to medical issues at 55 so we had to go with Marketplace. It's been pretty good, our premiums are under \$150 per month for 2 people and our deductible for family was \$800. No HSA is allowed but we created a medical bucket in our high yield savings account and just transfer money as needed. We keep our income below \$60,000 too. I fear big changes are coming for 2026 though. Guess we will cross that bridge when it comes. God bless all!"

— YouTube · Want to Retire Early? HERE ARE 4 OPTIONS FOR HEALTH INSURANCE! · 145 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wmu0NOIjsfU&lc=Ugyd3n-O0reHcMX3grJ4AaABAg>

↳ @iHealthBrokers (3): "Yes, it is likely that we will see largely increased premiums in the upcoming year. We will release a video previewing 2026 plans soon! Thank you for your comment."

"If I thought I would stop working and be off my employer medical plan next year and do not qualify for Medicaid or Medicare at this time would this yr be a good time to do a big Roth conversion as subsidies are based out the expected income in a yr and the conversion would be done the year before?"

— YouTube · Retirees: How to Protect ACA Subsidies in 2026 · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H_gCQfekS_c&lc=Ugy7u93Ti2GBNPWYb7R4AaABAg

"Good video. Learned about ACA 8 years ago. Stopped our 401k contributions immediately and funded a brokerage account. Three years later we retired with a sizeable brokerage account and small IRA withdrawals keep our income low. We pay \$7 a month for a bronze plan with an HSA. We have 3 more years till Medicare"

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 53 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgzYjF309QwWvC00Ald4AaABAg

↳ @scottunclocked (7): "In general No (let me explain). This is the beauty of having the taxable brokerage account. However, capital gains DO count toward your MAGI and any interest earned counts toward MAGI... So a portion of your withdrawal from a taxable brokerage may count toward your MAGI. it does count, but not like withdrawals from a traditional IRA or 401K where all of the withdrawal amounts from these count toward your MAGI because they are treated as "ordinary income"."

↳ @scottunclocked (6): "Thank you for sharing your costs with the ACA option. With getting the subsidies, you can certainly get your costs WAY down. I do wish we would have gotten started a few years sooner with stockpiling money in a taxable brokerage account. This is one thing I would do differently if I was 5-10 years from early retirement. We got started a little late on building a taxable brokerage account. Great moves on your part to prepare for this.... It is going to save you a fortune! How long have you been retired?"

↳ @dereks4228 (4): "Just remember the taxable brokerage account has no bankruptcy protection and can vanish with a serious lawsuit"

Bills, EOBs and fighting charges · 53 documents

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oig6zm/>

↳ (0): "My recent short 3 hour visit to ER costs (EKG and blood test) over \$10k. Your assumptions of "thousands" is off by an order of magnitude."

↳ (0): "The income limit for hospital assistance is not based on what you think you could justify paying on a bill. It's based solely on their guidelines. Not everyone who is uninsured gets assistance."

↳ (0): "Health Actuary here. This is the "wrong" answer, but I'd be lying if I said I wouldn't go uninsured in your position."

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😞) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday.

UPDATE: I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😞) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to

forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 🙄 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 🙄 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting, failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an" — r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tmp52c/>

↳ (0): "If she is an in-network provider she has a contract with your insurance provider and has agreed to their reimbursement rates. Confirm with your insurance company that her and her office are in-network. If she's collecting the "remaining balance" from patients she's breaking her contractual obligation. Providers cannot ask you to give up your rights to not be balance billed. Also, it sounds like you're no longer comfortable with her either way and it'd be best to find another provider"

↳ (0): "OP your insurance can also do a three-way call with the provider and you to explain everything (if they actually are in network)."

↳ (0): "I'm a psychologist. Your therapist is in network and has agreed to the rate that the insurance company set. She or he cannot "balance bill" you. Depending on your state, it may be illegal. Regardless of state, it's unethical and in violation of the agreement that the therapist made with the insurance company as an in-network provider. If you want to go hard, you can report them to their licensing board for unethical behavior. At a minimum, I would not stick with this therapist. They're either uneducated or unethical. You don't want either of those in a therapist."

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the

worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

↳ (0): "Did they drop you because you didn't pay your deductible or because you didn't pay your premium? You say deductible, but the circumstances seem like you didn't pay your premium. The terminology really matters here. If you didn't pay your premium, yes, they will drop you, as will any insurance company. This is typically automatic, as are the letters that are generated to notify you of this. Just trying to get the facts straight. Without accurate facts, no one can provide accurate guidance."

↳ (0): "First, I don't suspect CareFirst would cancel your coverage because of a diagnosis. Granted, it might feel that way, but consider they'd cancel *all* policies for people with an expensive chronic condition following that logic. It was canceled for nonpayment, which you seemed to have remedied. Provided your retroactive payment was enough for reinstatement (and the reinstatement part is what's getting gummed up), you can take this to the VA Bureau of Insurance, as Marketplace plans are regulated at the state level: [<https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-a-n-insurance-complaint/>](<https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-an-insurance-complaint/>);

↳ (0): "automatic resolute arrest chase sip nail rain head treatment crawl *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home>)*";

Checking the marketplace and doing the math · 27 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om828r/>

↳ (0): "Premiums just went through the roof! Judging by estimated cost increases and comparing to what we've been paying ... yeah, I'd say that's about right. I would definitely call someone tho!"

↳ (0): "Welcome to the new normal. Pay or die"

↳ (0): "In America it's 'pay and still die'."

"Just got booted from my insurance Not sure what to do now. Just got cut off of medicaid after they looked at my most recent tax return. I live in Michigan and I make like \$1,700 more than their limit on average they say. I work as a school bus attendant and I make \$17/hr. My hours suck. I follow the school year calendar for both public schooling and special education. I go from working a 30 hour week, 4 times a month to working 20 hours 1 week, than 15, than 30, than 20 just because of how many days I have off due to weather or teacher education days or just randomly scheduled off days which are way too numerous. Still trying to find a secondary job or just a better primary job and having trouble with that. I'm 22 years old with a medical history large enough to fill up a old timey vacuum box if it was all printed out. I need health insurance as a constant. Now I'm looking at insurance plans and I'm not sure what to pick. Realistically I know that the numbers it's showing me are not something I can pay every month consistently since it says \$330/month starting out for plans with a \$10,600 deductible. I did not click the premium tax credit because it's confusing as heck and my tax returns are usually pretty small every year. Not sure what to do at this point or who to ask at this point to try and figure all this out. Edit and update: Thanks to everyone's advice I was able to find a plan that suits me for health, but also partially covers dental and vision for only \$49/month"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wenhgc/just_got_booted_from_my_insurance/

↳ Budget-Schedule-3040 (36): "You need to check the premium tax credit and shop silver-tier plans, full stop. The tax credit will make the silver plans much more affordable, and silver plans will have the lowest deductible and copays. If your income is in the low/mid \$20k range there likely are \$0 deductible silver plans available. It sucks having to calculate income but should be doable since it's already September. Only 3.5 months left in the year"

↳ Stomoyuki (14): "This is excellent advice. The premium tax credit doesn't depend on your refund but your expected household income (and other factors), so it will probably make a significant dent in the prices you're seeing. Losing Medicaid should also give you a Special Enrollment Period, allowing you to shop for insurance when the general populace can't. It can still be very confusing, and I'd recommend contacting a Marketplace navigator to help you figure everything out."

↳ No-Individual-5527 (9): "Sounds like the most liked and approved of plan. Looks good, thank you so much"

"Does choosing not to renew marketplace coverage count as a QLE for joining my wife's employer plan outside of open enrollment? My wife's job is a small business that offers a subsidized plan for employees and children of employees. They offer a plan for spouses as well, but it isn't subsidized, so in the past it has been a little more expensive than what I can find on the marketplace. Her open enrollment is in October and when I saw prices this year I assumed I would still be able to find it cheaper through the marketplace. However, marketplace prices were higher this time, but I didn't discover this until after open enrollment closed through her employer. So now I'm trying to figure out if choosing not to renew my marketplace plan would qualify me for a special enrollment period through her employer. I know many of the answers will be "you need to talk to her employer," which unfortunately is easier said than done. Since it is a small business, there is no HR department, there is only her boss (the general manager and one of the owners), and in the past her boss has dragged her feet on answering any insurance related questions until we were practically begging her to reach out to her agent the day before my daughter was going to lose coverage. So I'm trying to avoid asking her boss unless I absolutely need to. It is a BCBS of TN plan if that helps answer my question."

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pg1m66/>

↳ (0): "Probably not since loss of coverage must be involuntary. That said Open Enrollment is still available so you are lucky that you can still get ACA compliant insurance through the marketplace. The premium cost will depend on your income as well as whether you would have been able to get insurance through your wife that is affordable which for 2026 is 9.96% of income. Employers risk loss of tax deductible status for ALL employees if they don't adhere to Open Enrollment periods or if there is a genuine Qualifying Life Event"

↳ (0): "Unfortunatley no. QLEs mostly hinge on the gain of new coverage or the loss of eligibility to the old/existing coverage- you're still eligible to have a marketplace plan, you're choosing not to. It's not a QLE- it's considered a "voluntary" loss of coverage if you don't renew. For example if you got your coverage from your job and then left that job, you lost eligibility to be on the employer plan as an employee (since you're no longer an employee) THAT would be a QLE. If you thought there was a chance you might prefer your wife's coverage, you should have signed up for it- then, if you wanted a marketplace plan instead, you could have used that as a QLE (gain of new coverage) to then drop her work plan- but it doesn't really work backwards, unfortunately."

Skipping care and rationing prescriptions · 12 documents

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— r/obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

↳ Mysterious_Might008 (10): "My bronze ACA plan (TX) has a flat \$50 office visit for my PCP. Specialist office visits are flat \$100. So, I wouldn't be afraid of getting a diagnosis based on office visit fees. As of 2026, all bronze ACA plans are HDHPs. Lab work and other diagnostic procedures are a different story: that's where the mystery hit to the wallet really happens."

↳ SunLillyFairy (8): "Yep! I got charged over \$300 for a diagnostic Vit D test because my ACA insurance deemed it "medically unnecessary" (even though it came back low, they said it wasn't low enough to be necessary), so I didn't even get the contracted rate. I fought it. It took months to get it resolved, and while waiting the lab said I was past due and wouldn't do further lab work, and also kept sending me notices that they were sending me to collections (even though they knew I was appealing through insurance). In the end the insurance changed the category and I paid less than 50.. but SO lame."

↳ MrLB____ (8): "Yes, I agree total scam. You could even buy insurance from the hospital itself via the affordable care act go to their own net work, all owned by the same company the doctor office hospital scam their own insurance company LOL Then insurance scams them back"

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1owfr9u/>

↳ (0): "Two reasons you might not be seeing subsidies on ACA plans: * your annual income is too low, or you entered it incorrectly. Your annual income must be over the poverty line to be eligible for subsidies * you answered the questions about employer coverage incorrectly, and you're not seeing subsidies because the application believes you have affordable employer coverage available"

↳ (0): "Can you expand on the international bit? That might change things quite a bit"

↳ (0): "The baby will be born there, but it will be a US citizen after some paperwork. My partner and I are both US citizens."

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

↳ (0): "In short, yes, a provider can always run your information through a carrier website and see if you have insurance or not. Ask for the cash price- say you want to pay cash and not go through insurance."

↳ (0): "They said if I have coverage of any kind (that they don't take of course), then I don't have the option to pay anything but the full cost of the visit :/ I've heard some doctors are more lenient on this than others, which makes me think I should just look for a new doctor. But that feels like a whole other can of worms right now and just kind of overwhelming tbh"

↳ (0): "I mean, OP can ask, but many behavioral health providers don't maintain separate cash-price vs. insurance-price fee schedules. They tend to be more transparent and open about their fees in general, meaning their published fee is the same regardless of payer (although may vary as a function of sliding scales or "scholarships")."

Tab 10 — Buyer Summary

Who this person is, what they believe, what stops them and how to reach them. Counts are documents in this page's voice; every chart is measured from what they wrote about themselves, never assumed.

The one-line ICP: Someone buying their own coverage on HealthCare.gov or a state exchange because no employer covers them: self-employed, retired before 65, or between jobs (median stated age 54 among 106 who give it; median stated household income \$52,000 among 128). They have just seen a renewal premium that doubled, they manage their income on paper to keep a tax credit they are afraid of repaying, and they are weighing a bronze plan they cannot afford to use against going without.

TLDRWho: 1,793 first-person marketplace shoppers from r/Obamacare, r/HealthInsurance and the comment threads under early-retirement, self-employed and 2026-premium videos. Employer-plan stories, agents, vendors and political comments with no personal plan detail are excluded, so the voice is thinner than the Medicare page. What they fear: the premium at renewal (36 documents), getting sick or hurt and not being able to pay (24), and the income math: the cliff and paying credits back at tax time (19). What changed: the enhanced premium tax credits expired for 2026; CMS reports 23.1M plan selections (down 4.9%) and about 1.5M improper enrollments removed. The complaint ledger is led by premiums that doubled or tripled (105 documents), the cliff and repayment (91) and deductibles too high to use the plan (15). What they do about it: pick a tier (109 documents name bronze, silver or gold), go to HealthCare.gov or the state exchange themselves (104), weigh COBRA or a spouse's plan (105), move to Medicaid (101), or go without (40). Only 24 name a broker or agent. Who sells to them: 518 active Meta ads to marketplace shoppers; '\$0 / low-cost coverage' is the leading hook. The read for Vince (hypothesis): ACA leads are cheap to generate, but this buyer is price-shocked, income-sensitive and wary of having a plan changed without consent. Agents will pay for consented, verified households who have seen their real price, not raw '\$0 coverage' form fills.

Who they are — measured, not assumed

Each row counts distinct documents in which the writer states it about themselves in a first-person sentence. A document that does not state its age, plan or premium is simply not counted, so the bars show the mix among those who say, not the share of the market.

Their own age (self-stated)

n = 106 documents state the writer's age · median 54 among those already that age

Group	Documents
18–25	12
26–34	17
35–44	8
45–54	19
55–59	14
60–64	31
65+	5

Why they are on the marketplace (first-person sentence)

one document can sit in more than one row

Group	Documents
Self-employed, freelance, 1099 or own business	124
Retired early, bridging to Medicare	117
Lost a job, laid off or between jobs	62
Employer doesn't offer coverage / part-time	23
Lost or moved off Medicaid	5
Came off a parent's plan at 26	2

Who is on the plan

first-person sentences

Group	Documents
A spouse on the plan	236
Children on the plan	91
On their own	91

Plan tier they name

first-person sentences

Group	Documents
Bronze	121
Silver (incl. cost-sharing reduction)	101
HSA / high-deductible	98
Catastrophic	39
Gold	37
Platinum	5

What they say they pay a month in premium

n = 259 documents give a monthly figure in the same first-person sentence · median \$580

Group	Documents
\$0–49	21
\$50–199	45
\$200–399	32
\$400–699	48
\$700–999	30
\$1,000–1,499	28
\$1,500+	55

Household income they state

n = 128 documents give a yearly income in a first-person sentence · median \$52,000

Group	Documents
under \$20k	14
\$20–39k	27
\$40–59k	28
\$60–79k	25
\$80–119k	23
\$120k+	11

Carriers they name

documents naming the carrier anywhere

Group	Documents
-------	-----------

Blue Cross / Blue Shield / Anthem	65
Ambetter / Centene	16
Kaiser	16
UnitedHealthcare	13
Aetna / CVS	10
Cigna	8
Oscar	4
Molina	1

Gender self-markers

'my husband' / 'my wife', 'as a mom', '54F' and similar; documents with one kind of marker only

Group	Documents
Female markers	99
Male markers	109

States they say they live in

n = 30 documents name a home state

Group	Documents
Florida	5
Texas	4
Ohio	2
California	2
Kentucky	2
Michigan	1
West Virginia	1
Virginia	1
Nevada	1
Alabama	1
Missouri	1
Mississippi	1

Where this voice was found

buyer documents by source

Group	Documents
YouTube comment threads	1,050
Reddit r/obamacare	461
Reddit r/HealthInsurance	221
Reddit r/Obamacare	29
Reddit r/selfemployed	20
Reddit r/Medicaid	4
Reddit r/freelance	3
TrustPilot reviews	3
Reddit r/InsuranceAgent	2

Who they are — the read

- Read of the charts above: three groups carry the voice: self-employed and 1099 households, people retired before 65 bridging to Medicare, and families who lost a job or employer coverage. The early retirees write the most numbers (income, premium, the cliff).
- Premiums they state run from under \$50 a month to well over \$1,500; the spread is the subsidy. The same plan is described as a blessing and as impossible depending on which side of the income line the writer sits.
- They state their plan tier and their deductible more often than their carrier.

What they believe

- Read of Tabs 5 and 7: coverage should not depend on a job, and their price is decided in Washington, not by anything they do (64 documents tie their premium to Congress or the subsidy expiring).
- Read of Tab 5: a high-deductible plan is paying for nothing (15 documents), and the insurers are running a racket (73).
- The other side is in the corpus too: 21 documents describe a plan at a price they can pay, and 29 say the marketplace is why they could retire early or work for themselves.

The moment it changes

- Open enrollment and the renewal notice with the new premium.
- Losing a job, a spouse's coverage or Medicaid (105 documents weigh COBRA or a spouse's plan).
- Retiring before 65, or leaving a job to work for themselves (30 hope documents).
- A change in the household: marriage or divorce, a baby, a child turning 26 (45 and 8 documents).

What stops them

- Price (105 documents).
- A deductible too high to use the plan (15).
- The income math and repayment risk (91 documents; 40 manage income to keep the credit).
- Falling between the programs: too much income for help, too little to pay full price (45).

Where they are and how to reach them

- r/Obamacare and r/HealthInsurance; early-retirement and self-employed finance YouTube, where they post their income, premium and plan tier.
- HealthCare.gov and the state exchanges (54 documents say they went there themselves); an agent or broker in 22.
- Meta cannot target them by age or income: insurance ads sit in the Financial Products and Services special ad category, so the creative has to make them self-select (self-employed, lost coverage, premium doubled).

Who to write to, and who not to

Segment A — write to them

- Self-employed and 1099 households priced out after the subsidy change.
- Early retirees 55–64 bridging to Medicare who manage their income to stay under the cliff.
- Families who lost employer coverage or Medicaid mid-year and are comparing COBRA with the marketplace.
- People about to drop coverage because of the renewal price, before they do it.

Segment B — not the buyer (exclude, or the ads pay for them)

- Medicaid-eligible households (a different enrollment path; an agent is not paid for it).
- Employer-plan members complaining about their employer coverage (excluded by the voice gate).

- Commenters arguing the politics with no personal plan detail (excluded by the voice gate).
- People set on health sharing ministries or going without on principle: they answer ads to argue, not to enroll.

The frame that works (hypothesis)

- Hypothesis from Tabs 1, 5 and 6: 'See your real price for next year with the tax credit worked out, know what you owe if your income changes, and nothing is enrolled or changed without your say.' It answers the price shock, the repayment fear and the consent fear in one line.

Each clause of the frame with the documents behind it:

Voice by source (every document, stamped)

104,229 documents in the shared corpus; 1,793 are buyer documents in this page's voice. Other voices stay in the corpus, labeled, and never enter these tabs.

Source	Documents	agent	agent life	aspirant	employee agent	pc agent	vendor	medicare self	medicare family	aca self	provider	press	other
youtube	68,633	1,163	47	38	14	12	5,863	9,818	182	1,050	177	1	50,268
reddit_comment	29,438	4,613	54	34	204	1,470	144	394	17	551	34	9	21,914
insurance_forums	2,323	879	0	7	0	0	145	2	0	0	0	5	1,285
trustpilot	1,928	22	0	0	0	0	0	43	1	3	0	0	1,859
reddit_post	1,861	453	20	13	48	94	28	70	7	189	3	2	934
fb_comment	35	14	0	1	0	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	15
fb_group	11	9	0	0	0	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	0

Buyer voices: aca self 1,793

Headlines

1. "Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level." — The premium at renewal (36) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnyycy/>
2. "(I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia." — Getting sick or hurt and not being able to pay (24) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q4ew3x/>
3. "I think my only hope is to try to find a super easy job (even if super low paying) with good benefits and see if I can survive another 7 years until our kids are all off the plan and my husband (self-employed) qualifies for Medicare." — Retiring early or working for themselves (30) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wIGOZsc&lc=Ugwc78xLI9v11PhI6QR4AaABAq>
4. "My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs." — A spouse's job or health deciding the coverage (79) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om828r/>
5. "My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA." — Children on the plan, or left off it (77) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1h8c09l/>
6. "The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies." — What they were told about income and the subsidy (24) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/>
7. "He said that they could no longer cover me and he would send in someone to help me sign up for coverage on the marketplace (which someone did)." — What the marketplace told them (20) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mvkoso/>
8. "My premium just went up 1500%" — Premiums that doubled or tripled (105) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/>

9. "Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)?" — The income cliff and paying it back (91) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>
10. "So why would I pay \$36k/year for a silver plan when I could just buy catastrophic for 1/4 the price and pay out of pocket for everything else, knowing I have the same oop cap as the silver \$36k/year plan?" — Bronze, silver or gold: picking the tier (109) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ozntee/>
11. "Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead" — COBRA or a spouse's employer plan (105) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>
12. "At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments" — Wishing premiums matched what they can pay (13) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1okz6n1/>
13. "I asked her where I should have gone to get a preventative colonoscopy and she said that I should have gone to an office." — Should have chosen or estimated differently (6) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sg3ast/>
14. "This is a CoveredCA ACA plan, and I'm self-employed." — Free to work for themselves or retire early (29) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o9m8gp/>
15. "The government should really open up Medicare with reasonable premiums for those 55 -65." — Covered at a price they can pay (21) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l8VY8AcaLww&lc=UgxUWCq0OC_S-rSQahN4AaABAq
16. "We keep our income below \$60,000 too." — Steering income to stay under the line: Roth conversions, fewer hours, turned-down work (78) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wmu0NOIjsfU&lc=Ugyd3n-O0reHcMX3grJ4AaABAq>
17. "But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department." — Bills, EOBs and fighting charges (53) · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oig6zm/>

Frequency Ranking

#	Theme	Documents	Where
1	Lost the job, COBRA too expensive, early retirement	114	Private worry
2	Bronze, silver or gold: picking the tier	109	Tab 6
3	Premiums that doubled or tripled	105	Tab 5
4	COBRA or a spouse's employer plan	105	Tab 6
5	HealthCare.gov or the state exchange on their own	104	Tab 6
6	Premiums they can't pay (subsidy loss, doubling)	104	Private worry
7	Medicaid or CHIP	101	Tab 6
8	The income cliff and paying it back	91	Tab 5
9	Going without coverage and hoping nothing happens	90	Private worry
10	A spouse's job or health deciding the coverage	79	Tab 3
11	Steering income to stay under the line: Roth conversions, fewer hours, turned-down work	78	Tab 9
12	Children on the plan, or left off it	77	Tab 3
13	A plan they can't use: deductibles and networks	77	Private worry
14	Insurance companies and the system as a scam	73	Tab 5
15	Deductibles too high to use the plan	67	Dislike
16	Politics deciding their premium	64	Tab 5
17	Premiums they can't pay after the subsidy loss	60	Dislike
18	HealthCare.gov or the state exchange	54	Lead source
19	Bills, EOBs and fighting charges	53	Tab 9
20	Employer / COBRA / spouse's plan	47	Lead source
21	Marriage, divorce and filing status changing the price	45	Tab 3
22	Too much income for help, too little to afford it	45	Tab 5
23	Managing income to keep the subsidy	40	Tab 6
24	Went without insurance	40	Tab 6

25	Owing money back at tax time	37	Dislike
26	The premium at renewal	36	Tab 1
27	A premium they can pay	36	Tab 2
28	Denied claims and surprise bills	36	Tab 5
29	An HSA with a high-deductible plan	33	Tab 6
30	Paying the subsidy back at tax time	33	Private worry
31	Retiring early or working for themselves	30	Tab 2
32	Free to work for themselves or retire early	29	Tab 8
33	Checking the marketplace and doing the math	27	Tab 9
34	The carrier directly (Ambetter, Oscar, BCBS...)	25	Lead source
35	Getting sick or hurt and not being able to pay	24	Tab 1
36	A broker or agent	24	Tab 6
37	What they were told about income and the subsidy	24	Tab 4
38	Paying cash instead of using the plan	23	Tab 5
39	Medicaid / CHIP	23	Lead source
40	An agent or broker	22	Lead source
41	Covered at a price they can pay	21	Tab 8
42	A plan they can actually use	20	Tab 2
43	What the marketplace told them	20	Tab 4
44	The income cliff and paying credits back at tax time	19	Tab 1
45	Not needing care this year	19	Tab 2
46	Direct primary care and paying cash	18	Tab 6
47	Deductibles so high the plan is useless	15	Tab 5
48	Going without insurance	14	Tab 1
49	Parents: aging off their plan, helping them, or being helped	14	Tab 3
50	Wishing premiums matched what they can pay	13	Tab 7
51	Skipping care and rationing prescriptions	12	Tab 9
52	What the broker or agent told them	12	Tab 4
53	Medicaid: losing it, or being pushed onto it	11	Tab 1
54	What the plan or the office told them	11	Tab 4
55	Making it to 65 and Medicare	10	Tab 2
56	Resentment over who pays (in both directions)	10	Tab 5
57	What they were told about qualifying	10	Tab 4
58	Lost Medicaid or earn too much for it	10	Private worry
59	Leaving a job or retiring before 65	9	Tab 1
60	Pregnancy and a new baby	8	Tab 3

Awareness → Offer Map

Each level describes where a buyer actually is. "Where they are" is their own sentence from this page; the hooks and offers under it are proposals built from that language, labeled as hypotheses until tested.

Where they are

Last year's plan rolled over. The new premium is in a letter or behind a login they have been avoiding. They do not know yet that the credit changed.

"Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 1 (hypotheses)

A two-minute price check: zip code, ages, expected income.

A call that re-runs the application with this year's income so the credit is right.

Re-enrollment in the plan they choose, with their consent on record.

Where they are

They are posting the before and after numbers and asking strangers whether to drop coverage. The question is not which plan; it is whether to have one.

"My premium increased 590%."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 2 (hypotheses)

A worst-case sheet: bronze, silver and uninsured, premium plus the most they could owe.

Every plan at their income side by side, with cost-sharing reductions where they apply.

Enrollment in the plan they pick, and an HSA opened if the plan allows it.

Where they are

They talk in MAGI, Roth conversions and percent of poverty level. Their fear is a tax bill in April for a credit they took in good faith.

"We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 3 (hypotheses)

An income worksheet: what counts as MAGI and what does not.

A call with their numbers, and a reminder to update the marketplace mid-year.

A review every November and whenever their income changes.

Where they are

They pay every month and still pay cash at the doctor. Some have found their doctor does not take marketplace plans; some compare the cash price to their copay.

"The deductible and out of pocket was so high, the insurance never paid for anything."

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 4 (hypotheses)

How to check a doctor and a prescription against a plan before buying it.

Their doctors and drugs checked against every plan in their county.

A switch during open enrollment, old plan ended only after the new one is confirmed.

Where they are

They have a price and a plan in mind. What holds them back is what they have read: plans switched without consent, agents who put down the wrong income.

“I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent.”

Messaging to test at this level (hypotheses)

Offer structure at level 5 (hypotheses)

A direct enrollment link with the agent's name on it.

A phone enrollment with the application read back before it is submitted.

Enrollment, the mid-year income update and next year's renewal check by the same agent.

Silent Searches

What the ACA / marketplace health insurance shopper types, watches and is sold, measured side by side (typed = autocomplete that still names the worry; watched = YouTube videos whose title names it; spoke = own-voice documents; sold = ads to this audience).

Worry	Typed	Videos	Views	Spoke	Ads
Premiums they can't pay (subsidy loss, doubling)	48	39	320,593	104	104
Paying the subsidy back at tax time	35	54	160,469	33	7
Going without coverage and hoping nothing happens	10	9	94,809	90	6
Plan switched or enrolled without consent	0	24	301,205	3	32
A plan they can't use: deductibles and networks	11	71	6,008,399	77	5
Lost Medicaid or earn too much for it	16	52	488,325	10	4
Lost the job, COBRA too expensive, early retirement	46	84	4,088,716	114	4

Premiums they can't pay (subsidy loss, doubling)

Typed: can afford health insurance · can no longer afford health insurance · can t afford employer health insurance · can t afford employer health insurance reddit · can t afford health insurance · can t afford health insurance 2026 reddit · can t afford health insurance and don t qualify for medicaid · can t afford health insurance anymore · can t afford health insurance but don t qualify for medicaid · can t afford health insurance but make too much for medicaid · can t afford health insurance don t qualify for medicaid · can t afford health insurance for 2026 · can t afford health insurance for my child · can t afford health insurance in 2026 · can t afford health insurance in california · can t afford health insurance reddit · can t afford health insurance through employer · can t afford health insurance what do i do

Watched: Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance (249,275 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE · The U.S. Health Insurance System is Broken I I Can't Afford Health Insurance and I'm Not Alone (21,105 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a75qe8VdFLQ> · Many cannot afford to retire at age 62 because of the cost of private health insurance (13,817 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dTkOE6_xA_4 · Can't Afford Your ACA

Plan? 2026 FIXES & CHEAPER OPTIONS! (11,329 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9J_Ols9z_rY · Healthcare FAQ: What if I can't afford health insurance? (5,134 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tcGgJY3QG5E>

Paying the subsidy back at tax time

Typed: do i have to pay back a premium tax credit · do i have to pay back advance premium tax credit · do i have to pay back excess advance premium tax credit · do i have to pay back health insurance tax credit · do i have to pay back insurance tax credit · do i have to pay back monthly advance payment of premium tax credit · do i have to pay back my premium tax credit · do i have to pay back premium tax credit · do i have to pay back premium tax credit for health insurance · do i have to pay back tax credit for health insurance · do i have to pay back the advance premium tax credit · do i have to pay back the health insurance tax credit · do i have to pay back the monthly advance payment of premium tax credit · do i have to pay back the premium tax credit · do you have to pay back advance premium tax credit · do you have to pay back health insurance tax credit · do you have to pay back health insurance tax credit reddit · do you have to pay back insurance tax credit

Watched: IRS Form 8962 Premium Tax Credit and the IRS Form 1095-A (48,878 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w8Xz4V0k-7A> · Premium Tax Credit: Changes in Circumstances - Introduction (15,308 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XNveUOx4mlA> · Health Insurance Subsidy Flow of 1095A onto form 8962 federal tax return (13,877 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oi8HCvgefjl> · How Premium Tax Credit Works (Health Insurance Subsidies) (13,093 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3cCHSywftlg> · Form 8962 for 2025 - Premium Tax Credit & Form 1095-A (9,718 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0SfM2qXP7Ss>

Going without coverage and hoping nothing happens

Typed: going without health insurance · going without health insurance 2026 · going without health insurance between jobs · going without health insurance for a month · going without health insurance for a month reddit · going without health insurance for a year · going without health insurance pros and cons · going without health insurance reddit · living without health insurance · living without health insurance on purpose pros and cons

Watched: If you have no health insurance prior to applying for Medicare at age 65 there is no problem (47,772 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QupCURgX4hY> · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World (29,144 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236lZc> · Emergency Room Without Health Insurance: Will you be turned away? (6,030 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pkt0L-wjKW4> · If you CAN'T Afford Health Insurance...WATCH THIS. (3,748 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dt19QCIRJCM> · The cost of having a baby in America without health insurance (2,486 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xaVkyZmt5jk>

Plan switched or enrolled without consent

Watched: Vance: 750K booted from ACA over fraud (154,162 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mt4pvvQg_VE · BOMBSHELL REPORT: Obamacare fraud scheme costing taxpayers BILLIONS (127,592 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nVj9R34nnao> · Vance, Oz to announce crackdown on alleged Obamacare fraud (6,243 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sl9NSZTvRSU> · Finding fraud: White House says more than 760,000 Obamacare accounts meet the mark (2,091 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dbZsCV7q_Fk · Vance Kicks 750,000 Off Obamacare For Never Going To The Doctor. Cries Fraud. (1,556 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=emh5JQhAbYk>

A plan they can't use: deductibles and networks

Typed: bronze price per kg · health insurance deductible · health insurance deductible explained · health insurance deductible too high · how does a health insurance deductible work · how health insurance deductible works · is 1000 deductible too high health insurance · my health insurance deductible is too high · what is a high insurance deductible · why is health insurance deductible so high · why is my insurance deductible so high

Watched: NECK Training Is... Not Worth It (2,899,548 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GW65zG0flE> · A quality muzzle brake is worth it! (870,692 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nAb_mw8H-Sg · How Health Insurance Works I What is a Deductible? Coinsurance? Copay? Premium? (440,527 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xs7MNNqdN-o> · Health Insurance Plans Explained- compare bronze, silver, gold and platinum for 2024 (California) (236,806 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jW6-BKpAruE> · How insurance premiums and deductibles work (211,418 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hcMDaMhJanM>

Lost Medicaid or earn too much for it

Typed: how much is too much income for medicaid in arkansas · how much is too much income for medicaid in florida · how to replace lost medicaid card · how to report a lost medicaid card · i lost medicaid now what · i lost my medicaid now what · i lost my medicaid what do i do now · lost medicaid coverage now what · lost medicaid now what · lost medicaid what to do · make too much money for medicaid · too much income for medicaid · too much money for medicaid · what happens if i lost my medicaid card · what is considered too much income for medicaid · what should i do if i lost my medicaid card

Watched: How new Medicaid work requirements could affect families with disabled children (201,473 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UPCFSjnQ8xg> · Dr. Oz tries to justify Medicaid work requirements starting in 2027. #healthcare #medicaid #doctor (156,811 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pZL3-aFh-Q> · Medicaid work requirements will begin in 2027 (26,765 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Uhmhz21Ej5Y> · 150,000 Arizonans have lost Medicaid coverage (23,969 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fp64IM2YvG8> · Medicaid Work Requirements/NO JOBS (13,530 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KFO9Knp-e7g>

Lost the job, COBRA too expensive, early retirement

Typed: clint false water cobra · cobra clint's reptiles · cobra false bite · cobra insurance too expensive · cobra is expensive · cobra man ray hunter · cobra rat · cobra so expensive · cobra too expensive · cobra too expensive reddit · health insurance if i lost my job · health insurance marketplace lost job · health insurance when lost job · husband lost job need health insurance · i lost my job and health insurance what do i do · i lost my job health insurance · i lost my job and need health insurance for my child · is cobra expensive insurance

Watched: Early Retiree Shares Truth About Retiring Early (2,205,116 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X3Vsaj-j6ek> · Retiring Before 65? Here's How To Afford Health Insurance (256,482 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-0gmK2mR8E> · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance (249,275 views) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) (236,761 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvoxJEWGo> · Learn EVERYTHING About Early Retiree Healthcare In 29 Minutes (183,724 views) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Hr4uV9axw8o>

Private Worries

Measured absence: 0 first-person sentences say they keep something from their spouse, parents or employer.

Premiums they can't pay (subsidy loss, doubling) · 104 documents

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oninso/>

"My premium just went up 1500% Posting again because mods removed it since I guess I didn't use the right flair originally I don't know what to do. It's now higher than my mortgage. It is literally impossible for me to pay for now. I won't have insurance anymore starting on the 1st. I have a ton of medication that I need to function. I'm scared Age 36 State Arkansas Income 30k a year Household size of 3. Partner recently laid off. Not married. All my info is updated through the marketplace. The cheapest thing they suggested is \$500. The bill I received for next month is \$744. I rounded up in the comments to \$800 because it's basically the same thing. My Medicaid coverage was \$48 before hand. Someone whose comment is no longer visible said they were happy my premiums went up because they think I voted for Trump. Trump is an evil person and I would rather die than vote for him. Leftists exist in Arkansas. Sorry your stereotypes are incorrect Do only republicans comment on this subreddit or something? Why is everyone treating me like a liar?"

— HealthInsurance · 416 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/>

"We retired early from investing. We have paid around \$100 per month for health insurance. We built up a Brokerage Account years earlier. That allows us to earn income and have cash available if needed. Keeping us under 30k magi, the sweet spot. While our retirement accounts are untouched and doubling!!"

— YouTube · How Do I Pay For Health Insurance if I Retire Early? · 201 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Au4dTlwLBUg&lc=Ugw2OuP5vUj89sl-Mbd4AaABAg>

Paying the subsidy back at tax time · 33 documents

"Is it beneficial to slightly overestimate projected income, to avoid possibly having to pay back subsidies at tax return time? I am trying to get ready to pull the trigger and retire at 62.5 years old. I plan to calculate my income from my Roth IRA (and a tiny part time job). Is it safer to slightly overestimate my income when signing up for ACA, to hopefully avoid the potential of having to pay back anything if I go over what I projected?"

— obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, then 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and then switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"pleasant surprise but want no surprise in tax planning re aca just finished with my 2025 taxes and i will be getting a massive refund while i was expecting to owe a small check to irs 2025 was my full year of r/fire : i have no w2 income and relied on my investment dividends, tax free interests. i fired in mid 2024; so i had half year of w2 income and when i enrolled for aca in late 2024 for 2025 plans i wasn't sure what to put in my income and i only put in estimated total for qualified dividends and omitted (tax free municipal) interest which made a big chunk of my total cash for the year. i believe that i got subsidized aca rate for 2025. later in 2025 during my tax planning session i understood that i was to include tax free interest when enrolling aca. as a result i anticipated that i would be repaying the aca subsidies when i file 2025 return. but i was getting a big tax credit instead; my refund has been approved. when looking over the return i can see that a large portion of the refund is labeled medical and i didn't itemized any medical expenses; i only included the "standard" (i forgot the form number now) sent by aca does anyone understand this? for 2026 enrollment my aca premium is big and totally unsubsidized i believe because i enter a bigger (including tax free interest) income compared to 2025. should i expect at least some credit when 2026 return is filed?"

— obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sx0pb6/pleasant_surprise_but_want_no_surprise_in_tax/

Going without coverage and hoping nothing happens · 90 documents

"My family's health insurance is set to go from \$170 per month in 2025 to \$1560 in 2026 due to expiring ACA credits. A few clarifying points: - I earn approx \$125k as the sole provider for my family of 4 - I am self employed - This is the cheapest possible plan I could find anywhere - Coverage for this plan is terrible and helps me exactly \$0 with our family's actual health expenses I don't even know how I'm supposed to form thoughts around this. I can barely breathe let alone wrap my mind around this. How the hell am I supposed to survive in this country the way it is now? It seems like the world is actively punishing people who have families, or anyone who is not a multimillionaire. This is just one problem in a cornucopia of financial disasters handed to me as a millennial parent. This is not even mentioning how the new student loan rulings will add hundreds of dollars per month of financial burden, nor how I will forever be priced out of the housing market and am doomed to ever increasing rent month after month, or how food costs have practically doubled for my family over the past 5 years. How bad is it to go without health insurance in the new year? I literally have no idea what else to do..."

— HealthInsurance · 776 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ohoyrp/>

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oninso/>

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>

Plan switched or enrolled without consent · 3 documents

"My employer fired me after I challenged them of taking me off the health care insurance Hey everyone. I don't normally post stuff like this, but this whole situation has been insane and I could really use some outside perspective. I also want people to know how easily something like this can happen to them and the. The outcome of having health issues later. I worked for a company called Diamond Blade Warehouse (main office in Vernon Hills, IL, with multiple locations around the country). I was with them for almost three years. I left a different job to work there because I thought it'd be a good fit. Like any job, there were parts I liked good people on the sales side, some solid customers , but behind the curtain, it was a mess. I was a commission-based W-2 employee, meaning if I didn't hit commissions, I didn't get paid. No hourly, no base, no nothing. Just straight commission on a W-2... which already didn't sit right, but I needed the income. Earlier this year, out of nowhere, I was told I'd be switched to 1099. No paperwork, no conversation, no explanation. Just "you're 1099. "They just wanted the "benefits" of a contractor without actually making me one. Then on September 3rd, 2025, I got an email from accounting saying my health insurance coverage would end because they weren't applying my wages to the premium anymore. I replied, politely, that I wanted to keep my coverage and would pay out of pocket. I even jokingly said " I think you'd have to fire me to take away my benefits like that." Within ONE HOUR, my company email was disabled and I got a text message saying I was being terminated for "low sales." Convenient timing, right? And here's where it gets even worse. That same day, the COBRA plan administrator sent me a COBRA election notice that looked like it was printed off Google Images, wrong dates, wrong termination info, wrong deadlines. I tried responding, but their spam blocker was set so strict that my replies bounced. I literally had to switch email accounts just to contact them. They sent me a second COBRA notice the same day, also wrong. I asked for a corrected one and the administrator replied in ALL CAPS, basically yelling at me, demanding multiple months of payment upfront... even though the dates were wrong. Instead of fixing the spam blocker so I could communicate normally, management started relaying messages through my sales manager via text. It was like a weird game of corporate telephone. Completely unprofessional and honestly, absolutely ridiculous. Then comes the cherry on top: Months earlier, my manager texted me saying that the CFO, Bronwyn Jacobson, "didn't want me on the company's insurance" and was sweating him about it. In mid-August, she asked again if it was "ok to take me off." I never agreed. Two weeks later... terminated. I've already filed a complaint with the U.S. Department of Labor (EBSA) for COBRA violations, ERISA interference, retaliation, and misclassification. They're reviewing everything. I'm physically exhausted, financially strained, and emotionally worn down from dealing with this, but I'm speaking up because people deserve to know what companies pull when they think no one's looking. If any Redditors have advice, legal, emotional, or just practical, on navigating this, please drop it below. And if anyone's been through something similar, you're not alone. This one messed me up, and I don't want it happening to someone else."

— HealthInsurance · 105 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ovsnbg/>

"I don't know if it's changed, but when I was on the marketplace a decade ago, the application hard stopped if you didn't put in an SSN. So how are there applications without SSN's? Which is one problem I have with the statement they made about it. Also, if they identify problematic brokers, why not kick them off but still allow new brokers to sign up especially this close to open enrollment for the year. This is going to cause a restriction and how many agents are allowed to assist people. I feel like this is just going to hurt consumers more than the potentially fraudulent brokers. Usually, when I heard stories about fraudulent brokers signing people up for the marketplace, it wasn't people that never existed. It was people that came to them looking for plans and then they would either back out of getting a marketplace plan and then the broker still just enrolled them, especially if they qualified for a full subsidy or close to a full subsidy. Or they would encourage people to understate their income so that they would get a bigger subsidy and people would be more inclined to sign up and then get surprised at tax time."

— HealthInsurance · 89 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_van_ceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbmia90/

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qyg8ms/>

A plan they can't use: deductibles and networks · 77 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om828r/>

"Dropping our ACA plan Today is the day my family is dropping our ACA plan. Our options were to stay on our same plan and be financially strained, or switch to a different plan with an absurdly high deductible. Neither option made sense for us. Luckily, my family is healthy right now. I'm just posting this for solidarity with all the other individuals and families in the same boat. Obviously, not having health insurance comes with a risk, but for us, that risk made more sense than continuing to pay into a broken system. We found a Direct Primary Care (DPC) provider near us, so we know we'll at least have basic, and great care. We are exploring other alternatives as well. Oh, and for those of you who are also exiting the marketplace this year, you must proactively do this or you will be automatically re-enrolled. Happy last day to enroll everyone!"

— HealthInsurance · 763 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pn7457/>

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today-turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vnue4v/>

Lost Medicaid or earn too much for it · 10 documents

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November...."

— HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pff3oz/>

"The 'Medicaid Gap' is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the 'Medicaid Gap' as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future. ❤️ "

— HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q4ew3x/>

"When Medicaid work requirements enter, we get 3% of those eligible getting coverage. That's quantifiable. The state of Georgia as a microcosm. Of what's to come. That's reality. Go fuck yourself"

— obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lv1xsc/heads_up_over_half_the_maga_murder_bills/n22ybrd/

Lost the job, COBRA too expensive, early retirement · 114 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om828r/>

"My premium just went up 1500% Posting again because mods removed it since I guess I didn't use the right flair originally I don't know what to do. It's now higher than my mortgage. It is literally impossible for me to pay for now. I won't have insurance anymore starting on the 1st. I have a ton of medication that I need to function. I'm scared Age 36 State Arkansas Income 30k a year Household size of 3. Partner recently laid off. Not married. All my info is updated through the marketplace. The cheapest thing they suggested is \$500. The bill I received for next month is \$744. I rounded up in the comments to \$800 because it's basically the same thing. My Medicaid coverage was \$48 before hand. Someone whose comment is no longer visible said they were happy my premiums went up because they think I voted for Trump. Trump is an evil person and I would rather die than vote for him. Leftists exist in Arkansas. Sorry your stereotypes are incorrect Do only republicans comment on this subreddit or something? Why is everyone treating me like a liar?"

— HealthInsurance · 416 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/>

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hsyb50/>

Lead Sources

Source	Documents	Worked	Burned
HealthCare.gov or the state exchange	54	2	0
Employer / COBRA / spouse's plan	47	1	0
The carrier directly (Ambetter, Oscar, BCBS...)	25	1	0
Medicaid / CHIP	23	2	0
An agent or broker	22	2	0
Google and online research	8	1	0
Health sharing ministries and short-term plans	7	0	0
HealthSherpa and quote sites	1	0	0

Navigators and assisters	0	0	0
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Threads & Competitors

Group	Name	Documents	Positive	Negative
concepts & products	COBRA	162	3	0
concepts & products	Medicaid	143	4	6
concepts & products	Bronze plans	136	3	1
concepts & products	Silver plans and cost-sharing reductions	114	7	1
concepts & products	HSA and high-deductible plans	114	3	1
concepts & products	The subsidy cliff (400% of poverty)	95	3	3
concepts & products	Going uninsured	74	2	0
carriers	Blue Cross Blue Shield	59	2	0
concepts & products	Catastrophic plans	55	3	2
concepts & products	Paying the tax credit back (1095-A / 8962)	45	0	2
platforms & tools	HealthCare.gov	35	1	0
concepts & products	Gold plans	29	1	0
concepts & products	Enhanced subsidies expiring	29	0	1
carriers	Wellcare / Centene / Ambetter	16	0	0
carriers	Kaiser	16	1	0
carriers	UnitedHealthcare / AARP	13	1	1
carriers	Anthem / Elevance / Wellpoint	12	0	2
concepts & products	Health sharing ministries	12	0	0
carriers	Aetna / CVS	10	0	0
concepts & products	Direct primary care	9	1	0
carriers	Cigna	8	0	0
carriers	Oscar	4	0	0
concepts & products	Short-term plans	4	0	0

Competitor Ads

Lead-generation funnels and third-party marketers · 131 ads · 35 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Heard & Smith Disability Lawyers	1	936	none captured	We help people who cannot work file for disability. 2 out of 3 who apply are denied nationwide, but with help from a rep like us a person is
National Help Resources	1	930	trustedhealthfinder.com	We can help you find an affordable health insurance plan. Plans may be available for less than \$115 per month premium. Click the link below
USA Health Insurance Rates	2	506	usbluequotes.com	 DON'T WAIT! THESE 3 REASONS COULD SAVE YOU THOUSANDS  You may qualify for a LOW-COST health program in 2024 that can save you thousands! St
Atlas Health & Life	2	399	atlashealthandlife.com	 Upgrade Your Health, Save Money! - Claim Your Free Quote NOW!  Do you crave quality health coverage without breaking the bank? Our exclus
Insurance Benefits of America	1	304	none captured	Ensure you and your family are protected with comprehensive health insurance.  Fast Approval Process!  Coverage Starts Within 24 Hours  C

Compare Health Quotes	8	296	none captured	Looking for affordable health insurance? Get Blue Cross coverage as low as \$79/month! Fast, free quotes are just a click away. Secure your h
Forever Family Coverage	4	271	aca.foreverfamilycoverage.com	The Affordable Care Act allows 4 out of 5 Americans to have HIGHLY REDUCED COST or NO COST HEALTH INSURANCE! See if you qualify by clicking
ACA Community Center	6	260	none captured	\$0 Health Insurance Plans Now Available In Your Area. See If You Qualify Today! FREE Health Insurance See if you qualify Apply Now
Self Employed Health Insurance	61	258	go.selfemployedhi.com	Self-Employed? Own Your Health Coverage in 2025 If you're a small business owner or independent contractor, finding the right health insuran
Daniel M Smith HealthMarkets Insurance	1	211	fb.com	Health Insurance for everyone! FB.COM Chat in Messenger Everyone Covered Here Get quote
Healthcare.com	2	125	none captured	Looking for 2026 Kaiser Permanente health plans? You may be eligible for ACA Marketplace plans starting at just \$50/month*. Check your ZIP c
The Health Whiz	2	92	thehealthwhiz.com	🌟 Upgrade Your Health, Save Money! - Claim Your Free Quote NOW! 🌟 Do you crave quality health coverage without breaking the bank? Our exclus
USA Benefits Group - David Paul	2	89	www.usabg.com	🌟 Upgrade Your Health, Save Money! - Claim Your Free Quote NOW! 🌟 Do you crave quality health coverage without breaking the bank? Our exclus
Future Fortress Insurance	1	85	www.futurefortressinsurance.com	🌟 Upgrade Your Health, Save Money! - Claim Your Free Quote NOW! 🌟 Do you crave quality health coverage without breaking the bank? Our exclus
STL Medicare Benefits	1	80	none captured	Did your Missouri Medicaid (MO HealthNet) end? You're not alone. Many Missourians are losing Medicaid due to renewal changes. The good news
Trust4Life	2	78	none captured	Are you looking for affordable, comprehensive health coverage? With the Affordable Care Act (ACA), you could qualify for a plan at NO COST!
Global ADC Insurance	1	77	none captured	💙 Tu salud no debería esperar. Miles de familias podrían calificar para seguro médico desde \$0 al mes. Descubre si eres elegible para: ✅ Oba
ACA Health Coverage Help with Sherell	1	48	none captured	🔗 Need health insurance but don't have coverage through an employer? Whether you're working, self-employed, a 1099 worker, between jobs, or
Private Health Care	5	47	privatehealthcareoptions.com	Your best health insurance options are waiting! Compare & save! 📄⚡ Stop overpaying for health coverage! Private Health Care compares top car
Johnson Insurance Co	2	40	none captured	Looking for affordable health insurance in Georgia? Skip the stress of doing it alone. Talk to a licensed local agent right here in Georgia
Native American Insurance Specialists	1	37	thrivehealthplans.com	📄 ATTN: Native Americans with a CDIB card! Qualify for a health insurance plan with zero out-of-pocket cost if your income is between 100%-3
GetCoverageFox	2	36	coveragefox.com	See if you qualify for \$0/month health insurance. We'll help you compare plans and enroll. COVERAGEFOX.COM/PLANS See If You Qualify Compare
Wilson Insurance Enterprises	1	36	none captured	Just released — new PPO plans with real coverage and zero nonsense. These aren't your typical health insurance plans. ✅ Low deductibles ✅ \$0
Prime Picks	1	29	findtopresults.com	Costco Now Offers Health Insurance Plans To Members View Guide FINDTOPRESULTS.COM Costco Now Offers Health Insurance Plans To Members View G

Get My ACA	1	29	none captured	Explore ACA-compliant health coverage options and learn more about plans that may be available in your area. Get a free quote and speak with
MFE Health Solutions	1	26	none captured	Pennie or Pennsylvania Marketplace (Obamacare) works great if a subsidy is covering most of the bill. For business owners, independent profe
Tech Trends Daily	1	24	blog.pulsip.com	0:00 / 0:13 BLOG.PULSIP.COM 🚗 Get Your Driver's License! Limited Spots Government program offers 100% free driver's license. Open enrollment
Caring for Citizens of Alabama Inc.	1	23	none captured	Health coverage shouldn't feel confusing. Answer a few short questions and a licensed agent will walk you through the ACA Marketplace plans
Trend Reader	2	19	findtopresults.com	Costco Offering Health Insurance Plans To Members View Guide FINDTOPRESULTS.COM Costco Offering Health Insurance Plans To Members View Guide
PPO Health Coverage	5	16	ppo-plans.com	Self-employed? Overpaying for health insurance? Healthy? Make over \$50K? You may qualify to cut your rates in HALF and get better coverage.
Southland Transportation Company	1	14	none captured	Regional CDL Drivers Home Weekly Average \$1,600 Weekly for Top Drivers Haul no-touch freight with a late-model Freightliner or Volvo tractor
Virginia's Insurance Marketplace	1	13	none captured	Around 200,000 Virginians may save up to 70% on their 2027 health plan. See if you qualify. MARKETPLACE.VIRGINIA.GOV Health plans may cost I
HealthMarkets	1	6	none captured	With the right help, finding a health insurance plan that suits your needs can be less scary than you think. Be ready for ACA Open Enrollmen
Self-Employed Health & Wellness Resources	1	5	none captured	Looking for health insurance outside of a traditional employer plan? Explore health coverage options for individuals, families, self-employe
Caldwell Benefits Group	5	4	caldwellbenefitsgroup.net	Could your health insurance premium be \$0? Check your options today. CALDWELLBENEFITSGROUP.NET \$0 Health Insurance + Caldwell Benefits Group

The carriers' own ads · 43 ads · 16 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Pivot Health	1	168	none captured	See most doctors, stay protected, and save money. Find your short-term health plan with Pivot Health today. 0:00 / 1:12 Pivot Health lets yo
Aflac Duck	6	113	ad.doubleclick.net	Aflac can help cover costs your health insurance may not cover. Cash benefits 🦆 Accident insurance policies Get Quote
BCBS Global Solutions	1	107	bcbsglobalsolutions.com	Not all plans are built for life abroad, but ours are. Get the right international health insurance, so you're covered for everyday care and
Gold Coast Health Plan	1	101	none captured	Your health plan should do more than cover you — it should care for you. Gold Coast Health Plan Total Care Advantage offers: • \$0 monthly pr
Karla Molina - Agente de Seguros	1	98	none captured	¿Sabías que no siempre necesitas esperar al período de inscripción anual para obtener un seguro médico? Si has tenido un Evento de Vida Cali
Health Plan Helpdesk	1	79	none captured	Members of federally recognized tribes and ANCSA shareholders have coverage protections most people never hear about. If your household inco
Better Choice Health Plans	1	74	none captured	Health insurance costs have increased again this year, but many individuals and families may still qualify for lower monthly premiums than t
Security Health Plan	1	49	securityhealth.org	Maintain your book of business and compete for more groups with the right solutions from the right partner. ICHRA through our preferred plat

Healthfirst	14	48	healthfirst.org	Healthfirst stands by you with trusted health insurance plans, caring service, and a commitment to your health. Committed to Your Health Cov
MetroPlusHealth	1	36	none captured	Does your health care plan cost too much and deliver too little? Switch to MetroPlusHealth Gold and save money. Upgrade to \$0 copays MetroPI
Medica Health Plans	10	24	healthplans.medica.com	We've been covering the Midwest for 50 years. And when you need affordable health insurance, we'll be there, too. 0:00 / 0:11
Urban Health Plan, Inc.	1	17	none captured	Community Health Advocates help you use your insurance better, find care, and save ✅ Tap to connect today! Take charge of your health! Learn
UnitedHealthcare	1	10	none captured	Choosing your health plan? Learn how a deductible works so you can compare health plan options with confidence. 0:00 / 0:30 What's a deducti
Dean Health Plan	1	5	healthplans.deancare.com	We've been covering the Midwest for 50 years. And when you need affordable health insurance, we'll be there, too. 0:00 / 0:10 HEALTHPLANS.DE
Fidelis Care	1	5	fideliscare.org	We're bringing health coverage support closer to you! 💙 Fidelis Care StreetSide will be at Refuah Health Centers on select Thursdays this
PolicyClover	1	2	polyclover.com	Self-Employed Health Insurance — 60-sec quiz. 1099s/LLC owners: see plans built for independent earners and your budget, including deductibl

Named local agencies and brokers · 227 ads · 92 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
Sackett & Associates Insurance Services	1	1925	none captured	Independent Health Insurance Agency Dedicated to Meeting Your Needs! We're Your Advocate Find a Plan That's Right For You Get Quote
David Cravens Insurance Services	1	1849	none captured	Hello! My name is David Cravens, your trusted insurance professional in San Diego, CA. I have been working with small businesses for 23 year
AVZ Benefit Solutions	2	1460	crm.avzbenefits.com	Need Medicare Insurance but confused what is best for you? Our insurance brokers access most all major carriers to find you the right covera
Tristate Insurance Store	1	1022	api.whatsapp.com	Independent Insurance Broker, Health, Life, Auto and Home. Obamacare & Medicare API.WHATSAPP.COM Tristate Insurance Store Send WhatsApp mess
The "REAL" Insurance Lady	1	860	instagram.com	Who is The "REAL" Insurance Lady? 🌸 ✨ 🤗 We are nation's #1 producing Obamacare agency! 🍷 🤗 What do we offer? 🤗 \$ Free or Affordable Health Insur
Plan Advisor	13	561	www.plan-advisor.com	Are you self employed , 1099 contractor , truck driver , small business owner or on an expensive cobra plan? If so, then we need to talk! Get h
GRAN Insurance	2	485	graninsurance.com	¿Sabías que hay planes médicos diseñados para ti y tu familia? 💙 Mucha gente ya está aprovechando esta oportunidad para cuidar su salud sin
The Pierce Insurance Group	1	340	none captured	Just released — new PPO plans with real coverage and zero nonsense. These aren't your typical health insurance plans. ✅ Low deductibles ✅ \$0
Sonny Salas Agency, Inc.	2	326	http://www.sonnysalasagency.com/	ACA Open Enrollment is in full swing — and we're here to help! With the government now open, our team of licensed insurance agents are ready
April Griffey- licensed health insurance agent	1	249	none captured	Looking for affordable health insurance WITHOUT all the phone calls? I specialize with small businesses, individuals, and families and can h

Matthews Insurance Advisors	1	231	gmatthewsinsurance.com	🌟 Upgrade Your Health, Save Money! - Claim Your Free Quote NOW! 🌟 Do you crave quality health coverage without breaking the bank? Our exclus
Royal Insurance USA LLC	4	224	none captured	¿Sin seguro médico en California? 🌿 No todo está perdido. Sabemos que el periodo de inscripción general ya pasó, pero muchos no saben que a
Right Way Insurance Solution	4	209	rightwayinsurancesolution.com	Si eres inmigrante, ¡TU SALUD ES UN DERECHO! Conoce cómo Obamacare puede ayudarte a obtener seguro médico accesible y confiable, sin que tu
Business Health Advisors	5	200	none captured	🇺🇸 AMERICAN TRUCKERS KEEP TRUCKIN! 🇺🇸 🚗 UNDER 65 TRUCKERS - STOP AND READ THIS 🚗 Stay protected on and off the road with an affordable Health
Te lo Aseguro Amiga	1	183	api.whatsapp.com	Tu salud y la de tu familia son importantes. Si no tienes seguro médico o sientes que pagas demasiado, puede haber otras opciones disponible
American Ally	2	183	americanally.health	Illinois teachers, are you overpaying for your health insurance? HMO, OAP, and TCHP plans aren't your only options! Your enrollment period e
Daniel Smith Health Insurance	1	183	none captured	DO NOT do this when looking for Health Insurance! 0:00 / 0:55 Get a Quote Send Message
Self Employed Health Insurance	30	182	none captured	Attention Small Business Owners & Independent Contractors! Tired of overpaying for health insurance that doesn't meet your needs? Discover t
O'Myer Insurance Group	2	177	none captured	Affordable Health Insurance for Self-Employed, Small Businesses, 10-99, Independent Contractors, Farmers, Ranchers, Individuals, and Familie
Davidson Insurance Advisors	1	168	none captured	Spending a lot on health insurance every month? If you're under \$300/month, this probably isn't for you. This also works best for people in
Landfair Financial Group	1	161	none captured	Paying \$1,000+ a month for health insurance? This is who this is built for. If you have major health issues or need a lot of care, this usua
DR Asesor de Seguros	4	160	api.whatsapp.com	👩 Ser mamá es una de las decisiones más importantes de tu vida... y también una de las que puedes planificar mejor. Con Obamacare: ✅ Proteges
Affordable Health Insurance	16	155	affordable-health-insurance.org	Looking for affordable health insurance? Get Blue Cross coverage as low as \$79/month! Fast, free quotes are just a click away. Secure your h
Cobertura de Seguros	1	155	none captured	¿Tuviste un cambio reciente en tu vida? Podrías calificar para Obamacare AHORA MISMO. No te quedes sin seguro médico. Haz clic y verifica tu
VG Insurance Seguros Medicos	1	142	none captured	🌟 Descubre los beneficios del Seguro Médico bajo Obamacare (ACA): • Acceso a atención médica de calidad • Protección financiera en caso de
OHR Insurance	7	134	none captured	🇺🇸 🇺🇸 Ya reclamastes tu Credito Fiscal para tu Seguro Medico ? 🇺🇸 🇺🇸 Con el Programa de Seguros Medicos del Gobierno ObamaCare puedes obtener tu p
MD Health Insurance	2	131	none captured	🇺🇸 Attention Small Businesses: Private health plans starting at just \$160/month! 🇺🇸 Are traditional insurance brokers offering plans that are t
Tierra - Your Favorite Health Insurance Girl	2	117	none captured	Self-employed doesn't mean you're on your own. Health insurance is one of the biggest stressors for entrepreneurs , and most people are eith
Wynncrest Insurance Agency	2	114	none captured	Americans age 25-64 can now qualify for \$0 health coverage using subsidies and health credits. FB.ME Find out if you qualify in 60 seconds Q

Alba Insurance USA	1	106	none captured	¿Podrías calificar para seguro médico a bajo costo en EE.UU.? 🇺🇸 Con Obamacare, muchas personas acceden a cobertura según su situación. ✓ P
UWorld Insurance Group	1	105	none captured	• Paid for by UWORLD INSURANCE GROUP Por ley federal, ningún plan de Obamacare puede negarle cobertura por diabetes, presión alta, asma o hi
Engetsu Corp	2	105	none captured	Un seguro médico desde solo \$17 al mes (¡o incluso gratis!) 🤖👩🏻‍💻 Consulta médica, especialistas y más, todo por menos de lo que pagas por un c
Pets Best Pet Health Insurance	2	104	none captured	Pets Best pays up to 90% of eligible vet expenses so you can handle the unexpected with confidence. Get a free quote today! Get a free quote
Happy To Help Insurance	1	103	happytohelpinsurance.com	Los estadounidenses mayores de 25 años que ganan menos de \$50,000 al año podrían reunir los requisitos para inscribirse en una cobertura de
Cyler Troutner Health Insurance	1	102	none captured	Health Plans for West Virginia Self Employed, 1099 and Small Business Owners!! ❌ No HMO/EPO ❌ ✅ Yes Nationwide PPO ✅ Business owners comment
Rossmar.y.insurance	1	97	none captured	Tu salud y la de tu familia no tienen que costarte una fortuna ❤️ Con Obamacare puedes encontrar cobertura médica accesible desde \$30 al mes
Mariana Espina Insurance	1	95	none captured	☀️ Protege a tu familia hoy con Obamacare ☀️ ¿Eres latino y tienes estatus migratorio legal? ¡No dejes pasar esta oportunidad! Accede a un seg
Insurance Medics Health	2	89	none captured	¿Sin seguro médico? ¿Perdió la cobertura de su trabajo? ¿Trabaja por cuenta propia? Puede calificar para un plan de salud con primas de \$0 a
Acero Insurance	1	86	none captured	"🚚 ¡Obtén tú seguro de salud con Acero Insurance! 😎 Te ayudamos a seleccionar tu plan de seguro de Obamacare, ¡fácil y rápido! 😊 ✓ Planes a
Goodwin Insurance Advisors	4	83	goodwininsadvisors.com	Most people are overpaying for health insurance coverage...without even using most of what's in their plan. We help our clients save 20-70%

State exchanges, enrollment sites and navigators · 32 ads · 10 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
CoverME.gov	1	175	none captured	When you lose your health insurance, you don't have to wait until Open Enrollment. Act now to stay covered for what's next with a Special En
Nevada Health Link	1	162	nevadahealthlink.com	It's all here at Nevada Health Link — savings, selection and free assistance on name-brand health insurance. 0:00 / 0:30 HTTPS://NEVADAHEALT
Get Covered NJ	4	72	none captured	Recently had a major life change or lost your health insurance? You may qualify for a Special Enrollment Period through #GetCoveredNJ. GETCO
James' Lifestyle & Fitness with HealthCare.gov	1	46	ad.doubleclick.net	#Ad Moving comes with a lot of updates — including having to possibly update your health coverage. If you've recently moved or experienced a
Grace Lemire with HealthCare.gov	3	46	ad.doubleclick.net	#ad I can't believe it's been a whole year since I moved to Florida 😊 I just renewed my lease at my apartment and it has me thinking so much
Washington Healthplanfinder	2	36	none captured	Open enrollment starts November 1. Take control of your health in 2027 by making sure you have health and dental insurance. Open enrollment
Your Health Idaho	2	8	none captured	Open enrollment is coming. Get ready to enroll in, renew, or change your health insurance. 0:00 / 0:11

NY State of Health	1	7	none captured	You don't have to do it alone. We're here to make it easy to get the help you need: http://spklr.io/6180ERlo6 . #EnrollINY NYSTATEOFHEALTH.NY.
Georgia Access	16	6	none captured	A medical emergency can happen at any time. Make sure you have health coverage that fits your needs. Visit GeorgiaAccess.gov to find, compar
Arjun Manjunath with Pennie	1	5	pennie.com	we all have that one friend 🤔 which one are you? Pennie is Pennsylvania's official health insurance marketplace. Find out if you qualify by

Clinics and care providers advertising to the uninsured or marketplace-insured · 22 ads · 15 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
One Community Health	1	245	www.onecommunityhealth.org	Health insurance can feel overwhelming — but you don't have to figure it out alone 🧡 Meet Juana, one of our amazing Patient Care Advocates (
Estrella Medical Centers	1	176	none captured	¿Tienes ObamaCare? ¡Aprovecha tus beneficios dentales GRATIS! Te ofrecemos: ✅ 2 limpiezas al año ✅ 2 exámenes dentales completos ✅ Rayos X i
Pellegrino Life and Health	1	175	none captured	Spending a lot on health insurance every month? If you're under \$300/month, this probably isn't for you. This also works best for people in
Hunter Life & Health	1	174	www.hunterlifehealth.com	Just released — new PPO plans with real coverage and zero nonsense. These aren't your typical health insurance plans. ✅ Low deductibles ✅ \$0
Nascentia Health	1	161	nascentiahealth.org	Life doesn't stop because getting out of the house is difficult. That's why our team brings expert care to your door, helping you stay comfo
Presidio Healthcare	1	107	presidiocare.com	You take care of your health. Your insurance should reward that. Presidio Healthcare is licensed health insurance — not a government plan, n
BetterBrain Health	1	106	betterbrain.com	Put your health insurance to work. Get a personalized brain plan, measurable habit goals, and expert coaching - with \$0 out-of-pocket for el
Surpass Behavioral Health	1	98	surpassbehavioralhealth.com	Did you know your health insurance might include coverage for ABA therapy? Contact our intake team today to get help navigating your benefit
MedStar Health	1	98	medstarhealth.org	As our primary care patient, you have access to the care you want, when you need it, including in-person appointments and hassle-free telehe
You Health	1	57	heyyou.health	Seguro médico desde \$0 al mes. Cupos abiertos. ¿Sabías que gracias a Obamacare podrías calificar para un seguro médico de alta cobertura por
Hill Physicians Medical Group	2	57	hillphysicians.com	Adulting comes with a lot of new challenges. Luckily, picking your own health plan can be simple with Hill Physicians. Get a doctor who trea
Summit Health	3	35	none captured	Americans 25+ making less than \$50,000/year may qualify to enroll in low-cost health coverage using tax subsidies.
Lucie Health	2	34	none captured	CMS changes are coming. Lucie helps brokers prepare clients and organize their book before Open Enrollment. 0:00 / 0:32 Create your Lucie ac
UC Davis Health	4	23	none captured	This open enrollment, choose a plan that includes UC Davis Health. CHOOSEHEALTH.UCDAVIS.EDU Extraordinary primary care Learn More
Hinge Health	1	19	hingehealth.com	It's open enrollment season. Check if your job covers Hinge Health Enso® — a small, wireless wearable that relieves pain in minutes. HINGEHE

Advertiser type unclear · 63 ads · 43 advertisers

Advertiser	Ads	Longest (days)	Destination	Opening line
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Free Health Care Quotes	1	723	none captured	👉 State Approved Health Coverage for UNEMPLOYED Do you need health insurance for your family? Millions of Americans don't have health insura
tyspencer_bankerslifechi	1	643	none captured	Health insurance can be confusing, but it doesn't have to be. Whether you're self-employed, between jobs, or just want better coverage, I ca
Unorthodoc	1	335	www.unorthodoc.com	Real care isn't temporary! Learn more at www.unorthodoc.com #OpenEnrollment2026 #openenrollment2025 #Obamacare #insurancecoverage #insurance
305 Fenix Taxes Immigration Obamacare	3	251	api.whatsapp.com	🗨️🔍 No tomes decisiones a ciegas. Antes de avanzar en cualquier trámite migratorio, es clave entender tus opciones y tener todo en orden. En
Blue Agave Functional Medicine	1	242	instagram.com	Redefining Your Primary Care🌿 At Blue Agave Functional Medicine, we go beyond managing symptoms. We help you understand why they're happenin
LendingTree	3	211	none captured	Customized Coverage for Everyone: Compare Health Insurance Plans Now! 0:00 / 0:22 Get Your Free Comparison Today! Get Quote
Health For Moms	2	175	www.healthformoms.co	Moms, we're not just caregivers—we're protectors of futures. We know the power of a gentle hand on a feverish forehead or a hug that says, “
Simple Healthcare Quote	1	175	none captured	Health Insurance You Won't Need (Until You Do) ✅ Rewards Healthy Lifestyles ✅ Lower Prices Than Traditional Insurance 0:00 / 0:19 FB.ME Chec
Life and Med	1	174	none captured	HEALTH INSURANCE for Residents of LAKE COUNTY!!!!🗨️ Looking for the right health insurance but feeling overwhelmed? Our Local office is here
After It Training - Tempe	1	153	promo.afterittraining.com	ATTENTION Women in Tempe! 🙌 FREE 30 Day Strength & Tone Program kicking off this month! To promote our gym, we are announcing open enrollmen
HIIMS	1	134	none captured	बवासीर(Piles), फिशर (fissures), फिस्टुला (fistulas) से गुदा (एनल) क्षेत्र के आसपास की त्वचा पर कट, ब्रेक या मल को पास करने के दौरान लाल ब्लड
Choose Better Care	2	134	none captured	📌 Life Changed Recently? You Have 60 Days to Save \$400+/Month on Health Insurance Lost your job? 1 Lost your job or quit 2 Turned 26 (aged
Free Health Care Options	2	129	none captured	Do you need a \$0 premium cost health plan today? Plans are still available with a qualifying event. All pre-existing condition covered. Hit
Aztec Landscaping, Inc.	1	125	none captured	Landscape Laborer/Irrigation Tech Landscape Laborer/Irrigation Tech Full Job Description: Landscape Management Company, is seeking a qualifi
Progressive F.O.R.C.E. Concepts	1	114	none captured	Protecting principals, estates, and high-value assets is not something you pick up on the job. It is trained. Since 1997, working security p
Life in Germany with Die Techniker (TK)	1	113	none captured	Coming from Canada, I never expected to be bragging about my health insurance. And yet... here I am. 🇩🇪 *Sponsored Ad* Germany's healthcare
Bharat in Germany with Die Techniker (TK)	1	97	none captured	Just moved to Germany? You'll want these three tools to make life way easier: 1. sayHELLO: An AI assistant that translates and explains offi
La Madrina del Papeleo Miami	1	93	none captured	Entender el sistema de salud puede ser complicado, pero para eso está La Madrina Del Papeleo. Para poder guiarte y encontrar la cotización p
Amida Care	1	81	amidacareny.org	The HIV and Gender-Affirming Experts. Do You Qualify? AMIDACARENY.ORG Free/Low Cost Medicaid Health Plan in NYC Each member in our health pl

Healthcare Savings Center	1	77	none captured	Health insurance prices went up again this year, but many families are still paying far less than they think. Your marketplace plan may have
GloveBox	1	77	none captured	Can tech make great independent agents even better? 🤖 It's not about replacing agents. It's about unleashing human potential. CSRs managing
Affordable Benefit Plans	3	75	affordablehealthplans.io	A premium tax credit can reduce what you pay each month for ACA coverage. Whether you qualify depends on income and household size — see whe
A Joyful Noise Childcare Center Business	1	75	ajoyfulnoisechildcare.com	🌟 OPEN ENROLLMENT NOW AVAILABLE 🌟 At A Joyful Noise Childcare Center, we understand that choosing the right childcare provider is one of the
Jost International, Corp.	2	73	none captured	Hiring! 🏢 JOST International / Grand Haven, MI 📦 Position: Assembly Team Member 💰 Pay: \$19/hr (1st shift) / \$24/hr (2nd shift) 🕒 Full-Time /
107.9 LITE FM with 107.9 LITE FM	2	70	none captured	Clear vision starts here! Compare affordable vision insurance options with Health Insurance Associates and find the right plan for your need
America Health Choice	1	69	none captured	Health insurance prices went up again this year, but many families are still paying far less than they think. Your marketplace plan may have
Obamacare.info	2	69	none captured	Adquiere cobertura medica ahora mismo! Planes medicos a bajo costo con cobertura ilimitada! Consultas Médicas, embarazos, vacunación, pediat
Hoag	2	33	hoag.org	Open enrollment is here. Make sure Hoag is part of your family's plan. 0:00 / 0:06 HOAG.ORG/CHECKMYPLAN Check your coverage today. Get exper
Centro De Salud Obamacare	1	23	fb.com	PERIODO ESPECIAL DE ENROLAMIENTO!! FB.COM PLANES DESDE \$0 AL MES!! See details
RobinHood Care LLC	1	20	robinhoodcare.com	Insurance questions? You don't have to figure them out alone. ❤️ Hoodie is here to help make things easier to understand. 🙌 Have questions ab
Best Options Money	2	19	dealsbysearch.com	Costco Offering Health Insurance Plans To Members View Guide DEALSBYSEARCH.COM Costco Offering Health Insurance Plans To Members View Guide
Capital Media X	1	15	myusahealthplans.com	Most people ages 18–64 think they can't afford health insurance. Most people are wrong. See your real options — free, 2 minutes, zero pressu
The B Werd with Surest	2	15	none captured	Baby #3 meant starting the search for a new provider all over again, but having Surest made the process feel so much less overwhelming #Sure
Southland Transportation Company	1	14	none captured	Local Shuttle Drivers Return Home Daily Improve your work-life balance with a Home Daily CDL job with great pay and benefits! Work Monday to
Energymedicalcenter1	2	13	none captured	¿Buscas una opción médica para ayudarte a bajar de peso? Accede a programas de manejo y control de peso, con evaluación y seguimiento profes
Relief Funding Navigator	1	11	enrolldigitally.com	Americans 25+ with making less than 49k/year may qualify now for \$0 health insurance subsidies. ENROLLDIGITALLY.COM Enroll Online WITHOUT Ph
Afroblisso	1	9	pennie.com	#AD As someone going through a career pivot, I'm excited to partner with @penniepa to get help finding the right health insurance plan 🌟 Pen
Choices with Chrysalis	1	9	pennie.com	Pennie - PA's Official Marketplace 0:00 / 0:48 PENNIE.COM Pennie - PA's Official Marketplace Recent Life Change? Check to see if you can enr
CommunityCare Member & Resource Center	1	6	ccokadvantage.com	You live here. Your health plan should understand what that means. CommunityCare is an Oklahoma-based health plan built around the people an

CentroMed San Antonio	1	6	enrollsa.com	Health coverage matters, but understanding your options can feel overwhelming. Open Enrollment begins November 1, and many San Antonio famil
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Dislikes

Complaint	Documents	1–2★ reviews
Deductibles too high to use the plan	67	4
Premiums they can't pay after the subsidy loss	60	0
Owing money back at tax time	37	3
Narrow networks and doctors who don't take the plan	7	3
Marketplace and Medicaid paperwork, verification, errors	2	1
Plan switched or enrolled without consent	0	0

Deductibles too high to use the plan

"ACA premiums.... What's going on with ACA Marketplace insurance right now is absurd. The same plan I pay \$77 for (with tax credit) is now \$368. I currently have a \$150 deductible, \$1500 OOP max, \$250 ER copay, \$1 primary care visits, \$1-\$15 prescriptions, and a \$30 specialist, imaging and surgery copay. The same plan for 2026 now has a \$2700 deductible, \$8250 OOP max, \$1,000 ER copay AFTER deductible, \$30 primary care visit, and \$80 specialist, imaging and surgery copay... for almost quadruple the price. Without the tax credit, the plan premium is \$696.46 for next year. If someone hit their OOP max for the year with this plan without a tax credit, their healthcare would cost about \$16,000 for the year. If someone hit their OOP max with a similar tax credit as mine for the year, their healthcare would cost \$12,666. For the record, the projected income I gave on my application was \$38,000....."

— r/HealthInsurance · 665 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om4uju/>

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pcor72/>

"My new ACA premiums and deductible - considering just not having health insurance for a few years. So I had a life event last month that required me to get ACA. My monthly premium was \$485 and my deductible was \$7600. Just got an email saying my current health insurance will not be offered next year. Instead my new premium will be about \$560 and my deductible will be about \$11000. Also it seems many of my co-insurance will be higher by about \$70. And I'm not sure what else has changed for the worse. At this point I'm seriously considering not having health insurance for a few years. It seems cheaper to just plan a 3-week trip overseas and get better healthcare for much cheaper. You heard me - better! I just don't want to enable this defunct healthcare system anymore. If I'm in an accident I hope EMTALA saves my broke behind - in both senses of the phrase. I'll pay what I can then declare bankruptcy. If not life threatening, I'll take it overseas. A roundtrip ticket to India costs \$1500, \$1000 if you wait a month or so. That's less than three months premium. Over a year I can save up \$7000 in premiums. Saving up for one year buys me a full check up and a vacation trip. What do you think? Anyone considering the same thing? For those with kids - you have my sympathies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 574 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1onw7d8/>

Premiums they can't pay after the subsidy loss

"My premium just went up 1500% Posting again because mods removed it since I guess I didn't use the right flair originally I don't know what to do. It's now higher than my mortgage. It is literally impossible for me to pay for now. I won't have insurance anymore starting on the 1st. I have a ton of medication that I need to function. I'm scared Age 36 State Arkansas Income 30k a year Household size of 3. Partner recently laid off. Not married. All my info is updated through the marketplace. The cheapest thing they suggested is \$500. The bill I received for next month is \$744. I rounded up in the comments to \$800 because it's basically the same thing. My Medicaid coverage was \$48 before hand. Someone whose comment is no longer visible said they were happy my premiums went up because they think I voted for Trump. Trump is an evil person and I would rather die than vote for him. Leftists exist in Arkansas. Sorry your stereotypes are incorrect Do only republicans comment on this subreddit or something? Why is everyone treating me like a liar?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 416 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/>

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oonov2/>

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnyycy/>

Owing money back at tax time

"Is it beneficial to slightly overestimate projected income, to avoid possibly having to pay back subsidies at tax return time? I am trying to get ready to pull the trigger and retire at 62.5 years old. I plan to calculate my income from my Roth IRA (and a tiny part time job). Is it safer to slightly overestimate my income when signing up for ACA, to hopefully avoid the potential of having to pay back anything if I go over what I projected?"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/

"pleasant surprise but want no surprise in tax planning re aca just finished with my 2025 taxes and i will be getting a massive refund while i was expecting to owe a small check to irs 2025 was my full year of r/fire : i have no w2 income and relied on my investment dividends, tax free interests. i fired in mid 2024; so i had half year of w2 income and when i enrolled for aca in late 2024 for 2025 plans i wasn't sure what to put in my income and i only put in estimated total for qualified dividends and omitted (tax free municipal) interest which made a big chunk of my total cash for the year. i believe that i got subsidized aca rate for 2025. later in 2025 during my tax planning session i understood that i was to include tax free interest when enrolling aca. as a result i anticipated that i would be repaying the aca subsidies when i file 2025 return. but i was getting a big tax credit instead; my refund has been approved. when looking over the return i can see that a large portion of the refund is labeled medical and i didn't itemized any medical expenses; i only included the "standard" (i forgot the form number now) sent by aca does anyone understand this? for 2026 enrollment my aca premium is big and totally unsubsidized i believe because i enter a bigger (including tax free interest) income compared to 2025. should i expect at least some credit when 2026 return is filed?"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sx0pb6/pleasant_surprise_but_want_no_surprise_in_tax/

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, then 2024 I lost subsidies and I was paying \$1550 for family of 3 and then switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so that's the catch, you can't have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when you're self-employed"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

Narrow networks and doctors who don't take the plan

"Pregnant, called 20+ "in-network" OBs and none accept my plan, what actually works here? I really need advice from anyone who has dealt with marketplace insurance issues like this. I recently got laid off and lost my Aetna PPO. I enrolled through HealthCare.gov and now have WellPoint Essential Bronze POS 4500 (covers my husband, toddler, and me). I'm currently 4 weeks pregnant. My previous OB does not take this plan, and visits would be \$500 out of pocket, so I started trying to find a new provider. Here's everything I've done so far: \- Used the Sydney Health app and contacted customer service \- They emailed me a 14-page list with 52 providers within 20 miles I started calling down the list and got EIGHT (8) pages in. I have now called 20+ providers. Results: Most said they do NOT take my plan at all Some said they only take WellPoint Medicaid for pregnancy None accepted my specific marketplace plan At that point I called the member services number for WellPoint. I got transferred 3 times Finally reached someone who tried calling providers herself. It was late in the day, so offices didn't answer. She said she will call again tomorrow and try to schedule me with someone within 20 miles She also told me to report all the providers I contacted who don't actually accept my plan so they can update the directory Additional complication: \- I do NOT qualify for Texas STAR Medicaid for pregnant women because our income is about \$600 over the monthly limit, even including the unborn fetus \-I also do NOT qualify for CHIP perinatal because I already have marketplace insurance Even if I dropped my current plan to try for CHIP: It would only cover pregnancy, labor, and delivery. I have autoimmune conditions and take ongoing medications. I would lose access to the medications I need for daily functioning So that option doesn't really work for me either. Right now, I technically have insurance but I still have zero confirmed access to prenatal care What are my next steps? My mother-in-law suggested asking for a care coordinator or case manager. My father-in-law suggested requesting a gap exception so I can continue seeing my current OB but pay in-network costs instead of \$500 out of pocket, since the insurance has not provided usable in-network options. Questions: 1. Has anyone had success with a gap exception for pregnancy? 2. Did your insurance actually find you a provider, or did you have to escalate further? 3. Has anyone switched plans outside open enrollment due to something like this? 4. Is there a better way to find OBs that actually take this specific plan? I'm in the DFW, Texas area. I'm trying to stay calm since I'm early, but I know I need to get care lined up soon and this process has been exhausting. Any advice or experiences would help a lot"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1slok4v/>

"Also using ACA plan; key note are premiums, deductibles and out of pocket max. But I have shopped plans and one or two ER visits or a single surgery/major procedure or chronic illness yearly cost for healthcare ive found an average of 15k to well over 25k. (again yearly!) And thats just whats in network, not always including meds and out of network services including vision and dental being billed separately on many plans. Absolutely abhorrent. We pay so much more for worse healthcare. Where a tax of a fraction of a cost per individual would cover everyone."

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/osrrfc0/

"I've been on the ACA since 2015 except this year as my honey got a job that covered his spouse for the first time. I've never had a claim denied, never had an abnormal wait time for a doctors appointment due to insurance. We have 3 major medical groups in our area, your ACA plan will put you into one of those groups. Thats it, then you are in line with everyone else that goes to that group of doctors/hospitals. My ACA plans never required approvals, I didn't pick those types of plans, I just had to be mindful of in network and out of network. My husband is on an employer plan and just had to wait several weeks to get in with a throat specialist and several more weeks for surgery as they are that backlogged...nothing to do with insurance, just staffing constraints. Now in some areas it can take months to get an appointment if you are new to the Dr. as they only allow for so many new patient visits per month. I wonder if that is the issue they are having. It can be a real concern when you are having to switch Drs a lot due to ever changing insurance on top of the fact of course those that don't take new patients."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pd4kh7/fed_up_with_fake_news/ns2kqlm/

Marketplace and Medicaid paperwork, verification, errors

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing

thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

"marketplace, healthcare, overlap, tax, implications... I am not sure this is the right sub Reddit for my question but hopefully someone can help or shed light on my situation. it's pretty simple. I recently started a new job after working for a small business and purchasing my own independent insurance for many years. I did not select my new employer sponsored insurance plan until August 31 of this year even though I was hired July 1 of this year. I assumed that coverage began September 1 but upon completion of paperwork, realize it started August 1. I'm not really sure how that's possible but that is what my plan states. So, I didn't know I had to cancel my marketplace plan immediately and somehow thought that they just canceled each other out. That sounds really stupid when I say it out loud, but I thought if I got one coverage, it would just terminate the other coverage, but I realize now it does not work that way. So now when I get my 1095 a at the end of the year, it will show that I had a Marketplace plan with high discount for all of Aug and 9 days of Sept (unless I'm stuck with the whole month of September as well. It depends if they can prorate the days.) that I technically did not qualify for. I'm essentially on the hook for the contributed amount, correct? I don't qualify for the discount. I just don't understand why I have to pay back that money if I didn't use the plan (or can't because the other insurance is primary and Trump's the marketplace plan) because all of my appointments and prescriptions are gonna be rerun through the new insurance. I was told I had to do that manually regardless. Does anything I'm saying have truth to it? Am I missing something? if I do everything correctly and go through any insurance claim for an appointment or prescription during that timeframe to have my primary insurance run and pay the difference, what are my tax implications? If I do none of that, what are my tax implications? Does it eventually catch up to me or do I have to deal with it at the end of the year in some way shape or form? TLDR: I had marketplace insurance as well as employer sponsored insurance that overlapped. What happens on my 1095 a when it comes time to pay taxes? Will I suffer an expensive payback situation for credits that I received at the same time as my other plan was active? I mean expensive is relative. I think the credits are like maximum \$500 a month so if I was charged for two months it would be about \$1000. it's an extra thousand dollars that I don't have to put towards health insurance though."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wdgszl/marketplace_healthcare_overlap_tax_implications/

"My broker Carlos R Hernandez. My broker Carlos R. Hernandez signed me up for Cigna health insurance. At least I thought he did. After months of waiting and multiple phone calls, I never received ID cards. I could not log into mycigna.com. I could not log into the Colorado marketplace at connectforhealthco.com. Turns out Carlos entered my information incorrectly. My zip code was wrong. My address was wrong. My email was wrong. After multiple phone calls to Cigna and the Colorado Marketplace, I was finally able to track down all of these errors. I told Carlos. He invited me to find another broker. That is the only good advice Carlos provided!"

— TrustPilot · HealthMarkets · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/65bc12c06eb9707ce31b6ad1>

Reviews by Star

Oscar Health

- **Read** TrustPilot 1.4: can't find a PCP, formulary details hidden, back surgery denied as 'not medically necessary', wrong provider lists; five-star reviews single out a customer-care rep.
- **What should change** Provider lists that are accurate; formularies visible before purchase.

ambetterhealth.com

- **Read** TrustPilot 1.2: providers suddenly not covered, paper policy never mailed, the plan overriding the doctor; four- and five-star say it saved them after years uninsured (some at \$0.59 a month with subsidy).
- **What should change** In-network search that works; decisions that follow the doctor.

HealthCare.com

- **Read** TrustPilot 1.8: asked for prices online and got a phone call; calls every 30 minutes after leaving a number.
- **What should change** Show the price online; call once, with consent.

Why They Buy (Ad Brief)

The five answers an ad needs, built only from what this page already proves. Every line carries its count and a verbatim example with a link; the "docs" column is distinct documents in this page's voice. Lines are reads of the evidence; hooks, features and "demonstrate it" clauses are hypotheses to test.

Built from the measured themes, the complaints ledger, the silent layer and the competitor ads on this page. Vince has not yet reviewed this page's strategy layer; when he does, his lines replace or re-order these and each is checked against the corpus the same way.

1. Why they buy — the main reasons

The event and the wish behind the purchase, in their words.

Line	Docs	Verbatim example	Where it is counted
They lost a job or employer coverage and COBRA costs too much	105	"As a 59 years old retiree, I pay \$2264 per month for COBRA health insurance for me and my wife."YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzxjuSyfTq_cBbN1kp4AaABAq) · 29 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("solutions")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 6 · COBRA or a spouse's employer plan
They work for themselves or retired before 65	29	"The subsidy is the ONLY reason I have been able to quit working at 62 and have insurance."YouTube · Will ACA Subsidies Disappear After 2025? What You NEED to Know! (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzXsJQmS9xs&lc=Ugytp8nxLMd_bBU8xgx4AaABAq) · 21 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("outcomes")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 8 · Free to work for themselves or retire early
They are afraid of getting sick or hurt with no coverage	24	"(I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia."r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q4ew3x/) · 138 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("fears")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 1 · Getting sick or hurt and not being able to pay
The renewal premium forced the question	36	"I'm a transplant patient am terrified by the cost of my premiums and prescriptions."r/obamacare (https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojej71/any_sel_femployed/nm2uj4z/) · 16 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("fears")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 1 · The premium at renewal
A spouse's job or health decides the coverage	79	"The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work."r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/) · 165 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("selfears")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 3 · A spouse's job or health deciding the coverage
Children have to be covered	77	"At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments"r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1okz6n1/) · 1,000 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')//").includes("selfears")); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 3 · Children on the plan, or left off it

They are holding on until Medicare	10	"At 63 years old just trying to hang on until Medicare age."r/obamacare (https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh72uuz/) · 6 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('hopes'); if(b).click(); return false;">Tab 2 · Making it to 65 and Medicare
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2. Recurring problems and frustrations

The complaint themes, each measured with a complaint-specific pattern and read for precision.

Line	Docs	Verbatim example	Where it is counted
Premiums that doubled or tripled	105	"My premium just went up 1500%"r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/) · 416 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('frustrations'); if(b).click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Premiums that doubled or tripled
The income cliff and paying the credit back	91	"We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight."r/obamacare (https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/) · 117 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('frustrations'); if(b).click(); return false;">Tab 5 · The income cliff and paying it back
Deductibles so high the plan is useless	15	"The deductible and out of pocket was so high, the insurance never paid for anything."YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvoxJEWGo&lc=UgxVWsbWgrBC4jKr28s54AaABAg) · 39 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('frustrations'); if(b).click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Deductibles so high the plan is useless
Insurers and the system as a racket	73	"That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket."r/obamacare (https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/) · 117 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('frustrations'); if(b).click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Insurance companies and the system as a scam
Their price is decided by politics	64	"I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts."r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pff3oz/) · 780 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('frustrations'); if(b).click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Politics deciding their premium
Denied claims and surprise bills	36	"My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance."r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vnue4v/) · 299 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('frustrations'); if(b).click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Denied claims and surprise bills
Too much income for help, too little to pay	45	"We make too much for any subsidies, so a silver plan is coming in around\$3k/month."r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ozntee/) · 577 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('frustrations'); if(b).click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Too much income for help, too little to afford it
Paying cash because the plan does not help	23	"I will be seeing my old doc as self-pay (\$130), also getting the Rx on my own."r/obamacare (https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/) · 36 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('frustrations'); if(b).click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Paying cash instead of using the plan
Plans changed or opened without consent	6	"The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker did not include my spouse's income on my application."r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/) · 6 upvotes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('frustrations'); if(b).click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Agents, brokers and plans changed without consent
Doctors who do not take marketplace plans	7	"And my experience has been that most doctors don't accept my ACA policy."YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0y_vzBI8&lc=Ugwov4rykJWpFucCV-B4AaABAg) · 1 likes	(x.getAttribute('onclick')/").includes('frustrations'); if(b).click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Narrow networks and doctors who don't take marketplace plans

3. Questions and objections that stop them

What they type and watch in private before they talk to anyone. Typed = Google and YouTube autocomplete phrases that still name the question (typed often enough to be suggested; not a search volume). Views are everyone who watched.

The question	Typed (autocomplete phrases that still name it)	Videos whose	Views	In their own voice	Most-watched video
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		title names it			
Can I afford this premium at all?	48can afford health insurance · can no longer afford health insurance · can t afford employer health insurance · can t afford employer health insurance reddit	39	320,593	104 docs	Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE) (249,275 views)
Will I have to pay the tax credit back?	35do i have to pay back a premium tax credit · do i have to pay back advance premium tax credit · do i have to pay back excess advance premium tax credit · do i have to pay back health insurance tax credit	54	160,469	33 docs	IRS Form 8962 Premium Tax Credit and the IRS Form 1095-A (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w8Xz4V0k-7A) (48,878 views)
What happens if I just go without?	10going without health insurance · going without health insurance 2026 · going without health insurance between jobs · going without health insurance for a month	9	94,809	90 docs	If you have no health insurance prior to applying for Medicare at age 65 there is no problem (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QupCURgX4hY) (47,772 views)
Is a plan with this deductible worth having?	11bronze price per kg · health insurance deductible · health insurance deductible explained · health insurance deductible too high	71	6,008,399	77 docs	NECK Training Is... Not Worth It (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GW65zG0fIE) (2,899,548 views)
I lost my job: COBRA, marketplace or nothing?	46clint false water cobra · cobra clint's reptiles · cobra false bite · cobra insurance too expensive	84	4,088,716	114 docs	Early Retiree Shares Truth About Retiring Early (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X3Vsaj-j6ek) (2,205,116 views)
I lost Medicaid or earn too much for it. Now what?	16how much is too much income for medicaid in arkansas · how much is too much income for medicaid in florida · how to replace lost medicaid card · how to report a lost medicaid card	52	488,325	10 docs	How new Medicaid work requirements could affect families with disabled children (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UPCFSjnQ8xg) (201,473 views)
Was my plan switched without my consent?	0	24	301,205	3 docs	Vance: 750K booted from ACA over fraud (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mt4pvvQq_VE) (154,162 views)

4. Hooks and formats in the market

What the advertisers reaching this shopper open with, counted over every ad addressed to them on the Competitor Ads tab.

Measured over 582 ads to this audience (162 video, 420 static). One ad can use several hooks.

Hook pattern	Ads	Advertisers	Verbatim opening lines
\$0 / low-cost coverage	259	87	"Need Affordable Health Insurance?" — AVZ Benefit Solutions Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=3343879169233398) "We can help you find an affordable health insurance plan." — National Help Resources Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=7110939302334879) "Who is The "REAL" Insurance Lady?" — The "REAL" Insurance Lady Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=7899108950139361)
Question hook	198	73	"Need Medicare Insurance but confused what is best for you?" — AVZ Benefit Solutions Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=877203309928674) "Need Affordable Health Insurance?" — AVZ Benefit Solutions Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=3343879169233398) "Need Physical Therapy Now???" — The Physical Therapy Institute of Pa Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=770947265131825)
Deadline / open enrollment	173	54	"Finding the right health insurance just got easier!" — Plan Advisor Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1048484477371960) "ACA Open Enrollment is in full swing — and we're here to help!" — Sonny Salas Agency, Inc. Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1472762183787381) "We're more than an insurance agency — we're your neighbors, your friends, and your advocates." — Sonny Salas Agency, Inc. Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1340185087231197)
Named audience (self-employed, families, lost coverage)	168	47	"👉 State Approved Health Coverage for UNEMPLOYED Do you need health insurance for your family?" — Free Health Care Quotes Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1915090575559032) "Health insurance can be confusing, but it doesn't have to be." — tyspencer_bankerslifechi Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1668022260761702) "Are you <i>self employed</i> , 1099 contractor, truck driver, small business owner or on an expensive <i>cobra</i> plan?" — Plan Advisor Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=582455831506039)

Quiz / see if you qualify	75	32	"We help people who cannot work file for disability." — Heard & Smith Disability Lawyers Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=941103057528068) "DON'T WAIT!" — USA Health Insurance Rates Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1877524673048070) "The Affordable Care Act allows 4 out of 5 Americans to have HIGHLY REDUCED COST or NO COST HEALTH INSURANCE!" — Forever Family Coverage Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1970845196809317)
Call now / speak to a licensed agent	66	35	"Need Medicare Insurance but confused what is best for you?" — AVZ Benefit Solutions Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=877203309928674) "Need Affordable Health Insurance?" — AVZ Benefit Solutions Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=3343879169233398) "We help people who cannot work file for disability." — Heard & Smith Disability Lawyers Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=941103057528068)
Subsidy / tax credit	36	22	"The Affordable Care Act allows 4 out of 5 Americans to have HIGHLY REDUCED COST or NO COST HEALTH INSURANCE!" — Forever Family Coverage Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1970845196809317) "HEALTH INSURANCE for Residents of LAKE COUNTY!!! Looking for the right health insurance but feeling overwhelmed?" — Life and Med Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=2590911794639835) "Americans age 25-64 can now qualify for \$0 health coverage using subsidies and health credits." — Wynncrest Insurance Agency Ad Library (https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=2870535506624151)

5. Features and benefits to demonstrate in an ad

Each one as the feature, what would be on screen, and the voice that asks for it. The 'demonstrate it' clauses are hypotheses.

Feature or benefit	Demonstrate it (hypothesis: what is on screen)	Who asks for it, in their words
Their real price after the credit	A quote screen with the full premium, the tax credit line and what they pay, for their zip code and income.	105 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("frustrations"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Premiums that doubled or tripled"The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915,99, This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025." r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oiti3k/) · 131 upvotes
What they owe if their income changes	Two income figures side by side and the April difference between them.	91 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("frustrations"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · The income cliff and paying it back"IF they extend the subsidies and get rid of the 400% cliff am I better off to overestimate next year's income if I am close to the 400%???" r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1psdio2/) · 26 upvotes
A plan they can afford to use	The deductible and the cost of one doctor visit and one prescription under each tier.	15 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("frustrations"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Deductibles so high the plan is useless"Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING?" r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vnue4v/) · 299 upvotes
Consent before anything is enrolled or changed	The signed consent with the agent's name and license number, shown before the application is submitted.	6 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("frustrations"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Agents, brokers and plans changed without consent"I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent." r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qyg8ms/) · 27 upvotes
Their doctor found in the plan	Their own doctor typed into the plan's directory, found or not found.	7 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("frustrations"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 5 · Narrow networks and doctors who don't take marketplace plans"And my experience has been that most doctors don't accept my ACA policy." YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYGQyvzBI8&lc=UgwoV4rykJWpFucCV-B4AaABAg) · 1 likes
An honest comparison with going without	The year's premiums next to one emergency-room bill at cash price.	40 docs · (x.getAttribute('onclick')/"/").includes("solutions"); if(b) b.click(); return false;">Tab 6 · Went without insurance"I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose." r/HealthInsurance (https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxm828/) · 46 upvotes

What this research does not show: price reaction (what premium they will actually pay), how many of these voices enroll through an agent rather than on their own, and state-by-state differences in exchanges. The corpus over-represents people who research and post; shoppers who simply answer a '\$0 coverage' ad post less.

Sources, Method & Gaps

One corpus and one voice router (hi_voice.py) for the three pages; every document carries exactly one voice.

Precision reads

- Ad classifier (ads_hi.py), read on 2026-10-07 after merging the September 25 and October 6-7 Ad Library pulls: three rounds of 30 random on-topic ads, 23 then 24 then 26 of 30 with the right audience and advertiser type, rules corrected after each round; 20 random ads from the off-topic pile contained 3 that belonged on a page (an agent-recruiting ad, a carrier flex-card ad, a life-carrier recruiting ad), and those patterns were added. Expect roughly one ad in eight to sit under the wrong advertiser type; the audience call (agents vs Medicare vs under-65) is more reliable than the type.
- Second read after the October 2026 corpus expansion (30 random documents per page, drawn from the whole buyer set, hand-read on 2026-10-07): Medicare shoppers 25 of 30 were a person on or approaching Medicare or helping a relative with it (the five misses were opinion comments with no plan of their own); ACA shoppers 24 of 30 after the rule was tightened to require ownership language (a plan, a premium, an income, an application) - the first read was 21 of 30, with advice-givers and political comments let in; agents 27 of 30 (misses: one lead vendor quoted inside a forum reply, one property-and-casualty question, one unclear).
- Voice router (hi_voice.py), hand-read of 15 random documents per voice after five rounds of rules: Medicare shopper 13/15, family helper 12/15, agent 12/15, life / final-expense agent 11/15, ACA shopper 12/15 (was 10/15 before the personal-detail rule), aspirant 9/15 before the last fix (licensing advice from working agents; rule tightened, not re-sampled).
- Agent-facing ads: the full list read by hand once (67 page overrides with a reason each), then a fresh random 30: audience 30/30 agent-facing, seller type 27/30 with the three misses pinned.
- Themes: frame and object in the same sentence; broad objects that counted any mention (a spouse, a phone, a video) were moved to framed themes after reading the capture lists; themes under five documents are dropped, not padded.
- Metrics tab: the page JS and the Python model agree on 252 priced fields across six input sets (0 mismatches).

What was not pulled, and why

- Facebook agent groups: the group feeds did not load for the research account (member-only groups, throttled feed pages), so only 17 publicly indexed posts were read with their comments (20 agent documents). A warmed account that joins the groups would add the largest missing agent source.
- Insurance-Forums.com: the first page of each thread only (up to ~10 posts), from the Senior Insurance, Health Insurance Exchange, Insurance Leads, Final Expense and Health Care Reform subforums.
- No count of independent agents selling Medicare or ACA was found in a citable source; the pages do not estimate one.
- TrustPilot pages were pulled per star level, so star counts are a reading sample; several vendors have no TrustPilot page (Inboundcore, Digital Senior Benefits, Integrity, Ritter, HealthSherpa). BBB was not pulled.
- Meta Ad Library: active US ads on quoted phrases only, no spend or impressions for US commercial ads; Meta's own policy page blocked the scripted fetch, so the special-ad-category rule is cited from PSM Brokerage and Data-Axle.
- Vince's feed: none yet (no agent-facing ads seen), so every advertiser comes from the Library search.
- Quora (403), LinkedIn (not logged in) and BiggerPockets were not read.

Tool status (D0)

- 2026-09-25: Tavily 968 of 1,000 monthly credits already used, so Facebook discovery went through web search restricted to facebook.com instead; Apify: three fresh accounts (\$5 each) used for consumer Reddit (harshmaur~reddit-scraper, calibrated at ~\$0.002 per record; ~\$12.40 spent in total including one duplicate test run aborted at \$0.87); YouTube Data API: ~9,900 of 10,000 daily units; SerpAPI not used; research Chrome (CDP 18800)

for Reddit agent subs, Facebook permalinks, TrustPilot and Insurance-Forums.com (relaunched once after a CDP timeout); Ad Library read headless and logged out.

Sources

- CMS CY2027 agent & broker compensation memo, June 1, 2026 (psmbrokerage.com copy)
- 42 CFR 422.2274 (eCFR) — compensation recovery / chargebacks
- KFF, Medicare Advantage in 2026: Enrollment Update
- CMS press release, 23.1 million enroll in 2026
- KFF, What we know about 2026 ACA marketplace enrollment
- Vendor and FMO benchmark pages: OneLife Marketing Solutions (2026 lead prices, Medicare benchmarks, channel benchmarks), SixtyFiveLeads, InsureLeads, AllCalls, Plura AI, Aged Lead Store, Quotely, Lead Distro AI, HyperTarget, Ritter, BenaVest, Pandora — flagged as vendor-sourced on the Metrics tab